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Systems and methods for ex-vivo organ care and for using lactate as an indication of donor organ status

Abstract

The disclosure provides, in various embodiments, systems, devices and methods relating to ex-vivo organ care. In certain embodiments, the disclosure relates to maintaining an organ ex-vivo at near-physiologic conditions. The present application describes, for example, a method for using lactate measurement in the arterial and the venous blood lines of the Organ Care System Heart perfusion device to evaluate, for example, the: 1) overall perfusion status of an isolated heart; 2) metabolic status of an isolated heart; and 3) overall vascular patency of an isolated donor heart. This aspect of the present disclosure may use, for example, the property of myocardial cell's unique ability to produce/generate lactate when they are starved for oxygen and metabolize/utilize lactate for energy production when they are well perfused with oxygen.

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Background/Summary

REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent Ser. No. 18/153,391, filed Jan. 12, 2023, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,010,987, issued Jun. 18, 2024, entitled “Systems and Methods for Ex-Vivo Organ Care and for Using Lactate as an Indication of Donor Organ Status,” which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/916,514, filed Jun. 30, 2020, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,570,985, issued Feb. 7, 2023, entitled “Systems and Methods for Ex-Vivo Organ Care and for Using Lactate as an Indication of Donor Organ Status,” which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/396,296, filed Apr. 26, 2019, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,736,314, issued Aug. 11, 2020, entitled “Systems and Methods for Ex-Vivo Organ Care and for Using Lactate as an Indication of Donor Organ Status,” which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/857,953, filed Dec. 29, 2017, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,321,676, issued Jun. 18, 2019, entitled “System and Methods for Ex-Vivo Organ Care and for Using Lactate as an Indication of Donor Organ Status,” which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 13/587,810, filed Aug. 16, 2012, now U.S. Pat. No. 9,894,894, issued Feb. 20, 2018, entitled “Systems and Methods for Ex-Vivo Organ Care and for Using Lactate as an Indication of Donor Organ Status,” which is a divisional of U.S. application Ser. No. 11/790,405, filed Apr. 25, 2007, now U.S. Pat. No. 8,304,181, issued Nov. 6, 2012, entitled “Method for Ex-Vivo Organ Care and For Using Lactate as an Indication of Donor Organ Status,” which is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 11/246,902, filed Oct. 7, 2005, now U.S. Pat. No. 8,465,970, issued Jun. 18, 2013, entitled “Systems and Methods for Ex-Vivo Organ Care,” which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 60/616,835, filed Oct. 7, 2004; U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 60/694,971, filed Jun. 28, 2005; and U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 60/725,168, filed Oct. 6, 2005. The specifications of each of the foregoing are incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

FIELD

(1) The invention generally relates to systems, methods, and devices for ex-vivo organ care. In various embodiments, the invention relates to caring for an organ ex-vivo at physiologic or near-physiologic conditions and methods to indicate adequate perfusion and oxygen delivery to the myocardial cells.

BACKGROUND

(2) Current organ preservation techniques typically involve hypothermic storage of the organ in a chemical perfusate solution on ice. In the case of a

heart, it is typically arrested, cooled and cooled to the storage/cardioplegic solution in a hypothermic, non-functioning state. These techniques utilize a variety of cardioplegic solutions, none of which sufficiently protect the heart from myocardial damage resulting from ischemia. Such injuries are particularly undesirable when an organ, such as a heart, is intended to be transplanted from a donor into a recipient. In addition to myocardial damage resulting from ischemia, reperfusion of a heart may exacerbate the myocardial injury and may cause coronary vascular endothelial and smooth muscle injury, which may lead to coronary vasomotor dysfunction.

(3) Using conventional approaches, such injuries increase as a function of the length of time an organ is maintained ex-vivo. For example, in the case of a heart, typically it may be maintained ex-vivo for only a few hours before it becomes unusable for transplantation. This relatively brief time period limits the number of recipients who can be reached from a given donor site, thereby restricting the recipient pool for a harvested heart. Even within the few hour time limit, the heart may nevertheless be significantly damaged. A significant issue is that there may not be any apparent indication of the damage. Because of this, less-than-optimal organs may be transplanted, resulting in post-transplant organ dysfunction or other injuries. Thus, it would be desirable to develop techniques that can extend the time during which an organ can be preserved in a healthy state ex-vivo. Such techniques would reduce the risk of transplantation failure and enlarge potential donor and recipient pools.

(4) Effective preservation of an ex-vivo organ would also provide numerous other benefits. For instance, prolonged ex-vivo preservation would permit more careful monitoring and functional testing of the harvested organ. This would in turn allow earlier detection and potential repair of defects in the harvested organ, further reducing the likelihood of transplantation failure. The ability to perform simple repairs on the organ would also allow many organs with minor defects to be saved, whereas current transplantation techniques require them to be discarded.

(5) In addition, more effective matching between the organ and a particular recipient may be achieved, further reducing the likelihood of eventual organ rejection. Current transplantation techniques rely mainly on matching donor and recipient blood types, which by itself is a relatively unreliable indicator of whether or not the organ will be rejected by the recipient. A more preferred test for organ compatibility is a Human Leukocyte Antigen (HLA) matching test, but current cold ischemic organ preservation approaches preclude the use of this test, which can often require 12 hours or more to complete.

(6) Prolonged and reliable ex-vivo organ care would also provide benefits outside the context of organ transplantation. For example, a patient's body, as a whole, can typically tolerate much lower levels of chemo-, bio- and radiation therapy than many particular organs. An ex-vivo organ care system would permit an organ to be removed from the body and treated in isolation, reducing the risk of damage to other parts of the body.

(7) There exists a need for a sensitive indicator for determining the status of a donor organ, especially the perfusion status. Lactate, also called lactic acid, is a byproduct/end product of anaerobic metabolism in living cells/tissues/organs. Lactate is generated when there is no or low oxygen in the cell to metabolize glucose for basic energy production through the glycolysis pathway. Many clinical and scientific manuscripts have described the measurement of total lactate as an indication of body stress, trauma, injury or some form of hypo-perfusion state.

(8) In view of the foregoing, improved systems, methods, and devices for caring for and evaluating the perfusion status of an organ ex-vivo are needed.

SUMMARY

(9) The invention addresses the deficiencies in the prior art by, in various embodiments, providing improved systems, methods and devices relating to portable ex-vivo organ care. More particularly, according to various aspects, the invention provides systems, methods and devices relating to portable ex-vivo heart care. According to one advancement, the heart care system of the invention maintains the heart in a beating state at, or near, normal physiological conditions. To this end, the system circulates an oxygenated, nutrient enriched perfusion fluid to the heart at or near physiological temperature, pressure and flow rate. According to one implementation, the system employs a blood product-based perfusion fluid to more accurately mimic normal physiologic conditions. In alternative embodiments, the system uses a synthetic blood substitute solution, while in other embodiments, the solution may contain a blood product in combination with a blood substitute product.

(10) The present application describes a method for using lactate measurement in the arterial and the venous blood lines of the Organ Care System Heart perfusion device to evaluate the: 1) The overall perfusion status of an isolated heart and 2) The metabolic status of an isolated heart and 3) the overall vascular patency of an isolated donor heart. This aspect of the present invention is based on the ability of myocardial cells to produce/generate lactate when they are starved for oxygen and metabolize/utilize lactate for energy production when they are well perfused with oxygen.

(11) A system for evaluating the perfusion status of a heart is disclosed. In particular, an organ care system according to an aspect of the present invention includes a module that has a chassis, an organ chamber assembly that is mounted to the chassis and is adapted to contain a heart during perfusion. The organ care system includes a fluid conduit with a first interface for connecting to an aorta of the heart and a second interface for connecting to a pulmonary vein of the heart. The organ care system includes a Lactate A sensor for sensing lactate in the fluid conduit connected to the aorta of the heart, a Lactate V sensor for sensing lactate in the fluid conduit connected to the pulmonary vein of the heart, wherein a Lactate V-A differential is calculated using values sensed by the Lactate A sensor and the Lactate V sensor. The organ care system may also include a sensor for measuring the aortic pressure in the OCS.

(12) A method of determining heart perfusion status is also disclosed. In particular, one aspect of the present invention includes a method for evaluating heart perfusion status includes the steps of placing a heart in a protective chamber of an organ care system, pumping a perfusion fluid into the heart, providing a flow of the perfusion fluid away from the heart, measuring the lactate value of the fluid leading to the heart, measuring the lactate value of the fluid leading away from the heart, and evaluating the status of the heart using the measured lactate values. Additionally, the method can include the step of subtracting the lactate value of the fluid leading to the heart from the lactate value of the fluid leading away from the heart to determine a V-A lactate differential.

(13) According to another advancement, the system of the invention can maintain a harvested heart in two modes of operation; a normal aortic flow mode (also referred to as "normal flow mode"), and a retrograde aortic flow mode (also referred to as a "retrograde flow mode"). Generally, in the normal flow mode, the system circulates the perfusion fluid to the heart in the same manner as blood would circulate in the human body. More particularly, the perfusion fluid enters the heart via the left atrium and is flowed away from the heart via the right and left ventricles. In normal flow mode, the system pumps the perfusion fluid to the heart at a rate of between about 1 liter/min and about 5 liters/minute. This mode is useful, for example, for performing functional testing to verify that the heart is defect free, both prior and subsequent to transportation to a donor location. Alternatively, in retrograde flow mode, the system flows the perfusion fluid into the heart via the aorta, through the coronary sinus, and then out of the heart via the right ventricle. In this mode of operation, the system reduces the flow rate of the perfusion fluid to between about 300 milliliters/min and about 1 liter/min. The inventors have found that the retrograde flow path, along with the reduced flow rate, reduces damage to the heart during extended periods of ex-vivo care. Thus, according to one feature of the invention, the heart is transported to a donor site in retrograde flow mode.

(14) According to various aspects, the systems and/or devices of the invention include, and/or the methods of the invention employ, one or more of: an organ chamber assembly for containing a heart during ex-vivo care; a reservoir for containing and optionally, defoaming and/or filtering a volume of perfusion fluid; a perfusion fluid pump for pumping/circulating perfusion fluid to and from the harvested heart; a heater assembly for maintaining the temperature of the perfusion fluid at or near physiological temperatures; a flow mode selector valve for switching between normal and retrograde flow modes; an oxygenator for re-oxygenating the perfusion fluid subsequent to it being expelled by the heart; a nutritional subsystem for replenishing nutrients in the perfusion fluid as they are metabolized by the heart and for providing preservatives to the perfusion fluid to reduce, for example, ischemia and/or other reperfusion related injuries to the heart; a sensor subsystem for monitoring, for example, temperature, pressure, flow rate and/or oxygenation of the perfusion fluid, and/or electrical signals from the heart and/or the various components employed to maintain suitable flow conditions to and from the heart; an operator interface for assisting an operator in monitoring system operation and/or the condition of the heart,

and/or for enabling the operator to set various operating parameters; a power subsystem for providing fault tolerant power to the organ care system; and a control subsystem for controlling operation of the organ care system.

(15) Operationally, in one practice, a heart is harvested from a donor and affixed to the organ chamber assembly by a process of cannulation. The perfusion fluid pump pumps perfusion fluid from a reservoir to the heater assembly. The heater assembly heats the perfusion fluid to or near a normal physiological temperature. According to one embodiment, the heater assembly heats the perfusion fluid to between about 32 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C. From the heater assembly, the perfusion fluid flows to the flow mode selector valve. Initially, the flow mode selector valve is positioned for retrograde flow mode to direct the perfusion fluid from the heater assembly to a first interface on the organ chamber assembly. Also referred to as an aorta interface or the left ventricle interface, the first interface is cannulated to vascular tissue of the left ventricle (e.g., an aorta stub) via a conduit located within the organ chamber assembly. The heart then pumps the perfusion fluid out of the heart through the right ventricle via a second interface on the organ chamber assembly. The second interface, also referred to as a pulmonary artery interface or right ventricle interface, is cannulated to vascular tissue of the right ventricle (e.g., a pulmonary artery stub) via a conduit located within the organ chamber assembly. In retrograde flow mode, fluid is not pumped into or out of the left side of the heart other than in the form of a small trickle of perfusion fluid, which is delivered to moisten the left atrium. In response to the flow mode selector valve being in the normal flow mode position, it directs the perfusion fluid into the left atrium of the heart via a third interface on the organ chamber assembly. The third interface, also referred to as a pulmonary vein interface or left atrium interface, is cannulated to the vascular tissue of the left atrium (e.g., a pulmonary vein stub) via a conduit located within the organ chamber assembly. The heart then expels the perfusion fluid through the left ventricle via the aorta interface, and through the right ventricle via the pulmonary artery interface.

(16) In both modes of operation, from the pulmonary artery interface, the perfusion fluid flows into the oxygenator. The oxygenator receives oxygen from an external or onboard gas source and applies gas (e.g., oxygen) to the perfusion fluid prior to returning it to the reservoir. The system may include one or more oxygen saturation sensors to measure the oxygen saturation level of the perfusion fluid to ensure that the perfusion fluid is maintained at physiological oxygen levels. In the embodiments where the perfusion fluid is blood-product based, it contains red blood cells (e.g., oxygen carrying cells). Optionally, the oxygen sensors also provide a hematocrit measurement of the concentration of red blood cells in the perfusion fluid.

(17) In both normal and retrograde flow modes, the nutritional subsystem infuses the perfusion fluid with a supply of maintenance solutions as the perfusion fluid flows through the system, and in some embodiments, while it is in the reservoir. According to one feature, the maintenance solutions include nutrients, such as glucose. According to another feature, the maintenance solutions include a supply of therapeutics and/or preservatives (e.g., cardio stimulants, insulin, amino acids, etc.) for reducing ischemia and/or other reperfusion related injuries to the heart.

(18) According to another practice, the perfusion fluid includes blood removed from the donor through a process of exsanguination during harvesting of the heart. Initially, the blood from the donor is loaded into the reservoir and the cannulation locations in the organ chamber assembly are bypassed with a bypass conduit to enable normal mode flow of perfusion fluid through the system without a heart being present. Prior to cannulating the harvested heart, the system may be primed by circulating the exsanguinated donor blood through the system to heat, oxygenate and/or filter it. Nutrients, preservatives, and/or other therapeutics may also be provided during priming via the infusion pump of the nutritional subsystem. During priming, various parameters may also be initialized and calibrated via the operator interface during priming. Once primed and running appropriately, the pump flow is reduced or cycled off, the bypass conduit is removed from the organ chamber assembly, and the heart is cannulated into the organ chamber assembly. The pump flow is then restored or increased, as the case may be. According to one feature, the operator interface may be plugged into the system via a hard wired connection, or may be unplugged and used to wirelessly communicate with the system of the invention.

(19) According to one feature, the system includes a plurality of compliance chambers. The compliance chambers are essentially small inline fluid accumulators with flexible, resilient walls for simulating the human body's vascular compliance by aiding the system in more accurately mimicking blood flow in the human body, for example, by providing flow back-pressure and/or by filtering/reducing fluid pressure spikes due, for example, to flow rate changes. In one configuration, compliance chambers are located on either side of the flow mode selector valve and on the output of the perfusion fluid pump. According to one feature, a compliance chamber is located next to a clamp used for regulating back pressure seen by the aorta during normal flow mode operation.

(20) According to one implementation, the sensor subsystem includes an electrocardiogram (ECG) sensor for monitoring electrical signals from the heart. According to one embodiment, the control subsystem synchronizes the pumping of the perfusion fluid to the heart with the ECG signals. According to one feature, the ECG signals include an r-wave, and the control subsystem uses the r-wave to synchronize the fluid pumping with a diastolic state of the heart. According to another feature, the control subsystem adjusts pump stroke volume and/or pump rate in dependence on the ECG signals. For example, in one embodiment, the control subsystem reduces the pump stroke volume as heart rate increases in order to maintain blood flow. In another embodiment, the system reduces the pump stroke volume in response to detecting an irregular heart rate. In both cases, the result is to reduce fluid volume pumped to the heart, which in turn reduces the likelihood of causing damage to the heart. In various embodiments, the sensors include perfusion fluid flow rate and/or flow pressure sensors, which provide feedback for controlling the perfusion fluid pump.

According to one embodiment, to more accurately simulate normal circulation through the body, the pump of the system is a pulsatile pump.

(21) According to one aspect of the invention, the organ chamber assembly includes a plurality of improved features. More particularly, in one configuration, the organ chamber assembly of the invention includes a housing, an outer lid and an intermediate lid. The housing includes a bottom and one or more walls for containing the organ. The intermediate lid covers an opening to the housing for substantially enclosing the organ within the housing, and includes a frame and a flexible membrane suspended within the frame. The flexible membrane, preferably, is transparent but may be opaque, translucent, or substantially transparent. According to one feature, the flexible membrane includes sufficient excess membrane material to contact an organ contained within the chamber. This feature enables a medical operator to touch/examine the organ indirectly through the membrane while still maintaining sterility of the system and the organ. The outer lid opens and closes over the intermediate lid independently from the intermediate lid. Preferably, the outer lid is rigid enough to protect the organ from physical contact, indirect or direct.

(22) According to one implementation, the intermediate lid is hinged to the housing. The intermediate lid may also include a latch for securing the intermediate lid closed over the opening of the organ chamber. The outer lid may be similarly hinged and latched. In some configurations, gaskets are provided for forming a fluid seal between the intermediate lid frame and the one or more organ chamber walls, and/or for forming a fluid seal between the periphery of the outer lid and the frame of the intermediate lid.

(23) Optionally, the organ chamber assembly includes a pad or a sac assembly sized and shaped for interfitting within a bottom of the housing. Preferably, the pad assembly includes a pad formed from a material resilient enough to cushion the organ from mechanical vibrations and shocks during transport. In the case of the organ chamber assembly being configured to receive a heart, according to one feature, the pad of the invention includes a mechanism for receiving at least one electrode. The mechanism may include, without limitation, one or more slots, indentations, protrusions, through apertures, partially through apertures, hooks, eyelets, snaps, adhesive patches, or the like. According to one advantage, the mechanism allows for adjustable placement of the at least one electrode on or in the pad to accommodate differently sized and shaped hearts. According to one embodiment, the pad includes a through-aperture through which an electrical lead of the at least one electrode may pass.

(24) According to one embodiment, the pad assembly includes at least one electrode adjustably positioned at a location on or in the pad in such a way as to facilitate contact with a heart placed on the pad in the organ chamber assembly. According to one configuration, the at least one electrode rests on the surface of the pad and is held in place by the weight of the heart. In another configuration, the at least one electrode is glued to the surface of the pad. The at least one electrode includes one or more sensors for monitoring one or more electrical signals from the heart. It may also include one or more defibrillator contacts for providing an electrical signal to the heart. One advantage of the pad/electrode configuration of the invention is that

it does not require the heart to be at least one electrode to be permanently sutured or otherwise mechanically connected to the heart. Instead, electrical connection is made by placing the heart on the one or more electrodes. In one configuration, the at least one electrode includes an integrated sensor and defibrillation contact that allows the user to monitor electrical signals from the heart and provide an electrical signal to the heart through a common electrical interface connection to the organ chamber assembly. According to another feature, the common electrical interface includes one or more electrical ports on the organ chamber assembly for transferring electrical signals between the at least one electrode within the chamber and instrumentation located external to the housing. By way of example, the ports may provide the ECG signals to an external processor and/or display, and/or may provide defibrillation power to the electrodes.

(25) Optionally, the organ chamber housing also includes a base for angling the housing for optimal heart function. According to one feature, the base maintains a heart contained within the organ chamber at an angle of between about 30° and about 60° relative to horizontal.

(26) According to another aspect, the perfusion fluid heater assembly of the invention includes a plurality of improved features relating to providing a compact, solid state mechanism for heating the perfusion fluid. Some features of the heater assembly make it particularly suitable for heating blood-product based embodiments of the perfusion fluid. In one embodiment, the heater assembly of the invention includes an inlet, an outlet, a flow channel, first and second flow channel plates and a first heater. The flow channel is formed between the first and second flow channel plates. The inlet flows the perfusion fluid into the flow channel and the outlet flows the perfusion fluid out of the heater. The first and second flow channel plates have substantially bioinert perfusion fluid contacting surfaces for providing direct contact with the perfusion fluid flowing through the channel. The perfusion fluid contacting surfaces may be formed, for example, from a treatment or coating on a substrate or may be the substrate surface itself. The first heater is thermally coupled to the first flow channel plate for heating the first flow channel plate. In one configuration, the first heater is located on a nonperfusion fluid contacting side of the first flow channel plate. According to a further embodiment, the heater assembly of the invention also includes a second heater thermally coupled to the second flow channel plate for heating the second flow channel plate to provide a more uniform temperature distribution in the flow channel.

(27) According to one configuration, the heater assembly includes a first heater plate disposed between the first heater and the first flow channel plate for thermally coupling heat from the first heater to the first flow channel plate. According to one feature, the first heater plate is formed from a material, such as aluminum, that conducts and distributes heat from the heater relatively uniformly. The uniformly distributed heat of the heater plate is then coupled to the first channel plate, which preferably is formed from a bioinert material, such as titanium, which does not necessarily provide sufficiently uniform heat distribution if put in direct contact with the heater. The heater assembly may also include a second heater plate disposed between the second heater and the second flow channel plate for coupling heat from the second heater to the second flow channel plate.

(28) According to one embodiment, the first and/or second heaters of the invention are resistive heaters. In one configuration, they each include a resistive heating element formed on a polyimide substrate. According to a further configuration, the resistive heating elements have a resistance of about 5 ohms. In other configurations, the resistance of the heating elements ranges from about 3 ohms to about 10 ohms.

(29) Optionally, the heater assembly of the invention includes one or more temperature sensors. For example, the heater assembly may include a temperature sensor at its outlet for reporting the temperature of the perfusion fluid exiting the heater to the control subsystem. The signal from this sensor may be employed in a feedback loop to control drive signals to the first and second heaters to control the temperature of the heater plates. Additionally, to ensure that the perfusion fluid contacting surfaces of the heater plates do not reach a temperature that might damage the perfusion fluid, the heater assembly may also include temperature sensors for reporting the temperature of the first and/or second heaters to the control subsystem. The signals from these sensors may also be employed in a feedback loop to further control the drive signals to the first and/or second heaters to limit the maximum temperature of the heater plates. According to a variation of this embodiment, the heater assembly may include temperature sensors for reporting the temperature of the first and/or second heaters to the control subsystem.

(30) To provide improved contact between the first and/or second heaters and their respective heater plates, and also between the first and/or second heater plates and their respective flow channel plates, the heater assembly may also include first and second resilient pads disposed on the respective heaters for maintaining the first heater in contact with the first heater plate and the second heater in contact with the second heater plate in response to compressive force. The compressive force may be provided, for example, by way of one or more heater assembly housing components. According to one feature, the heater assembly includes housing components formed from a polycarbonate, and weighs less than about 5 lb., while in other embodiments the heater assembly may weigh less than about 4 lb., less than about 3 lb., less than about 2 lb., or even less than about 1 lb. According to another feature, the heater assembly is about 6.75 inches long, about 2.75 inches wide, and about 2.5 inches thick, all exclusive of inlet and outlet ports and temperature sensor assemblies. According to another feature, the heater assembly is a single use disposable assembly.

(31) According to one embodiment, in operation, the heater assembly uses between about 1 Watt and about 200 Watts of power. According to a further embodiment, the heater assembly of the invention is sized and shaped to transition about 2.5 liters of perfusion fluid flowing through the channel at a rate of between about 300 ml/min and about 5 L/min from a temperature of less than about 30 degrees C. to a temperature of about 37 degrees C. in less than about 25 minutes, less than about 20 minutes, less than about 15 minutes or even less than about 10 minutes, without causing substantial hemolysis to the blood cells or denaturation of any proteins that may be contained in the perfusion fluid.

(32) According to a further embodiment, the power subsystem of the invention provides a fault tolerant battery arrangement. More particularly, a plurality of batteries are interlocked such that all of them may not be removed from the system at any particular time while the system is operating to maintain an organ. According to one feature, the power subsystem can switch between external power and onboard battery backup, without interruption of system operation. According to another feature, the power subsystem automatically allocates externally supplied power between powering the system, charging the batteries, and charging internal batteries of the wireless operator interface.

(33) According to another aspect, the invention segments various subsystems and components of the portable organ care system into two modules; a portable multiple use module and a single use disposable module. According to one segmentation, the system of the invention generally assigns perfusion fluid contacting (and thus, blood product contacting in embodiments employing a blood product perfusion fluid) components to the disposable module, and nonperfusion-fluid-contacting (and thus, non-blood product contacting components) to the multiple use module. However, the disposable unit may also include non-blood contacting components. According to one feature, the perfusion-fluid contacting components may be coated or bonded with heparin or other anticoagulant or biocompatible material to reduce the inflammatory response that may otherwise arise when the perfusion fluid contacts the surfaces of the components. Heparin may also be added to the maintenance solutions for circulation within the system.

(34) In one embodiment, the portable multiple use module includes a portable housing constructed on a portable chassis, and the single use disposable module includes a disposable chassis. To reduce weight, in one configuration, the single use module chassis is formed from molded plastic such as polycarbonate, and the multiple use module chassis is formed from molded materials such as polycarbonate or carbon fiber composites. According to one feature, the single use chassis unloaded with components weighs less than about 12 pounds and the loaded single use module weighs less than about 18 pounds. According to another feature, the multiple use housing and chassis unloaded with components weighs less than about 50 pounds, and when loaded with a multiple use module, batteries, gas, maintenance solutions, perfusion fluid and a heart, weighs about 85 pounds or less. According to another advantage, the system of the invention including both single and multiple use modules, exclusive of any perfusion, nutrient, preservative or other fluids, batteries and oxygen supply, weighs less than about 65 pounds.

(35) The single use disposable chassis is sized and shaped for interlocking with the portable chassis of the multiple use module for electrical, mechanical, gas and fluid interoperability with the multiple use module. According to one feature, the multiple and single use modules communicate with each other via an optical interface, which comes into optical alignment automatically upon the single use disposable module being installed into the portable multiple use module. According to another feature, the portable multiple use module provides power to the single use disposable module

via spring loaded connections, which also automatically connect upon the single use disposable module being installed on the portable multiple use module. According to one feature, the optical interface and spring-loaded connections ensure that connection between the single and multiple modules is not lost due to jostling, for example, during transport over rough terrain.

(36) In various embodiments, the organ chamber assembly and the pump interface assembly both mount to the disposable chassis. The pump interface assembly is aligned to receive a pumping force from the pump driver of the perfusion fluid pump, and the interface assembly then translates the pumping force to the perfusion fluid to circulate the perfusion fluid to the organ chamber assembly. According to one embodiment, the perfusion fluid pump is a pulsatile pump, and the pump interface assembly includes a housing, a first deformable membrane, a fluid inlet, and a fluid outlet. The housing of the pump interface assembly includes an interior side and an exterior side. The first deformable membrane mounts in fluid tight interconnection with the interior side of the housing to form a chamber between an interior side of the first deformable membrane and the interior side of the housing. The fluid inlet receives perfusion fluid, for example, from the reservoir, and provides the fluid into the chamber in response to the pump driver moving in a direction away from the interior side of the housing, and thus deforming the first deformable membrane in the same direction. The outlet expels the perfusion fluid out of the chamber, for example, to the heater assembly, in response to the pump driver moving in a direction toward the interior side of the housing.

(37) According to one configuration, the pump interface assembly includes a bracket for fitting over a periphery of the first deformable membrane to form the fluid tight seal between the periphery of the interior side of the deformable membrane and a periphery of the interior side of the housing. According to a further configuration, the pump interface assembly includes a gasket for providing a fluid tight seal between the perfusion fluid pump driver and the pump interface housing.

(38) According to one implementation, the system also includes a flow valve positioned on the input to the fluid inlet. The flow valve includes a ball valve assembly oriented to open and pass the perfusion fluid into the chamber through the bidirectional fluid inlet in response to the pump driver moving in the direction away from the interior side of the housing, and oriented to close and stop perfusion fluid passing back out of the chamber through the fluid inlet in response to the pump driver moving in the direction toward the interior surface of the housing. In a further implementation, the fluid outlet also includes a ball valve assembly oriented to close in response to the pump driver moving in the direction away from the interior surface of the housing, and to open to expel the organ perfusion fluid through the fluid outlet in response to the pump driver moving in the direction toward the interior side of the housing.

(39) Optionally, the perfusion fluid pump rigidly mounts to the portable multiple use chassis, the pump interface assembly rigidly mounts to the disposable single use chassis, and the system includes features for automatically forming a fluid tight seal between the perfusion pump driver and the pump interface assembly in response to the single use disposable module being interfitted with the portable multiple use module. More particularly, the pump interface assembly may include one or more projections out of the exterior side of the interface assembly housing, sized and shaped for engaging with and abutting one or more surfaces on the portable multiple-use module to force/draw the interior side of the pump interface assembly housing in a direction toward the pump driver of the perfusion pump.

(40) According to one feature, the pump interface assembly includes a second deformable membrane mounted adjacent to the first deformable membrane for providing a fault tolerant seal in case the first deformable membrane tears. According to another feature, the pump interface assembly is formed at least in part from a polycarbonate or other molded plastic material, to reduce the weight of the single use disposable module.

(41) In one embodiment, the perfusion fluid reservoir mounts to the single use disposable chassis and is in fluid communication with the organ chamber. According to a further embodiment, the flow mode selector valve mounts to the disposable chassis. In other embodiments, the solid-state perfusion heater of the invention mounts to the disposable chassis. The oxygenator is preferably provided with the multiple-use module, but in certain embodiments may alternatively be part of the disposable module. The oxygen source feeding the oxygenator may be included on the multiple use portable chassis, may be part of the multiple-use module, or may be external to the system.

(42) In one configuration, the various sensors associated with the heater assembly, the oxygenator and/or the perfusion fluid pump are included on the disposable single use module. However, this need not be the case, for example, with regard to non-perfusion fluid contacting sensors. According to one embodiment, the single use disposable module employs an oxygen sensor including in-line cuvette through which the perfusion fluid passes, an optical source for directing light at the perfusion fluid passing through the cuvette, and an optical sensor for measuring an optical quality of the perfusion fluid passing through the cuvette. Preferably, the in-line cuvette seamlessly or substantially seamlessly attaches to a perfusion fluid flow conduit to reduce turbulence in the perfusion fluid and provide one or more accurate measurements. The seamless or substantially seamless configuration also reduces damage to any blood-based components of the perfusion fluid.

(43) According to a further configuration, the disposable single-use module includes the above-mentioned plurality of inline compliance chambers located, for example, at the outlet of the perfusion fluid pump, and on either side of the mode select valve between the organ chamber and the mode select valve. In a further embodiment, the disposable single-use module includes a plurality of ports for sampling fluids from the organ chamber assembly. According to one feature, the ports are interlocked such that sampling fluid from a first of the plurality of ports prohibits simultaneously sampling fluids from a second port of the plurality. This safety feature reduces the likelihood of mixing fluid samples and inadvertently opening the ports. In one embodiment, the organ chamber assembly includes ports for fluid interconnection with one or more of the pulmonary artery, aorta, and left atrium interfaces.

(44) In another aspect, the invention is directed to a method of preserving a heart ex-vivo. The method includes placing a heart in a protective chamber of a portable organ care system, pumping a perfusion fluid to the heart, the perfusion fluid being at a temperature of between about 25 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C., and at a volume of between about 200 ml/min and about 5 L/min, monitoring one or more physiologic characteristics of the heart while it is beating in the protective chamber, and adjusting a pumping characteristic based at least in part on the electrical characteristics to preserve the heart ex vivo.

(45) According to another aspect, the invention is directed to a method of preserving a heart ex vivo, the method including the steps of placing a heart on one or more electrodes in a protective chamber of a portable organ care system, pumping a perfusion fluid to the heart, the perfusion fluid being at a temperature of between about 25 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C., and at a volume of between about 200 ml/min and about 5 L/min and monitoring electrical signals from the electrodes while pumping the perfusion fluid to the heart to preserve the heart ex vivo.

(46) In a further aspect, the invention is directed to a method of transporting a heart ex vivo, including the steps of placing a heart for transplantation in a protective chamber of a portable organ care system, pumping a perfusion fluid into the heart via an aorta of the heart, providing a flow of the perfusion fluid away from the heart via a right ventricle of the heart, and transporting the heart in the portable organ care system from a donor site to a recipient site while pumping the perfusion fluid into the heart via the aorta and providing the flow of the perfusion fluid away from the heart via the right ventricle.

(47) According to an additional aspect, the invention is directed to a method of evaluating a heart for transplantation, including the steps of placing a heart in a protective chamber of a portable organ care system, pumping a perfusion fluid into the heart via a left ventricle of the heart, providing a flow of the perfusion fluid away from the heart via a right ventricle of the heart, transporting the heart via the portable organ care system from a donor site to a recipient site while pumping the perfusion fluid into the heart via the left ventricle and providing the flow of the perfusion fluid away from the heart via the right ventricle; prior to transplanting the heart into a recipient, operating a flow control external to the protective chamber to alter a flow of the perfusion fluid such that the perfusion fluid is pumped into the heart via a left atrium of the heart and is flowed away from the heart via the right ventricle and the left ventricle of the heart; and performing an evaluation of the heart. In certain embodiments the evaluation includes performing an HLA test on the heart while the perfusion fluid is pumping.

(48) In another aspect, the invention is directed to a method of providing therapy to a heart. The method includes placing a heart in a protective

chamber of a portable organ care system, pumping a perfusion fluid into the heart via a left ventricle of the heart, providing a flow of the perfusion fluid away from the heart via a right ventricle of the heart, operating a flow control external to the protective chamber to alter a flow of the perfusion fluid such that the perfusion fluid is pumped into the heart via a left atrium of the heart and is flowed away from the heart via the right ventricle and the left ventricle of the heart, and administering a therapeutic treatment to the heart. The treatments may include, for example, administering one or more of immunosuppressive treatment, chemotherapy, gene therapy and irradiation therapy to the heart.

(49) According to another aspect, the invention is directed to a method of transplanting a heart. The method includes arresting a heart of a donor, explanting the heart from the donor, transferring the heart to an organ care system, and pumping a perfusion fluid to the heart in less than 30 minutes after explanting the heart from the donor (so as to reduce the heart's cold ischemia time), the perfusion fluid being at a temperature of between about 32 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C. In certain embodiments the heart is brought to a temperature of between about 35 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C. in less than 10 minutes after transferring the heart to the organ care system.

(50) These and other features and advantages of the invention are described in further detail below with regard to illustrative embodiments of the invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The following figures depict illustrative embodiments of the invention in which like reference numerals refer to like elements. These depicted embodiments may not be drawn to scale and are to be understood as illustrative of the invention and not as limiting, the scope of the invention instead being defined by the appended claims.

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of a portable organ care system according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(3) FIG. 2 is a diagram depicting a harvested heart.

(4) FIG. 3 is a conceptual diagram depicting the harvested heart of FIG. 2 interconnected with the organ care system of FIG. 1 in a normal flow mode configuration according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(5) FIG. 4 is a conceptual diagram depicting the harvested heart of FIG. 2 interconnected with the organ care system of FIG. 1 in a retrograde flow mode configuration according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(6) FIGS. 5A-5F show various views of an organ chamber assembly of the type employed in the organ care system of FIG. 1 according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(7) FIGS. 6A-6F show various views of a perfusion heater assembly of the type employed in the organ care system of FIG. 1 according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(8) FIG. 7 shows a more detailed view of an exemplary resistive heater element of the type employed in the heater assembly of FIGS. 6A-6F.

(9) FIGS. 8A-8C show various views of a perfusion fluid pump interface assembly according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(10) FIG. 9 shows a perspective view of a pump driver side of a perfusion fluid pump assembly of the type depicted in FIG. 1, along with a bracket for mounting with the perfusion pump interface assembly.

(11) FIG. 10 shows a side view of the perfusion fluid pump interface assembly of FIGS. 8A-8C mated with the pump driver side of the perfusion fluid pump assembly of FIG. 9.

(12) FIG. 11 depicts a block diagram of an illustrative control scheme for controlling operation of the organ care system of FIG. 1.

(13) FIG. 12 is a block diagram of an exemplary data acquisition subsystem of the type that may be employed with an illustrative organ care system of FIG. 1.

(14) FIG. 13 is a block diagram of an exemplary heating control subsystem of the type that may be employed for maintaining perfusion fluid temperature in the illustrative organ care system of FIG. 1.

(15) FIG. 14 is a block diagram of an exemplary power management subsystem of the type that may be employed in the illustrative organ care system of FIG. 1.

(16) FIG. 15 is a block diagram of an exemplary pumping control subsystem of the type that may be employed for controlling operation of a perfusion fluid pump assembly in the illustrative organ care system of FIG. 1.

(17) FIG. 16 is a graph depicting an r-wave with which the pumping control subsystem of FIG. 15 synchronizes according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(18) FIG. 17A-17J depict exemplary display screens of the type that may be employed with an operator interface according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(19) FIGS. 18A and 18B show an exemplary implementation of the system of FIG. 1 according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(20) FIGS. 19A-19C show various views of the system of FIGS. 18A and 18B with its top off and front panel open according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(21) FIG. 20A is a front perspective view of the system of FIGS. 18A and 18B with the top removed, the front panel open and the single use disposable module removed according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(22) FIG. 20B is a side view of a slot formed in a basin of the multiple use module of FIG. 20A for engaging with a corresponding projection in the single use disposable module.

(23) FIG. 21A shows a mounting bracket for receiving and locking into place the single use disposable module within the multiple use module of FIG. 20A.

(24) FIGS. 21B and 21C show installation of the single use disposable module into the multiple use module using the mounting bracket of FIG. 21A according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(25) FIGS. 22A-22C show exemplary mechanisms for automatically making electro-optical interconnections between the single use disposable module and the multiple use module during the installation of FIGS. 21B and 21C.

(26) FIGS. 23A-23C show various views of the system of FIGS. 18A and 18B with all of the external walls removed according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(27) FIG. 23D is a conceptual diagram showing interconnections between the circuit boards of FIGS. 23A-23C according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(28) FIGS. 24A-24E show various top perspective views of a single use disposable module according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(29) FIGS. 25A-25C show various bottom perspective views of the illustrative single use disposable module of FIGS. 24A-24E.

(30) FIGS. 26A and 26B depict the operation of a flow mode selector valve according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(31) FIGS. 27A and 27B show various top views of the single use disposable module of FIGS. 19A-19C with the top off of illustrative organ chamber.

(32) FIGS. 28A-28C show various views of an exemplary hematocrit and oxygen saturation sensor of the type employed in the illustrative single use disposable module of FIGS. 19A-19C.

(33) FIG. 29A is a flow diagram depicting a donor-side process for removing an organ from a donor and placing it into the organ care system of FIG. 1 according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

(34) FIG. 29B is a diagram depicting a harvested heart with suture and cannulation sites according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.

- (35) FIG. **30** is a flow diagram depicting a recipient-side process for removing an organ from the organ care system of FIG. **1** and transplanting it into a recipient according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention.
- (36) FIG. **31** depicts a chart demonstrating electrolyte stability for an organ undergoing perfusion in forward mode according to an embodiment of the invention.
- (37) FIG. **32** depicts a chart demonstrating electrolyte stability for an organ undergoing perfusion in retrograde mode according to another an embodiment of the invention.
- (38) FIG. **33** depicts a chart demonstrating the arterial blood gas profile for an organ undergoing perfusion according to an embodiment of the invention.
- (39) FIG. **34** depicts a chart demonstrating adequate perfusion in a transplant organ.
- (40) FIG. **35** depicts a chart demonstrating inadequate perfusion in a transplant organ.

ILLUSTRATIVE DESCRIPTION

- (41) As described above in summary, the invention generally provides improved approaches to ex-vivo organ care. More particularly, in various embodiments, the invention is directed to improved systems, methods and devices relating to maintaining an organ in an ex-vivo portable environment. According to one improvement, the organ preservation system of the invention maintains a heart beating at or near normal physiological conditions. To this end, the system circulates an oxygenated, nutrient enriched perfusion fluid to the heart at near physiological temperature, pressure and flow rate. According to one implementation, the system employs a perfusion fluid solution that more accurately mimics normal physiologic conditions. In one embodiment, the perfusion fluid is blood-product based. In alternative embodiments, the solution is synthetic blood substitute based. In other embodiments the solution may contain a blood product in combination with a blood substitute product.
- (42) According to various illustrative embodiments, the improvements of the invention enable an organ, such as a heart, to be maintained ex-vivo for extended periods of time, for example, exceeding 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 18, 20, 22, 24 or more hours. Such extended ex-vivo maintenance times expand the pool of potential recipients for donor organs, making geographical distance between donors and recipients less important. Extended ex-vivo maintenance times of the invention also provide the time needed for better genetic and HLA matching between donor organs and organ recipients, increasing the likelihood of a favorable outcome. The ability to maintain the organ in a near physiologic functioning condition also enables a clinician to evaluate the organ's function ex-vivo, further increasing the likelihood of transplantation success. In some instances, the extended maintenance time enables medical operators to perform repairs on donor organs with minor defects. According to another advantage, the increased ex-vivo organ maintenance times of the invention enable an organ to be removed from a patient, treated in isolation ex-vivo, and then put back into the body of a patient. Such treatment may include, without limitation, surgical treatments, chemo-, bio-, gene and/or radiation therapies.
- (43) The illustrative systems, methods and devices of the invention are described below in the following order. First, the components of an illustrative organ care system **100** are described. Second, illustrative operation of the system **100** is discussed. Third, a subset of the components of the system **100** are described in further detail. Fourth, illustrative control systems and methods for the system **100** are discussed. Fifth, an illustrative user interface is described. Sixth, mechanical features of the system **100** are discussed in further detail with regard to an exemplary implementation. Seventh, exemplary methods for employing the system **100** during an organ harvest, transport, and transplantation procedure are described. Eighth, illustrative perfusion, nutritional and preservative solutions suitable for use with the system **100** are presented.
- (44) Turning to the illustrative embodiments, FIG. **1** depicts a schematic diagram of a portable organ care system **100** according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention. FIG. **2** shows a conceptual drawing of a heart **102**, which may be preserved/maintained ex-vivo by the organ care system **100** of the invention. Referring to FIGS. **1** and **2**, the illustrative system **100** includes an organ chamber assembly **104** for containing the heart **102** during ex-vivo maintenance, a reservoir **160** for holding, defoaming and filtering the perfusion fluid **108**, portal **774** for loading perfusion fluid **108** into the reservoir **160** and a portal **762** for applying therapeutics to the fluid **108** contained in the reservoir **160**, a perfusion fluid pump **106** for pumping/circulating perfusion fluid **108** to and from the harvested heart **102**; a heater assembly **110** for maintaining the temperature of the perfusion fluid **108** at or near physiological temperatures; a flow mode selector valve **112** for switching between normal and retrograde aortic flow modes (also referred to as “normal flow mode” and “retrograde flow mode,” respectively); an oxygenator **114** for re-oxygenating the perfusion fluid **108** subsequent to it being expelled by the heart **102**; a nutritional subsystem **115** for replenishing nutrients **116** in the perfusion fluid **108** as they are metabolized by the heart **102** and for providing additional preservatives **118** to the perfusion fluid to reduce, for example, ischemia and/or other reperfusion related injuries to the heart **102**. The illustrative system **100** also includes a plurality of sensors, including without limitation: temperature sensors **120**, **122** and **124**; pressure sensors **126**, **128**, **130** and **132**; perfusion flow rate sensors **134**, **136** and **138**; a perfusion fluid oxygenation sensor **140**; and sensor electrodes **142** and **144**, and defibrillation source **143**. The system **100** further includes: various components employed for maintaining suitable flow conditions to and from the heart **102**; an operator interface **146** for assisting an operator in monitoring operation of the system **100**, and the condition of the heart **102**, and for enabling the operator to select various operating parameters; a power subsystem **148** for providing fault tolerant power to the system **100**; and a controller **150** for controlling operation of the organ care system **100**.
- (45) Referring also to FIGS. **3** and **4**, according to the illustrative embodiment, the system **100** can maintain the heart **102** in two modes of operation—a normal flow mode, shown in FIG. **3**, and a retrograde flow mode shown in FIG. **4**. Generally, in the normal flow mode of FIG. **3**, the system **100** circulates the perfusion fluid **108** to the heart **102** in the same manner as blood would circulate in the human body. More particularly, referring to FIGS. **1-3**, the perfusion fluid enters the left atrium **152** of the heart **102** via the pulmonary vein **168**. The perfusion fluid **108** is flowed away from the right ventricle **154** via the pulmonary artery **164** and away from the left **156** ventricle via the aorta **158**. In normal flow mode, the system **100** pumps the perfusion fluid to the heart **102** at a near physiological rate of between about 1 liter/min and about 5 liters/minute. This mode is useful, for example, for performing functional testing to verify that the heart **102** is defect free, both prior and subsequent to transportation to a donor location.
- (46) Alternatively, in retrograde flow mode, shown in FIG. **4**, the system **100** flows the perfusion fluid **108** into the heart **102** via the aorta **158**, through the coronary sinus **155** and other coronary vasculature of the heart, and out of the right ventricle **154** of the heart **102** via the pulmonary artery **164**. As discussed in further detail below with regard to FIGS. **24A** and **24B**, the system **100** also provides a trickle flow **769** to the left atrium **152** through trickle valve **768**. The trickle flow is provided in an amount sufficient to moisten the left atrium **152** and left ventricle **156**. In certain applications the trickle flow is less than about 5 ml/min, less than about 1 ml/min, or less than about 0.1 ml/min. In this mode of operation, the system **100** reduces the flow rate of the perfusion fluid **108** to between about 300 milliliters/minute and about 1 liter/minute. The inventors have found that the retrograde flow path of FIG. **4**, along with the reduced flow rate, reduces damage to the heart **102** during extended periods of ex-vivo maintenance. Thus, according to one feature of the invention, the heart **102** is transported to a donor site in retrograde flow mode.
- (47) Having briefly described the normal and retrograde flow modes, the system **100** will next be described in further detail operationally. Referring once again to FIGS. **1-4**, in one practice, the heart **102** is harvested from a donor and cannulated into the organ chamber assembly **104**. The perfusion fluid **108** is prepared for use within system **100** by being loaded into the reservoir **160** via portal **774** and, optionally, being treated with therapeutics via portal **762**. The pump **106** pumps the loaded perfusion fluid **108** from a reservoir **160** to the heater assembly **110**. The heater assembly **110** heats the perfusion fluid **108** to or near a normal physiological temperature. According to one embodiment, the heater assembly **110** heats the perfusion fluid to between about 32 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C. The heater assembly **110** has an internal flow channel with a cross-sectional flow area that is approximately equal to the inside cross-sectional area of fluid conduits that carry the perfusion fluid **108** into and/or away from the heater assembly **110**, so as to minimize disturbance of fluid flow. From the heater assembly **110**, the perfusion fluid **108** flows to the flow mode selector valve **112**.
- (48) Initially, the flow mode selector valve **112** is positioned in retrograde mode to direct the perfusion fluid **108** from the heater assembly **110** into the organ chamber assembly **104** via a first interface **162**. Also referred to as an aorta interface or left ventricle interface, the interface **162** includes

cannulation to vascular tissue of the left ventricle via an aperture **228b** located on the organ chamber assembly **104** (as shown in FIGS. 5A-5B). As the heart **102** warms, it begins to beat which causes the heart **102** to pump the perfusion fluid **108** through the coronary vasculature **155** and out of the heart **102** through the right ventricle **154** via a second interface **166**. The second interface **166**, also referred to as a pulmonary artery interface or a right ventricle interface, includes cannulation to vascular tissue of the right ventricle via an aperture **228c** located on the organ chamber assembly **104** (as shown in FIGS. 5A-5B). As mentioned above, in retrograde flow mode, fluid is not actively pumped into or out of the left side of the heart, except for a relatively small trickle **769** of perfusion fluid, which is delivered to moisten the left atrium **152** and left ventricle **156**, as described below in reference to FIGS. 24A-24E.

(49) In response to the flow mode selector valve **112** being placed in the normal mode position, it directs the perfusion fluid **108** into the left atrium **152** of the heart **102** via a third interface **170**. The third interface **170**, also referred to as a pulmonary vein interface or left atrium interface, includes cannulation to vascular tissue of the left atrium **152** via an aperture **228a** located on the organ chamber assembly **104** (as shown in FIGS. 5A-5B). The heart **102** then expels the perfusion fluid **108** through the left ventricle **156** via the aorta interface **162** and through the right ventricle **154** via the pulmonary artery interface **166**.

(50) Each of the interfaces **162**, **166** and **170** may be cannulated to the heart **102** by pulling vascular tissue (e.g., an aorta stub) over the end of the interface, then tying or otherwise securing the tissue to the interface. The vascular tissue is preferably a short segment of a blood vessel (e.g., an aorta stub **158**) that remains connected to the heart **102** after the heart **102** is severed and explanted from the donor. For example, the aorta interface **162** is cannulated to a small segment of the severed aorta **158** which has been formed by severing the aorta **158** in a location downstream from the coronary sinus **155**. In certain applications, the short vessel segments may be about 5 to about 10 inches in length or longer. The segments may also be shorter than about 5 inches. The segments may be about 2 to about 4 inches in length, or about 1 to about 2 inches in length; in other applications the segments may be less than about ½ inch, or less than about ¼ inch.

(51) Alternatively, the cannulation may occur by affixing the interface directly to the applicable atrium or ventricle, as may be preferred in applications where the heart **102** is prepared for transplantation by severing an entire blood vessel without leaving any stub portion of the vessel connected to the heart **102**. For example, a left atrium **152** cannulation can be formed by inserting the interface **170** directly into the left atrium **152** and clamping the interface **170** in place, without the need to tie to any pulmonary vein **168** tissue.

(52) With continued reference to FIG. 1, in both flow modes the perfusion fluid **108** flows from the pulmonary artery interface **166** into the oxygenator **114**. The oxygenator **114** receives gas from an external or onboard source **172** through a gas regulator **174** and a gas flow chamber **176**, which can be a pulse-width modulated solenoid valve that controls gas flow, or any other gas control device that allows for precise control of gas flow rate. A gas pressure gauge **178** provides a visual indication of how full the gas supply **172** is. The transducer **132** provides similar information to the controller **150**. The controller **150** can regulate automatically the gas flow into the oxygenator **114** in dependence, for example, on the perfusion fluid oxygen content measured at the sensor **140**. According to various illustrative embodiments, the oxygenator **114** is a standard membrane oxygenator, such as the Liliput 2 manufactured by Dideco, a division of Sorin Biomedical, or the MINIMAX PLUS™ manufactured by Medtronic, Inc. In the illustrative embodiment, the gas includes an oxygen and carbon dioxide mixture. An exemplary composition of such a mixture contains about 85% O.sub.2, about 1% CO.sub.2, with the balance being N.sub.2. Subsequent to re-oxygenation, the oxygenator **114** returns the perfusion fluid **108** to the reservoir **160**. According to the illustrative embodiment, the sensor **140** measures the amount of light absorbed or reflected by the perfusion fluid **108** when applied at a multi-wavelength to provide an optical-based measurement of oxygen saturation. Since the perfusion fluid **108** is blood product based in certain embodiments, it may contain red blood cells (e.g., oxygen carrying cells). Accordingly, the sensor **140** also provides a signal **145** indicative of a hematocrit measurement of the perfusion fluid **108**. In alternative embodiments the solution **108** is formed of a synthetic blood substitute, while in other embodiments, the solution **108** may contain a blood product in combination with a blood substitute product.

(53) Also, in both flow modes, the nutritional subsystem **115**, including a supply of maintenance solutions **116/118** and an infusion pump **182**, infuses the perfusion fluid **108** with nutrients **116**, such as glucose, as the perfusion **108** solution flows through the system **100**, and in some embodiments, while it is in the reservoir **160**. The maintenance solutions **116/118** also include a supply of therapeutics and preservatives **118** for reducing ischemia and other reperfusion related injuries to the heart **102**.

(54) Both normal and retrograde flow modes are described in further detail below with reference to FIGS. 24A-26B.

(55) According to the illustrative embodiment, the system **100** is primed prior to introducing an organ into the organ chamber assembly **104**. During priming, a priming solution (described below) is inserted into the organ chamber **160** and pumped through the system **100**. In one exemplar application, the priming occurs for a period of between about 5 and about 20 minutes. The cannulation interfaces **162**, **166** and **170** in the organ chamber assembly **104** are bypassed to enable normal mode flow of perfusion fluid **108** through the system **100**, without the donor heart **102** being present. Blood (or a synthetic blood substitute) is then loaded into the reservoir **160**. The blood may be the blood exsanguinated from the donor during harvesting of the heart **102** or obtained from typed and cross-matched banked blood. The system **100** then circulates the blood (or blood substitute) through the system **100** to heat, oxygenate, and filter it. Nutrients, preservatives and/or other therapeutics are provided via the infusion pump **182** of the nutritional subsystem **115**. Various parameters may also be initialized and calibrated via the operator interface **146** during priming. Once the system **100** is running appropriately, the pump rate can be decreased or brought to zero, and the heart **102** can be cannulated into the organ chamber assembly **104**. The pump rate can then be increased. Priming of the system **100** is described in further detail below with reference to the flow diagram of FIG. 29A.

(56) As shown in FIG. 1, the system **100** also includes a plurality of compliance chambers **184**, **186** and **188**. The compliance chambers **184**, **186** and **188** are essentially small inline fluid accumulators with flexible, resilient walls designed to simulate the human body's vascular compliance by aiding the system in more accurately mimicking blood flow in the human body, for example, by providing flow back-pressure and/or by filtering/reducing fluid pressure spikes due, for example, to flow rate changes and/or the pumping of the pump **106**. According to the illustrative embodiment, the compliance chamber **184** is located between an output **112a** of the mode valve **112** and the reservoir **160** and operates in combination with an adjustable clamp **190** during normal flow mode to provide back pressure to the aorta **158** to cause perfusion fluid to flow into the coronary sinus **155** to feed the heart **102**. In the illustrative embodiment, the fluid back-pressure provided to the aorta **158** is between about 55 mmHg and about 85 mmHg, which is within an acceptable near-physiologic range of mean aortic blood pressure (which is typically between about 80 mmHg and about 100 mmHg). The back pressure to the aorta **158** aids the system **100** in simulating normal physiologic conditions. The compliance chamber **186** is located between an output **112b** of the mode valve **112** and the pulmonary vein cannulation interface **170** of the organ chamber assembly **104**. The primary function of the compliance chamber **186** is to provide back-pressure to the left atrium **152** and to smooth pressure/flow spikes caused from the pumping action of the perfusion fluid pump **106**, which delivers blood to the heart without causing substantial fluid pressure spikes. In the illustrative embodiment, the fluid back-pressure provided to the left atrium **152** is between about 0 mmHg to about 14 mmHg, which is approximately the same as the left atrial pressure under normal physiologic conditions. The compliance chamber **188** is located between an output of a one-way valve **310** and an inlet **110a** of the heater **110**. The primary function of the compliance chamber **188** is also to smooth pressure/flow spikes caused by the pumping action of the perfusion fluid pump **106** and to provide fluid back-pressure to the pulmonary artery **164**. In the illustrative embodiment, the fluid back-pressure provided to the pulmonary artery **164** is between about 0 mmHg and about 25 mmHg, which is within an acceptable near-physiologic range of mean arterial blood pressure (between about 0 mmHg and about 12 mmHg).

(57) The compliance chambers **184**, **186** and **188** provide the benefits described above through their size and shape and the materials used in their design. The chambers **184**, **186** and **188** are sized to contain about 20 ml to about 100 ml of fluid **108**, and they are shaped in an oval configuration to allow them to receive fluid **108** and expand to dampen pressure spikes and to provide back-pressure to the heart **102**. In certain applications, the material used for the chambers **184**, **186** and **188** includes at least one flexible membrane, selected so that the chambers have a Shore A durometer

hardness (ASTM D2240 00) of about 10 (more flexible) to about 60 (less flexible), with certain preferred embodiments having a hardness between about 30 ($\pm$ about 8) and about 50 ($\pm$ about 8). In the illustrative embodiment, the compliance chamber **184** has a Shore A hardness of about 50 ($\pm$ about 8) and the compliance chamber **186** has a Shore A hardness of about 30 ($\pm$ about 8). In the illustrative embodiment, the compliance chamber **188** has a dual-layered configuration, with an inner chamber having a Shore A hardness of about 50 ($\pm$ about 8) and an outer sleeve having a Shore A hardness of about 30 ($\pm$ about 8). Alternatively, the inner chamber can have a lower hardness (e.g., about 30, $\pm$ about 8) and outer sleeve can have a higher hardness (e.g., about 50, $\pm$ about 8).

(58) Having provided an operational overview of the system **100**, the organ chamber assembly **104**, the perfusion heater assembly **110**, and a pump head interface assembly **192** for interfacing with the pump **106** are next described in further detail. FIGS. 5A-5F depict various views of the illustrative organ chamber assembly **104** of FIG. 1. As shown most clearly in FIGS. 5A-5D, the organ chamber assembly **104** includes a housing **194**, an outer lid **196** and an intermediate lid **198**. The housing includes a bottom **194e** and one or more walls **194a-194d** for containing the heart **102**. The intermediate lid **198** covers an opening **200** to the housing **194** for substantially enclosing the heart **102** within the housing **194**. As most clearly shown in FIGS. 5E and 5F, the intermediate lid **198** includes a frame **198a** and a flexible membrane **198b** suspended within the frame **198a**. The flexible membrane **198b**, preferably, is transparent but may be opaque, translucent, or substantially transparent. According to one feature, the flexible membrane includes sufficient excess membrane material to contact the heart **102** when contained within the housing **195**. This feature enables a medical operator to touch/examine the heart **102** indirectly through the membrane **198b**, or apply an ultrasound probe to the heart **102** through the membrane **198b**, while maintaining sterility of the housing **195**. The membrane **198b** may be made, for example, from any suitable flexible polymer plastic, for example polyurethane. The membrane **198b** may also have integrated electrically conductive pads/contacts **199a** and **199b** through which electrical activity of the heart may be sensed via electrodes such as the electrodes **142** and **144**, and/or for through which defibrillation or pacing signals may be delivered, as described more fully below. Alternatively, the contacts **199a** and **199b** may be electrodes including all or a portion of the functionality of the electrodes **142** and **144**. As shown in FIG. 5C, the outer lid **196** opens and closes over the intermediate lid **198** independently from the intermediate lid **198**. Preferably, the outer lid **196** is rigid enough to protect the heart **102** from physical contact, indirect or indirect. The outer lid **196** and the chamber **194** may also be made from any suitable polymer plastic, for example polycarbonate.

(59) According to one implementation, the housing **194** includes two hinge sections **202a** and **202b**, and the intermediate lid frame **198a** includes two corresponding mating hinge sections **204a** and **204b**, respectively. The hinge sections **202a** and **202b** on the housing **194** interfit with the hinge sections **204a** and **204b** on the intermediate lid frame **198a** to enable the intermediate lid **198** to open and close relative to the opening **200** of the housing **194**. As shown most clearly in FIGS. 5D and 5F, the organ chamber assembly **104** also includes two latches **206a** and **206b** for securing the intermediate lid **198** closed over the opening **200**. As shown in FIGS. 5E and 5F, the latches **206a** and **206b** rotatably snap fit onto latch hinge section **208a** and **208b**, respectively, on the wall **194c** of the housing **194**. As shown most clearly in FIGS. 5A and 5E, the intermediate lid frame **198a** also includes a hinge section **210**. The hinge section **210** rotatably snap fits with a mating hinge section **212** on the outer lid **196** to enable the outer lid **196** to open without opening the intermediate lid **198**. As shown best in FIGS. 5B, 5D and 5F, the outer lid **196** also includes two cutouts **214a** and **214b** for enabling the latches **206a** and **206b** to clamp down on the edge **216** of the intermediate lid frame **198a**. As shown in FIGS. 5B, 5D and 5F, the organ chamber assembly **104** also includes a latch **218**, which rotatably snap fits onto a hinge part **220** on the wall **194c** of the housing **194**. In operation, the latch **218** engages a tab **221** on the edge **225** of the outer lid **196** to secure the outer lid **196** closed over the intermediate lid **198**.

(60) As shown most clearly in FIGS. 5E and 5F, the intermediate lid also includes two gaskets **198c** and **198d**. The gasket **198d** interfits between a periphery of the intermediate lid frame **198a** and a periphery of the outer lid **196** to form a fluid seal between the intermediate lid **198** and the outer lid **196** when the outer lid **196** is closed. The gasket **198c** interfits between an outer rim **194f** of the housing **194** and the intermediate lid frame **198a** to form a fluid seal between the intermediate lid **198** and the periphery **194f** of the housing **194** when the intermediate lid **198** is closed.

(61) Optionally, the organ chamber assembly **104** includes a pad **222** or a sac assembly sized and shaped for interfitting over an inner bottom surface **194g** of the housing **194**. Preferably, the pad **222** is formed from a material resilient enough to cushion the heart **102** from mechanical vibrations and shocks during transport, for example a closed-cell foam. According to one feature, the pad **222** includes a mechanism for adjustably positioning a pair of electrodes, such as the electrodes **142** and **144** of FIG. 1. According to the illustrative embodiment, the mechanism includes two through-apertures **224a** and **224b** for passing electrical leads from the underside of the pad **222** to corresponding electrodes **142** and **144** on the heart-contacting surface of the pad. Passing the electrical leads through the pad **222** to the electrodes **142** and **144** enables the electrodes **142** and **144** to be adjustably positioned within the pad **222** to accommodate variously sized hearts. In other embodiments, the mechanism may include, without limitation, one or more differently oriented slots, indentations, protrusions, through apertures, partially through apertures, hooks, eyelets, adhesive patches, or the like. In certain embodiments, the pad **222** may be configured with one or more sleeve-like structures that allow an electrode to be inserted within the pad **222**, thus providing a membrane-like surface of the pad **222** positioned between the electrode and the heart **102**.

(62) In some illustrative embodiments, the pad **222** is configured as a pad assembly, with the assembly including one or more electrodes, such as the electrodes **142** and **144**, adjustably located in or on the pad **222**. According to one advantage, the pad/electrode configuration of the invention facilitates contact between the electrodes and the heart **102** placed on the pad **222**, without temporarily or permanently suturing or otherwise mechanically connecting the electrodes to the heart **102**. The weight of the heart **102** itself can also help stabilize the electrodes during transport. According to the illustrative embodiment, the electrodes **142** and **144** include one or more sensors for monitoring one or more electrical signals from the heart and/or defibrillators for providing an electrical signal to the heart. As shown in FIGS. 1 and 5C, the organ chamber assembly **104** includes electrical interface connections **235a-235b**, which mount into the apertures **234a-234b**, respectively, in the wall **194b** of the housing **194**. A cover **226** is provided for protecting the electrical interface connections **235a-235b** when not being used.

(63) As described below in further detail with reference to FIG. 15, the interface connections **235a** and **235b** couple electrical signals, such as ECG signals, from the electrodes **142** and **144** out of the housing **194**, for example, to the controller **194** and/or the operator interface **146**. As described in further detail below with reference to FIG. 22A, the interface connections **235a** and **235b** may also couple to a defibrillation source, which may be either provided by external instrumentation or through circuitry within the system **100**, and which can send a defibrillation or pacing signal **143** through electrodes **142** and **144** to the heart **102**.

(64) As shown most clearly in FIGS. 5E and 5F, the organ chamber assembly **104** includes a resealable membrane interface **230**, which mounts in an interface aperture **232**. The interface **230** includes a frame **230a** and a resealable polymer membrane **230b** mounted in the frame **230a**. The membrane **230b** may be made of silicone or any other suitable polymer. In operation, the interface **230** is used to provide pacing leads, when necessary, to the heart **102**, without having to open the chamber lids **196** and **198**. The membrane **230b** seals around the pacing leads to maintain a closed environment around the heart **102**. The membrane **230b** also reseals in response to removing the pacing leads.

(65) As shown in FIGS. 5A and 5B, the organ chamber assembly **104** includes apertures **228a-228c** for receiving the aorta interface **162**, the pulmonary artery interface **166** and the pulmonary vein interface **170**, described above with reference to FIGS. 1-4, and below with reference to FIGS. 24A-28C. As shown in FIG. 5D, the organ chamber assembly **104** also includes a drain **201** for draining perfusion fluid **108** out of the housing **194** back into the reservoir **160**, and mounting receptacles **203a-203d** for mounting the organ chamber assembly **104** onto the single use module (shown at **634** in FIG. 19A).

(66) FIGS. 6A-6F depict various views of the perfusion fluid heater assembly **110** of FIG. 1. As shown in FIGS. 6A and 6B, the heater assembly **110** includes a housing **234** having an inlet **110a** and an outlet **110b**. As shown in both the longitudinal cross-sectional view of FIG. 6D and the lateral cross-sectional view of FIG. 6E, the heater assembly **110** includes a flow channel **240** extending between the inlet **110a** and the outlet **110b**. The heater assembly **110** may be conceptualized as having upper **236** and lower **238** symmetrical halves. Accordingly, only the upper half is shown in an exploded view in FIG. 6F.

(67) Referring now to FIGS. 6D-6F, the flow channel 240 is formed between first 242 and second 244 flow channel plates. The inlet 110a flows the perfusion fluid into the flow channel 240 and the outlet 110b flows the perfusion fluid out of the heater 110. The first 242 and second 244 flow channel plates have substantially bioinert perfusion fluid 108 contacting surfaces (which may contain a blood-product in certain embodiments) for providing direct contact with the perfusion fluid flowing through the channel 240. The fluid contacting surfaces may be formed from a treatment or coating on the plate or may be the plate surface itself. The heater assembly 110 includes first and second electric heaters 246 and 248, respectively. The first heater 246 is located adjacent to and couples heat to a first heater plate 250. The first heater plate 250, in turn, couples the heat to the first flow channel plate 242. Similarly, the second heater 248 is located adjacent to and couples heat to a second heater plate 252. The second heater plate 252 couples the heat to the second flow channel plate 244. According to the illustrative embodiment, the first 250 and second 252 heater plates are formed from a material, such as aluminum, that conducts and distributes heat from the first 246 and second 248 electric heaters, respectively, relatively uniformly. The uniform heat distribution of the heater plates 250 and 252 enables the flow channel plates to be formed from a bioinert material, such as titanium, reducing concern regarding its heat distribution characteristic.

(68) Referring particularly to FIGS. 6E and 6F, the heater assembly 110 also includes O-rings 254 and 256 for fluid sealing respective flow channel plates 242 and 244 to the housing 234 to form the flow channel 240.

(69) The heater assembly 110 further includes first assembly brackets 258 and 260. The assembly bracket 258 mounts on the top side 236 of the heater assembly 110 over a periphery of the electric heater 246 to sandwich the heater 246, the heater plate 250 and the flow channel plate 242 between the assembly bracket 258 and the housing 234. The bolts 262a-262j fit through corresponding through holes in the bracket 258, electric heater 246, heater plate 250 and flow channel plate 242, and thread into corresponding nuts 264a-264j to affix all of those components to the housing 234. The assembly bracket 260 mounts on the bottom side 238 of the heater assembly 110 in a similar fashion to affix the heater 248, the heater plate 252 and the flow channel plate 244 to the housing 234. A resilient pad 268 interfits within a periphery of the bracket 258. Similarly, a resilient pad 270 interfits within a periphery of the bracket 260. A bracket 272 fits over the pad 268. The bolts 278a-278f interfit through the holes 276a-276f, respectively, in the bracket 272 and thread into the nuts 280a-280f to compress the resilient pad 268 against the heater 246 to provide a more efficient heat transfer to the heater plate 250. The resilient pad 270 is compressed against the heater 248 in a similar fashion by the bracket 274.

(70) As mentioned with respect to FIG. 1, and as also shown in FIG. 6A, the illustrative heater assembly 110 includes temperature sensors 120 and 122 and dual-sensor 124. The dual sensor 124 in practice includes a dual thermistor sensor for providing fault tolerance, measures the temperature of the perfusion fluid 108 exiting the heater assembly 110, and provides these temperatures to the controller 150. As described in further detail below with respect to the heating subsystem 149 of FIG. 13, the signals from the sensors 120, 122 and 124 may be employed in a feedback loop to control drive signals to the first 246 and/or second 248 heaters to control the temperature of the heaters 256 and 248. Additionally, to ensure that heater plates 250 and 252 and, therefore, the blood contacting surfaces 242 and 244 of the heater plates 250 and 252 do not reach a temperature that might damage the perfusion fluid, the illustrative heater assembly 110 also includes temperature sensors/lead wires 120 and 122 for monitoring the temperature of the heaters 246 and 248, respectively, and providing these temperatures to the controller 150. In practice, the sensors attached to sensors/lead wires 120 and 122 are RTD (resistance temperature device) based. As also discussed in further detail with respect to FIG. 13, the signals from the sensors attached to sensors/lead wires 120 and 122 may be employed in a feedback loop to further control the drive signals to the first 246 and/or second 248 heaters to limit the maximum temperature of the heater plates 250 and 252. As a fault protection, there are sensors for each of the heaters 246 and 248, so that if one should fail, the system can continue to operate with the temperature at the other sensor.

(71) As described in further detail below with respect to FIG. 13, the heater 246 of the heater assembly 110 receives from the controller 150 drive signals 281a and 281b (collectively 281) onto corresponding drive lead 282a. Similarly, the heater 248 receives from the controller 150 drive signals 283a and 283b (collectively 283) onto drive lead 282b. The drive signals 281 and 283 control the current to, and thus the heat generated by, the respective heaters 246 and 248. More particularly, as shown in FIG. 7, the drive leads 282a includes a high and a low pair, which connect across a resistive element 286 of the heater 246. The greater the current provided through the resistive element 286, the hotter the resistive element 286 gets. The heater 248 operates in the same fashion with regard to the drive lead 282b. According to the illustrative embodiments, the element 286 has a resistance of about 5 ohms. However, in other illustrative embodiments, the element may have a resistance of between about 3 ohms and about 10 ohms. As discussed in more detail below with regard to FIGS. 11 and 13, the heaters 246 and 248 may be controlled independently by the processor 150.

(72) According to the illustrative embodiment, the heater assembly 110 housing components are formed from a molded plastic, for example, polycarbonate, and weighs less than about one pound. More particularly, the housing 234 and the brackets 258, 260, 272 and 274 are all formed from a molded plastic, for example, polycarbonate. According to another feature, the heater assembly is a single use disposable assembly.

(73) In operation, the illustrative heater assembly 110 uses between about 1 Watt and about 200 Watts of power, and is sized and shaped to transition perfusion fluid 108 flowing through the channel 240 at a rate of between about 300 ml/min and about 5 L/min from a temperature of less than about 30 degrees C. to a temperature of at least about 37 degrees C. in less than about 30 minutes, less than about 25 minutes, less than about 20 minutes, less than about 15 minutes or even less than about 10 minutes, without substantially causing hemolysis of cells, or denaturing proteins or otherwise damaging any blood product portions of the perfusion fluid.

(74) According to one feature, the heater assembly 110 includes housing components, such as the housing 234 and the brackets 258, 260, 272 and 274, that are formed from a polycarbonate and weighs less than about 5 lb. In other embodiments, the heater assembly may weigh less than about 4 lb, less than about 3 lb, less than about 2 lb, or even less than about 1 lb. In the illustrative embodiment, the heater assembly 110 has a length 288 of about 6.6 inches, not including the inlet 110a and outlet 110b ports, and a width 290 of about 2.7 inches. The heater assembly 110 has a height 292 of about 2.6 inches. The flow channel 240 of the heater assembly 110 has a nominal width 296 of about 1.5 inches, a nominal length 294 of about 3.5 inches, and a nominal height 298 of about 0.070 inches. The height 298 and width 296 are selected to provide for uniform heating of the perfusion fluid 108 as it passes through the channel 240. The height 298 and width 296 are also selected to provide a cross-sectional area within the channel 240 that is approximately equal to the inside cross-sectional area of fluid conduits that carry the perfusion fluid 108 into and/or away from the heater assembly 110. In one configuration, the height 298 and width 296 are selected to provide a cross-sectional area within the channel 240 that is approximately equal to the inside cross-sectional area of the inlet fluid conduit 792 (shown below with reference to FIG. 25C) and/or substantially equal to the inside cross-sectional area of the outlet fluid conduit 794 (shown below with reference to FIG. 24E).

(75) Projections 257a-257d and 259a-259d are included in the heater assembly 110 and are used to receive a heat-activated adhesive for binding the heating assembly to the multiple-use unit 650 (referenced in FIG. 20A).

(76) FIGS. 8A-8C show various views of a pump interface assembly 300 according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention. FIG. 9 shows a perspective view of a pump-driver end of the perfusion fluid pump assembly 106 of FIG. 1, and FIG. 10 shows the pump interface assembly 300 mated with the pump-driver end of the perfusion fluid pump assembly 106, according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention. Referring to FIGS. 8A-10, the pump interface assembly 300 includes a housing 302 having an outer side 304 and an inner side 306. The interface assembly 300 includes an inlet 308 and an outlet 310. As shown most clearly in the bottom view of FIG. 8B and the exploded view of FIG. 8C, the pump interface assembly 300 also includes inner 312 and outer 314 O-ring seals, two deformable membranes 316 and 318, a doughnut-shaped bracket 320, and half-rings 319a and 319b that fit between the o-ring 314 and the bracket 320. The half-rings 319a and 319b may be made of foam, plastic, or other suitable material.

(77) The inner O-ring 312 fits into an annular track along a periphery of the inner side 306. The first deformable membrane 316 mounts over the inner O-ring 312 in fluid tight interconnection with the inner side 306 of the housing 302 to form a chamber between an interior side of the first deformable membrane 316 and the inner side 306 of the housing 302. A second deformable membrane 318 fits on top of the first deformable

membrane **316** to provide fault tolerance in the event that the first deformable membrane **316** or tears. Illustratively, the deformable membranes **316** and **318** are formed from a thin polyurethane film (about 0.002 inches thick). However, any suitable material of any suitable thickness may be employed. Referring to FIGS. **8A** and **8B**, the bracket **320** mounts over the second deformable membrane **318** and the rings **319a** and **319b** and affixes to the housing **302** along a periphery of the inner side **306**. Threaded fasteners **322a-322i** attach the bracket **320** to the housing **302** by way of respective threaded apertures **324a-324i** in the bracket **320**. As shown in FIG. **8B**, the outer O-ring **314** interfits into an annular groove in the bracket **320** for providing fluid tight seal with the pump assembly **106**. Prior to inserting O-ring **314** into the annular groove in bracket **320**, the half-rings **319a** and **319b** are placed in the groove. The O-ring **314** is then compressed and positioned within the annular groove in bracket **320**. After being positioned within the annular groove, the O-ring **314** expands within the groove to secure itself and the half-rings **319a** and **319b** in place. (78) The pump interface assembly **300** also includes heat stake points **321a-321c**, which project from its outer side **304**. As described in further detail below with reference to FIGS. **21A-21C** and **24A-24C**, the points **321a-321c** receive a hot glue to heat-stake the pump interface assembly **300** to a C-shaped bracket **656** of the single use disposable module chassis **635**.

(79) As shown in FIG. **8C**, the fluid outlet **310** includes an outlet housing **310a**, an outlet fitting **310b**, a flow regulator ball **310c** and an outlet port **310d**. The ball **310c** is sized to fit within the outlet port **310d** but not to pass through an inner aperture **326** of the outlet **310**. The fitting **310b** is bonded to the outlet port **310d** (e.g., via epoxy or another adhesive) to capture the ball **310c** between the inner aperture **326** and the fitting **310b**. The outlet housing **310a** is similarly bonded onto the fitting **310b**.

(80) In operation, the pump interface assembly **300** is aligned to receive a pumping force from a pump driver **334** of the perfusion fluid pump assembly **106** and translate the pumping force to the perfusion fluid **108**, thereby circulating the perfusion fluid **108** to the organ chamber assembly **104**. According to the illustrative embodiment, the perfusion fluid pump assembly **106** includes a pulsatile pump having a driver **334** (described in further detail below with regard to FIG. **9**), which contacts the membrane **318**. The fluid inlet **308** draws perfusion fluid **108**, for example, from the reservoir **160**, and provides the fluid into the chamber formed between the inner membrane **316** and the inner side **306** of the housing **302** in response to the pump driver moving in a direction away from the deformable membranes **316** and **318**, thus deforming the membranes **316** and **318** in the same direction. As the pump driver moves away from the deformable membranes **316** and **318**, the pressure head of the fluid **108** inside the reservoir **160** causes the perfusion fluid **108** to flow from the reservoir **160** into the pump assembly **106**. In this respect, the pump assembly **106**, the inlet valve **191** and the reservoir **160** are oriented to provide a gravity feed of perfusion fluid **108** into the pump assembly **106**. At the same time, the flow regulator ball **310c** is drawn into the aperture **326** to prevent perfusion fluid **108** from also being drawn into the chamber through the outlet **310**. It should be noted that the outlet valve **310** and the inlet valve **191** are one way valves in the illustrated embodiment, but in alternative embodiments the valves **310** and/or **191** are two-way valves. In response to the pump driver **334** moving in a direction toward the deformable membranes **316** and **318**, the flow regulator ball **310c** moves toward the fitting **310b** to open the inner aperture **326**, which enables the outlet **310** to expel perfusion fluid **108** out of the chamber formed between the inner side **306** of the housing **302** and the inner side of the deformable membrane **316**. A separate one-way inlet valve **191**, shown between the reservoir **160** and the inlet **308** in FIG. **1**, stops any perfusion fluid from being expelled out of the inlet **308** and flowing back into the reservoir **160**.

(81) As discussed in further detail below with respect to FIGS. **18A-27B**, in certain embodiments the organ care system **100** mechanically divides into a disposable single-use unit (shown at **634** in FIGS. **19A-19C** and **24A-25C**) and a non-disposable multi-use unit (shown at **650** in FIG. **20A**). In such embodiments, the pump assembly **106** rigidly-mounts to the multiple use module **650**, and the pump interface assembly **300** rigidly mounts to the disposable single use module **634**. The pump assembly **106** and the pump interface assembly **300** have corresponding interlocking connections, which mate together to form a fluid tight seal between the two assemblies **106** and **300**.

(82) More particularly, as shown in the perspective view of FIG. **9**, the perfusion fluid pump assembly **106** includes a pump driver housing **338** having a top surface **340**, and a pump driver **334** housed within a cylinder **336** of the housing **338**. The pump driver housing **338** also includes a docking port **342**, which includes a slot **332** sized and shaped for mating with a flange **328** projecting from the pump interface assembly **300**. As shown in FIG. **10**, the top surface **340** of the pump driver housing **338** mounts to a bracket **346** on the non-disposable multiple use module unit **650**. The bracket **346** includes features **344a** and **344b** for abutting the tapered projections **323a** and **323b**, respectively, of the pump interface assembly **300**. The bracket **346** also includes a cutout **330** sized and shaped for aligning with the docking port **342** and the slot **332** on the pump driver housing **338**.

(83) Operationally, the seal between the pump interface assembly **300** and the fluid pump assembly **106** is formed in two steps, illustrated with reference to FIGS. **9** and **10**. In a first step, the flange **328** is positioned within the docking port **342**, while the tapered projections **323a** and **323b** are positioned on the clockwise side next to corresponding features **344a** and **344b** on the bracket **346**. In a second step, as shown by the arrows **345**, **347** and **349** in FIG. **9**, the pump interface assembly **300** and the fluid pump assembly **106** are rotated in opposite directions (e.g., rotating the pump interface assembly **300** in a counter clockwise direction while holding the pump assembly **106** fixed) to slide the flange **328** into the slot **332** of the docking port **342**. At the same time, the tapered projections **323a** and **323b** slide under the bracket features **344a** and **344b**, respectively, engaging inner surfaces of the bracket features **344a** and **344b** with tapered outer surfaces of the tapered projections **323a** and **323b** to draw the inner side **306** of the pump interface assembly **300** toward the pump driver **334** and to interlock the flange **328** with the docking ports **342**, and the tapered projections **323a** and **323b** with the bracket features **344a** and **344b** to form the fluid tight seal between the two assemblies **300** and **106**.

(84) Having described the illustrative organ care system **100** from a system, operational and component point of view, illustrative control systems and methods for achieving operation of the system **100** are next discussed. More particularly, FIG. **11** depicts a block diagram of an illustrative control scheme for the system **100**. As described above with reference to FIG. **1**, the system **100** includes a controller **150** for controlling operation of the system **100**. As shown, the controller **150** connects interoperationally with the following six subsystems: an operator interface **146** for assisting an operator in monitoring and controlling the system **100** and in monitoring the condition of the heart **102**; a data acquisition subsystem **147** having various sensors for obtaining data relating to the heart **102** and to the system **100**, and for conveying the data to the controller **150**; a power management subsystem **148** for providing fault tolerant power to the system **100**; a heating subsystem **149** for providing controlled energy to the heater **110** for warming the perfusion fluid **108**; a data management subsystem **151** for storing and maintaining data relating to operation of the system **100** and with respect to the heart **102**; and a pumping subsystem **153** for controlling the pumping of the perfusion fluid **108** through the system **100**. It should be noted that although the system **100** is described conceptually with reference to a single controller **150**, the control of the system **100** may be distributed in a plurality of controllers or processors. For example, any or all of the described subsystems may include a dedicated processor/controller. Optionally, the dedicated processors/controllers of the various subsystems may communicate with and via a central controller/processor.

(85) FIGS. **12-17J** illustrate the interoperation of the various subsystems of FIG. **11**. Referring first to the block diagram of FIG. **12**, the data acquisition subsystem **147** includes sensors for obtaining information pertaining to how the system **100** and the heart **102** is functioning, and for communicating that information to the controller **150** for processing and use by the system **100**. As described with respect to FIG. **1**, the sensors of subsystem **147** include, without limitation: temperature sensors **120**, **122** and **124**; pressure sensors **126**, **128**, and **130**; flow rate sensors **134**, **136** and **138**; the oxygenation/hematocrit sensor **140**; and electrodes **142** and **144**. The data acquisition subsystem **147** also includes: a set of Hall sensors **388** and a shaft encoder **390** from the perfusion pump assembly **106**; battery sensors **362a-362c** for sensing whether the batteries **352a-352c**, respectively, are sufficiently charged; an external power available sensor **354** for sensing whether external AC power is available; an operator interface module battery sensor **370** for sensing a state of charge of the operator interface module battery; and a gas pressure sensor **132** for sensing gas flow from the gas flow chamber **176**. How the system **100** uses the information from the data acquisition subsystem **147** will now be described with regard to the heating **149**, power management **148**, pumping **153**, data management **151**, and operator interface **146** subsystems, shown in further detail in FIGS.

13-17J, respectively.

(86) The heating subsystem **149** is depicted in the block diagram of FIG. **13**. With continued reference also to FIG. **1**, the heating subsystem **149** controls the temperature of the perfusion fluid **108** within the system **100** through a dual feedback loop approach. In the first loop **251** (the perfusion fluid temperature loop), the perfusion fluid temperature thermistor sensor **124** provides two (fault tolerant) signals **125** and **127** to the controller **150**. The signals **125** and **127** are indicative of the temperature of the perfusion fluid **108** as it exits the heater assembly **110**. The controller **150** regulates the drive signals **285** and **287** to the drivers **247** and **249**, respectively. The drivers **247** and **249** convert corresponding digital level signals **285** and **287** from the controller **150** to heater drive signals **281** and **283**, respectively, having sufficient current levels to drive the first **246** and second **248** heaters to heat the perfusion fluid **108** to within an operator selected temperature range. In response to the controller **150** detecting that the perfusion fluid temperatures **125** and **127** are below the operator-selected temperature range, it sets the drive signals **281** and **283** to the first **246** and second **248** heaters, respectively, to a sufficient level to continue to heat the perfusion fluid **108**. Conversely, in response to the controller **150** detecting that the perfusion fluid temperatures **125** and **127** are above the operator-selected temperature range, it decreases the drive signals **281** and **283** to the first **246** and second **248** heaters, respectively. In response to detecting that the temperature of the perfusion fluid **108** is within the operator-selected temperature range, the controller **150** maintains the drive signals **281** and **283** at constant or substantially constant levels.

(87) Preferably, the controller **150** varies the drive signals **281** and **283** in substantially the same manner. However, this need not be the case. For example, each heater **246** and **248** may respond differently to a particular current or voltage level drive signal. In such a case, the controller **150** may drive each heater **246** and **248** at a slightly different level to obtain the same temperature from each. According to one feature, the heaters **246** and **248** each have an associated calibration factor, which the controller **150** stores and employs when determining the level of a particular drive signal to provide to a particular heater to achieve a particular temperature result. In certain configurations, the controller **150** sets one of the thermistors in dual sensor **124** as the default thermistor and will use the temperature reading from the default thermistor in instances where the thermistors give two different temperature readings. In certain configurations, where the temperature readings are within a pre-defined range, the controller **150** uses the higher of the two readings. The drivers **247** and **249** apply the heater drive signals **281** and **283** to corresponding drive leads **282a** and **282b** on the heater assembly **110**.

(88) In the second loop **253** (the heater temperature loop), the heater temperature sensors **120** and **122** provide signals **121** and **123**, indicative of the temperatures of the heaters **246** and **248**, respectively, to the controller **150**. According to the illustrated embodiment, a temperature ceiling is established for the heaters **246** and **248** (e.g., by default or by operator selection), above which the temperatures of the heaters **246** and **248** are not allowed to rise. As the temperatures of the heaters **246** and **248** rise and approach the temperature ceiling, the sensors **121** and **123** indicate the same to the controller **150**, which then lowers the drive signals **281** and **283** to the heaters **246** and **248** to reduce or stop the supply of power to the heaters **246** and **248**. Thus, while a low temperature signal **125** or **127** from the perfusion fluid temperature sensor **124** can cause the controller **150** to increase power to the heaters **246** and **248**, the heater temperature sensors **120** and **122** ensure that the heaters **246** and **248** are not driven to a degree that would cause their respective heater plates **250** and **252** to become hot enough to damage the perfusion fluid **108**. According to various illustrative embodiments, the controller **150** is set to maintain the perfusion fluid temperature at between about 32 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C., or between about 34 degrees C. and about 36 degrees C. According to a further illustrative embodiment, the controller **150** is set to limit the maximum temperature of the heater plates **250** and **252** to less than about 38 degrees C., 39 degrees C., 40 degrees C., 41 degrees C., or 42 degrees C.

(89) As can be seen, the second loop **253** is configured to override the first loop **251**, if necessary, such that temperature readings from temperature sensors **120** and **122** indicating that the heaters **246** and **248** are approaching the maximum allowable temperature override the effect of any low temperature signal from the perfusion fluid temperature sensor **124**. In this respect, the subsystem **149** ensures that the temperature of the heater plates **250** and **252** do not rise above the maximum allowable temperature, even if the temperature of the perfusion fluid **108** has not reached the operator-selected temperature value. This override feature is particularly important during failure situations. For example, if the perfusion fluid temperature sensors **124** both fail, the second loop **253** stops the heater assembly **110** from overheating and damaging the perfusion fluid **108** by switching control exclusively to the heater temperature sensors **120** and **122** and dropping the temperature set point to a lower value. According to one feature, the controller **150** takes into account two-time constants assigned to the delays associated with the temperature measurements from the heaters **246** and **248** and perfusion fluid **108** to optimize the dynamic response of the temperature controls.

(90) FIG. **14** depicts a block diagram of the power management system **148** for providing fault tolerant power to the system **100**. As shown, the system **100** may be powered by one of four sources—by an external AC source **351** (e.g., 60 Hz, 120 VAC in North America or 50 Hz, 230 VAC in Europe) or by any of three independent batteries **352a-352c**. The controller **150** receives data from an AC line voltage availability sensor **354**, which indicates whether the AC voltage **351** is available for use by the system **100**. In response to the controller **150** detecting that the AC voltage **351** is not available, the controller **150** signals the power switching circuitry **356** to provide system power high **358** from one of the batteries **352a-352c**. The controller **150** determines from the battery charge sensors **362a-362c** which of the available batteries **352a-352c** is most fully charged, and then switches that battery into operation by way of the switching network **356**.

(91) Alternatively, in response to the controller **150** detecting that the external AC voltage **351** is available, it determines whether to use the available AC voltage **351** (e.g., subsequent to rectification) for providing system power **358** and for providing power to the user interface module **146**, for charging one or more of the batteries **352a-352c**, and/or for charging the internal battery **368** of user interface module **146**, which also has its own internal charger and charging controller. To use the available AC voltage **351**, the controller **150** draws the AC voltage **351** into the power supply **350** by signaling through the switching system **364**. The power supply **350** receives the AC voltage **351** and converts it to a DC current for providing power to the system **100**. The power supply **350** is universal and can handle any line frequencies or line voltages commonly used throughout the world. According to the illustrative embodiment, in response to a low battery indication from one or more of the battery sensors **362a-362c**, the controller **150** also directs power via the switching network **364** and the charging circuit **366** to the appropriate battery. In response to the controller **150** receiving a low battery signal from the sensor **370**, it also or alternatively directs a charging voltage **367** to the user interface battery **368**.

According to another feature, the power management subsystem **148** selects batteries to power the system **100** in order of least-charged first, preserving the most charged batteries. If the battery that is currently being used to power the system **100** is removed by the user, the power management subsystem **148** automatically switches over to the next least-charged battery to continue powering the system **100**.

(92) According to another feature, the power management subsystem **148** also employs a lock-out mechanism to prevent more than one of the batteries **352a-352c** from being removed from the system **100** at a given time. If one battery is removed, the other two are mechanically locked into position within the system **100**. In this respect, the system **148** provides a level of fault tolerance to help ensure that a source of power **358** is always available to the system **100**.

(93) The pumping subsystem **153** of FIG. **11** will now be described in further detail with reference to FIGS. **15** and **16**. More particularly, FIG. **15** is a conceptual block diagram depicting the illustrative pumping subsystem **153**, and FIG. **16** shows an exemplary ECG **414** of a heart **102** synchronized with an exemplary wave **385** depicting pumping output by the subsystem **153**. The ECG **414** shown in FIG. **16** has P, Q, R, S, T, and U peaks. The pumping subsystem **153** includes the perfusion fluid pump **106** interoperationally connected to the pump interface assembly **300**, as described in more detail above with reference to FIGS. **8A-10**. As shown in FIG. **15**, the controller **150** operates the pumping subsystem **153** by sending a drive signal **339** to a brushless three-phase pump motor **360** using Hall Sensor feedback. The drive signal **339** causes the pump motor shaft **337** to rotate, thereby causing the pump screw **341** to move the pump driver **334** up and/or down. According to the illustrative embodiment, the drive signal **339** is controlled to change a rotational direction and rotational velocity of the motor shaft **337** to cause the pump driver **334** to move up and down cyclically. This cyclical motion pumps the perfusion fluid **108** through the system **100**.

(94) In operation, the controller **150** receives a first signal **387** from the Hall sensors **388** positioned integrally within the pump motor shaft **337** to

indicate the position of the pump motor shaft 337 for purposes of motor winding current. The controller 150 receives a second higher resolution signal 389 from a shaft encoder sensor 390 indicating a precise rotational position of the pump screw 341. From the current motor commutation phase position 387 and the current rotational position 389, the controller 150 calculates the appropriate drive signal 339 (both magnitude and polarity) to cause the necessary rotational change in the motor shaft 337 to cause the appropriate vertical position change in the pump screw 341 to achieve the desired pumping action. By varying the magnitude of the drive signal 339, the controller 150 can vary the pumping rate (e.g., how often the pumping cycle repeats) and by varying the rotational direction changes, the controller 150 can vary the pumping stroke volume (e.g., by varying how far the pump driver 334 moves during a cycle). Generally speaking, the cyclical pumping rate regulates the pulsatile rate at which the perfusion fluid 108 is provided to the heart 102, while (for a given rate) the pumping stroke regulates the volume of perfusion fluid 108 provided to the heart 102.

(95) Both the rate and stroke volume affect the flow rate, and indirectly the pressure, of the perfusion fluid 108 to and from the heart 102. As mentioned with regard to FIG. 1, the system includes three flow rate sensors 134, 136 and 138, and three pressure sensors 126, 128 and 130. As shown in FIG. 15, the sensors 134, 136, and 138 provide corresponding flow rate signals 135, 137 and 139 to the controller 150. Similarly, the sensors 126, 128 and 130 provide corresponding pressure signals 129, 131 and 133 to the controller 150. The controller 150 employs all of these signals in feedback to ensure that the commands that it is providing to the perfusion pump 106 have the desired effect on the system 100. In some instances, and as discussed below in further detail with reference to FIGS. 17A-17J, the controller 150 may generate various alarms in response to a signal indicating that a particular flow rate or fluid pressure is outside an acceptable range. Additionally, employing multiple sensors enables the controller 150 to distinguish between a mechanical issue (e.g., a conduit blockage) with the system 100 and a biological issue with the heart 102.

(96) According to one feature of the invention, the pumping system 153 may be configured to control the position of the pump driver 334 during each moment of the pumping cycle to allow for finely tuned pumping rate and volumetric profiles. This in turn enables the pumping system 153 to supply perfusion fluid 108 to the heart with any desired pulsatile pattern. According to one illustrative embodiment, the rotational position of the shaft 337 is sensed by the shaft encoder 390 and adjusted by the controller 150 at least about 100 increments per revolution. In another illustrative embodiment, the rotational position of the shaft 337 is sensed by the shaft encoder 390 and adjusted by the controller 150 at least about 1000 increments per revolution. According to a further illustrative embodiment, the rotational position of the shaft 337 is sensed by the shaft encoder 390 and adjusted by the controller 150 at least about 2000 increments per revolution. The vertical position of the pump screw 341 and thus the pump driver 334 is calibrated initially to a zero or a ground position, corresponding to a reference position of the pump screw 341.

(97) According to the illustrative embodiment, the positional precision of the pumping subsystem 153 enables the controller 150 to precisely regulate the pumping of the perfusion fluid 108 through the heart 102. This process of synchronizing the pulsatile flow of the perfusion fluid to the heart's natural rate is referred to herein as "r-wave synchronization," which is described with continued reference to FIGS. 2, 15, and 16. A normally functioning heart has a two-phase pumping cycle-diastole and systole. During the diastolic phase, also known as the "resting phase," the heart's atria 157 and 152 contract, causing valves to open between the atria 157 and 152 and the ventricles 154 and 156 to allow blood to flow into and load the ventricles 154 and 156. During the systolic phase, the loaded ventricles eject the blood, and the atria 157 and 152 are opened and fill with blood. The cyclical expansion and contraction of the heart 102 during this process can be represented by graphing the heart's ventricular ECG wave form, shown at 414 in FIG. 16. FIG. 16 depicts the ECG waveform 414 synchronized with an exemplary wave 385 representative of a pumping output by the subsystem 153.

(98) The pumping subsystem 153 is configured to provide the maximum output at a time that will result in delivery of fluid 108 to the heart 102 at the most beneficial time. In the illustrated embodiment, in retrograde mode, the pumping subsystem 153 is configured to pump fluid 108 toward the heart 102 so that the maximum pump output 382 occurs during the diastolic phase of the heart, which begins after the S peak shown in FIG. 16 and is when the left ventricle 156 has finished ejecting perfusion fluid 108 through the aorta 158. Timing the pump output in this manner allows the user to maximize the injection of perfusion fluid 108 through the aorta 158 and into the coronary sinus 155. The timed pumping is accomplished by starting the pumping at point 377 on wave 385, which is a point prior to point 382 and corresponds to the peak of the heart's r-wave pulse 380 and the middle of ventricular systole. The point 377 is selected to account for time-delay between the time a signal is provided from the controller 150 to start pumping the fluid and the time of actual delivery of the pumped fluid 108 to the heart 102. In another example, during normal flow mode where the left side of the heart fills and ejects perfusion fluid (as described in more detail with reference to FIG. 24A), the controller 150 synchronizes the pumping subsystem 153 to start pumping at a fixed period of time after the r-wave 380, so as to match the natural filling cycle of the left atrium 152. The synchronization may be adjusted and fine-tuned by the operator through a pre-programmed routine in the operating software on the system 100 and/or by manually operating the controls of the user interface display area 410, as described in more detail below in reference to FIGS. 17A-17J.

(99) To achieve the synchronized pump output, the controller 150 predicts when the heart's r-wave pulses 380 will occur and causes the pump to pump at the appropriate time during the ECG 414. To make this prediction, the controller 150 measures the length various r-wave pulses 380 from the electrical signals 379 and 381 provided from the electrodes 142 and 144, respectively. From these pulses, the controller 150 tracks the time that elapses from one pulse 380 to the next, and uses this information to calculate a running average of the length of time separating two sequential r-wave pulses. From this information, the controller 150 projects the time of the next r-wave (and from the projection determines the time prior to or after that projected r-wave when the pumping should start to achieve optimal output delivery) by adding the average time separating two sequential r-wave pulses to the time of the previous r-wave 380. Based on this running average of separation time between r-waves, the controller 150 has the option to adjust the time of pump output in relation to subsequent r-waves, as reflected in the movement of wave 385 to the left or the right along the ECG 414 as signified by the arrow 383 in FIG. 16. Adjusting the wave 385 thus allows the user to adjust and customize the timing of output by the pump 106 so as to optimize the filling of the heart. In addition, the pump 106 may also be adjusted to increase or decrease the pump stroke volume to customize the volume of fluid 108 provided by the pump 106, and this may be done either in concert with or independent of the r-wave synchronization.

(100) It should be noted that although the subsystem 153 particularly synchronizes with the r-wave cycle 385, this need not be the case. In alternative illustrative embodiments, the subsystem 153 may pump in synchronicity with any available characteristic of the heart, including fluid pressures into or out of a particular chamber or vessel. Also, the subsystem 153 may be programmed to pump in any arbitrary pattern, whether periodic or not.

(101) Referring back to FIG. 11, the data management subsystem 151 receives and stores data and system information from the various other subsystems. The data and other information may be downloaded to a portable memory device and organized within a database, as desired by an operator. The stored data and information can be accessed by an operator and displayed through the operator interface subsystem 146.

(102) Turning now to the operator interface subsystem 146, FIGS. 17A-17J show various illustrative display screens of the operator interface subsystem 146. The display screens of FIGS. 17A-17J enable the operator to receive information from and provide commands to the system 100. FIG. 17A depicts a top level "home page" display screen 400 according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention. From the display screen 400 an operator can access all of the data available from the data acquisition subsystem 147 and can provide any desired commands to the controller 150. As described in more detail in reference to FIGS. 17B-17J, the display screen 400 of FIG. 17A also allows the operator to access more detailed display screens for obtaining information, providing commands and setting operator selectable parameters.

(103) With continued reference to FIG. 1, the display screen 400 includes a display area 402, which shows a number of numerical and graphical indications pertaining to the operation of the system 100. In particular, the display area 402 includes a numerical reading of the aorta output pressure (AOP) 404 of the perfusion fluid 108 exiting the aorta interface 162 on the organ chamber assembly 104, a wave form depiction 406 of the aortic fluid pressure (AOP) 404, and an AOP alarm image 408 indicating whether the fluid pressure 404 is too high or too low (the alarm 408 is shown as "off" in FIG. 17A). The display screen 400 also includes a display area 410 having a numerical indication 412 of the rate at which the heart 102 is

beating, an ECG **414** of the heart **102**, a heart rate (HR) alarm image **416** indicating whether the HR **412** exceeds or falls below operator set thresholds, and a time log **418** indicating how long the system **100** has been running, including priming time (discussed in further detail below with reference to FIG. **29A**). A numerical display **419** shows the amount of time for which the system **100** has been supporting the heart **102**. The indicator alarm **413** indicates when an operator preset time limit is exceeded.

(104) The display screen **400** includes a number of additional display areas **420**, **424**, **432**, **438**, **444**, **450**, **456**, **460**, **462**, **466**, **472**, **480**, and **482**. The display area **420** shows a numerical reading of the pulmonary artery pressure (PAP) **422**. The PAP **422** is an indication of the pressure of the perfusion fluid **108** flowing from the heart's pulmonary artery **164**, as measured by the pressure sensor **130**. The display area **420** also provides a PAP alarm indicator **424**, which signals when the PAP **422** is outside an operator preset range. The display area **426** indicates the temperature (Temp) **428** of the perfusion fluid **108** as it exits the heater **110**. The display area **426** also includes a Temp alarm indicator **430**, which signals in response to the Temp **428** being outside of an operator preset range. The upper limit of the operator preset range is shown at **427**. The display area **432** shows a numerical reading of the hematocrit (HCT) **434** of the perfusion fluid **108**, and an HCT alarm indicator **436** for signaling the operator if the HCT **434** falls below an operator preset threshold. The display area **438** shows the oxygen saturation (SvO.sub.2) **440** of the perfusion fluid **108**. The display area **438** also includes a SvO.sub.2 alarm **442** for indicating if the SvO.sub.2 **440** of the perfusion fluid **108** falls below an operator preset threshold. The display area **444** indicates the aorta output flow rate (AOF) **446** of the perfusion fluid **108** as it flows out of the aorta **158**. The AOF **446** is measured by the flow rate sensor **134**. The AOF alarm **448** indicates whether the flow rate **446** falls outside of an operator preset range. The display area **450** shows the organ chamber flow rate (CF) **452**. The CF **452** is an indication of the flow rate of the perfusion fluid **108** as it exits the organ chamber **104**, as measured by the flow rate sensor **136**. The display area **450** also includes a CF alarm **454**, which signals in response to the CF **454** falling outside of an operator preset range. The display area **456** includes a graphic **458** for indicating when a file transfer to the memory card is occurring.

(105) The display area **460** shows a graphical representation **459** of the degree to which each of the batteries **352a-352c** (described above with reference to FIG. **14**) is charged. The display area **460** also provides a numerical indication **461** of the amount of time remaining for which the batteries **352a-352c** can continue to run the system **100** in a current mode of operation. The display area **462** identifies whether the operator interface module **146** is operating in a wireless **464** fashion, along with a graphical representation **463** of the strength of the wireless connection between the operator interface module **146** and the remainder of the system **100**. The display area **462** also provides graphical indication **467** of the charge remaining in the operator interface module battery **368** (described above with reference to FIG. **14**) and a numerical indication **465** of the amount of time remaining for which the operator interface module battery **368** can support it in a wireless mode of operation. The display area **466** indicates the flow rate **468** of oxygen from the gas flow chamber **176**. It also provides a graphical indication **469** of how full an onboard oxygen tank is, and a numerical indication **470** of the amount of time remaining before the onboard oxygen tank runs out. The display area **472** shows the heart rate of the heart **102**, and the amount of time **476** for which the heart **102** has been cannulated onto the system **100**. This field is duplicative of the field **419** mentioned above. The display areas **480** and **482** show the current time and date, respectively, of operation of the system **100**.

(106) Actuating a dial (or mouse, or other control device), such as the dial **626** shown in FIG. **18A**, on the operator interface **146** opens a configuration menu **484**, such as shown in the display screen **401** of FIG. **17B**. As shown, accessing the configuration menu **484** covers the display areas **402** and **410** so they no longer show the graphical depictions of the pressure **406** and the heart rate **414**, but continue to display critical alpha/numeric information. As also shown, all other display areas remain unchanged. This enables an operator to adjust operation of the system **100** while continuing to monitor critical information. According to one feature, the configuration menu **484** allows the operator to pre-program desired operational parameters for the system **100**. Using the display screen **401**, the operator can view/edit working and diastolic (or retrograde) mode alarms by selecting the fields **488** and **490**, respectively. The operator can set particular ECG and LAP graphical options by selecting the fields **492** and **494**. Additionally, the operator can set oxygen flow rate and perfusion fluid temperature by selecting the fields **496** and **498**, respectively. Selecting the field **500** enables the operator to set the time and date, while selecting the field **502** enables the operator to select the language in which information is displayed. At the bottom of the display field **484**, the operator has the option to return **504** to the display screen **400**, cancel **506** any changes made to operational settings, save **508** the changes as new defaults, or reset **510** the operational settings to factory defaults.

(107) Referring to FIGS. **17C-17D**, selecting the view/edit working mode alarms field **488** causes the working mode alarm dialog **512** of FIG. **17D** to open within the display field **484** of FIG. **17C**. The working mode dialog **512** displays the parameters associated with normal flow mode (described above with reference to FIGS. **1** and **3**) and includes a field for setting numerical thresholds for each of the normal flow mode alarms. More specifically, the dialog **512** includes: CF alarm field **514**; PAP alarm field **516**; AOP alarm field **518**; LAP alarm field **520**; perfusion fluid Temp alarm field **524**; SvO.sub.2 alarm field **526**; HCT alarm field **528**; and HR alarm field **530**. By selecting a particular alarm field and actuating the up **532** and/or down **534** arrows, a operator can adjust the acceptable upper and/or lower thresholds for each of the parameters associated with each of the alarms. The dialog **512** also includes alarm graphics **536a-536i**, each of which being associated with a particular normal flow mode alarm. The operator can enable/disable any of the above normal flow mode alarms by selecting the associated alarm graphic **536a-536i**. Any changes made using the dialog **512** are reflected in corresponding fields in the display screen **400** of FIG. **17A**.

(108) Referring to FIGS. **17A**, **17B** and **17E**, selecting the view/edit non-working mode alarms field **490** causes the resting mode alarm dialog **538** of FIG. **17E** to open within the display field **484** of FIG. **17C**. The resting mode dialog **538** displays the parameters associated with retrograde flow mode (described above with reference to FIGS. **1** and **4**) and includes a field for setting numerical thresholds for each of the retrograde flow mode alarms. According to the illustrative embodiment, the available alarms for the normal and retrograde flow modes are similar, but not necessarily the same. Additionally, even for those that are the same, the thresholds may differ. Accordingly, the invention enables the operator to select different alarms and/or different thresholds for each flow mode of operation. More specifically, the dialog **538** includes: CF alarm field **540**; PAP alarm field **542**; AOF alarm field **544**; AOP alarm field **546**; LAP alarm field **548**; perfusion fluid Temp alarm field **550**; SvO.sub.2 alarm field **552**; HCT alarm field **556**; and HR alarm field **558**. By selecting a particular alarm field and actuating the up **560** and/or down **562** arrows, an operator can adjust the acceptable numerical upper and/or lower thresholds for each of the parameters associated with each of the alarms. The dialog **538** also includes alarm graphics **564a-564i**, each of which being associated with a particular normal flow mode alarm. The operator can enable/disable any of the above normal flow mode alarms by selecting the associated alarm graphic **564a-564i**. As is the case of the dialog **512**, any changes, made using the dialog **538** are reflected in corresponding fields in the display screen **400** of FIG. **17A**. In one implementation, the system **100** may be configured to automatically switch between sets of alarm limits for a given flow mode upon changing the flow mode.

(109) Referring to FIGS. **17A**, **17B**, **17F** and **17G**, the operator interface **146** also provides graphical mechanisms for adjusting various parameters. For example, as noted above in reference to FIG. **16**, one advantage of the user display area **402** is that it allows the operator to monitor (and adjust) the pumping of the subsystem **153**. Display area **410** identifies the ECG waveform **414** of the heart **102** and display **402** shows in wave form **406** the pressure of fluid flowing through the aorta. In these two displays the operator can monitor the effect of the pumping profile on the heart's ECG **414**, which allows the user to adjust the stroke volume of the pumping subsystem **153**, to adjust the rate of the pumping subsystem **153** (and thus the flow-rate of the fluid **108** being pumped through the system **100**), to manually impose, or adjust a time of, firing of the subsystem (e.g., by imposing a fixed delay between the r-wave **380** and the beginning of the pumping cycle), or to automatically program the pumping subsystem **153** to pump at a pre-determined time along the heart's ECG waveform **414**, as needed to properly fill the heart according to whether the heart is being perfused in retrograde or normal mode. These pumping adjustments may be made by use of the various graphical frames of the operator interface **146**. By way of example, in response to a operator selecting the ECG graphic frame option **492** located in the display field **484** of the display screen **401**, the operator interface **146** displays the dialog **568** of FIG. **17F**. The dialog **568** shows a graphical representation **572** of the ECG **414** along with a cursor **570**. The position of the cursor **570** indicates the point at which the pumping subsystem **153** will initiate an output pumping stroke (e.g., the portion of the

pumping cycle at which the pump motor **106** will push perfusion fluid **108** to the heart **102**. Relative to the ECG **414**, FIG. **1** shows a mechanical knob **626** (shown in FIGS. **18A** and **18B**) on the operator interface **146**, the operator moves the position of the cursor **570** to adjust when the pumping subsystem **153** will initiate the output pumping stroke relative to the r-wave pulse **380**. As described above with regard to FIGS. **15** and **16**, the pumping subsystem **153** receives an r-wave signal **380** from the ECG sensors **142** and **144**. The pumping subsystem **153** uses the r-wave signal **380** along with the pumping adjustment information from the cursor **570** to synchronize perfusion fluid pumping with the beating of the heart **102**. In another example, in response to the operator pressing the pump adjust button **625**, the operator interface **146** displays the dialog **574** of FIG. **17G**. From the dialog **574**, the operator can select the pointer **576** and rotate the knob **626** to turn the pump motor **106** on and off. Additionally, the operator can select the bar graphic **578** and rotate the knob **626** to adjust the volume of fluid being pumped, which is displayed in liters/minute.

(110) The operator interface **146** also provides a plurality of warning/reminder messages. By way of example, in FIG. **17H**, the operator interface **146** displays a message to remind the operator to connect to AC power to recharge the batteries. This message appears, for example, in response to the controller **150** detecting an impending low battery condition. The operator interface **146** displays the message of FIG. **17I** to confirm that the user wishes to enter standby mode and to remind the operator to insert a portable memory device, such as magnetic or optical disk, a portable disk drive, a flash memory card or other suitable memory device, to download and store information regarding a particular use of the system **100**. The operator interface **146** displays the error messages, such as the error message of FIG. **17J**, in response to an identifiable fault occurring. The error messages of FIG. **17J** include, for example, error information **580** to aid a service technician in diagnosing and/or repairing the fault.

(111) Having described an illustrative control systems and methods for achieving operation of the system **100**, illustrative mechanical features of the system **100** will now be discussed, along with an illustrative division of components between the single use disposable module **634** and multiple use module **650** units. More particularly, FIGS. **18A-18B** show a mechanical implementation **600** of the system of FIG. **1**, according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention. As shown, the illustrative implementation **600** includes a housing **602** and a cart **604**. The housing **602** conceptually divides into upper **602a** and lower **602b** housing sections, and includes front **606a**, rear **606b**, left **606c**, and right **606d** sides. The cart **604** includes a platform **608** and wheels **610a-610d** for transporting the system **600** from place to place. A latch **603** secures the housing **602** to the cart **604**. To further aid in portability, the system **600** also includes a handle **610** hinge mounted to the upper section **602a** of the left side **606c** of the housing **602**, along with two rigidly mounted handles **612a** and **612b** mounted on the lower section **602b** of the left **606c** and right **606d** sides of the housing **602**.

(112) The housing **602** further includes a removable top **614**, and a front panel **615** having an upper panel **613**, and a mid-panel **616** hinged to a lower panel **617** by hinges **616a** and **616b**. The top **614** includes handles **614a** and **614b** for aiding with removal. In the illustrated embodiment, the upper panel **613** is screwed, bolted or otherwise adjoined to the top **614**, such that removal of the top **614** also removes panel **613**.

(113) As shown in FIG. **18A**, the system **600** includes an AC power cable **618**, along with a frame **620** for securing the power cable **618**, both located on the lower section **602b** of the left side **606c** of the housing **602**. A software reset switch **622**, also located on the lower section **602b** of the left side **602c**, enables an operator to restart the system software and electronics.

(114) As shown in FIGS. **18A** and **18B**, the implementation **600** also includes the operator interface module **146**, along with a cradle **623** for holding the operator interface module **146**. The operator interface module **146** includes a display **624** for displaying information to an operator, for example, by way of the display screens of FIGS. **17A-17J**. As mentioned above, the operator interface module **146** also includes a rotatable and depressible knob **626** for selecting between the various parameters and display screens of FIGS. **17A-17J**. The knob **626** may also be used to set parameters for automatic control of the system **100**, as well as to provide manual control over the operation of the system **100**. For example, the knob **626** may be used to provide instructions to the controller **150** to increase perfusion fluid flow rates, gas flow rates, etc. As also discussed above with regard to FIGS. **1**, **14** and **17A-17J**, the operator interface module **146** includes its own battery **368** and may be removed from the cradle **623** and used in a wireless mode. While in the cradle **623**, power connections enable the operator interface module **146** to be charged. As shown, the operator interface module also includes control buttons **625** for controlling the pump, silencing or disabling alarms, entering or exiting standby mode, entering or adjusting ECG synchronization mode, and starting the perfusion clock, which initiates the display of data obtained during organ care.

(115) As shown in FIG. **18B**, the illustrative implementation **600** also includes a battery compartment **628** and an oxygen tank bay **630**, both located on the lower section **602b** of the right side **606d** of the housing **602**. As shown, the battery compartment **628** houses the three system batteries **352a-352c**, described above with regard to FIG. **14**. According to one feature, the battery compartment **626** includes three battery locks **632a-632c**. As described above with respect to FIG. **14**, the battery locks **632a-632c** interoperate mechanically so that only one of the three batteries **352a-352c** may be removed at any given time.

(116) The disposable module **634** and the multiple use unit **650** are constructed of material that is durable yet light-weight. In some illustrative embodiments, polycarbonate plastic is used to form one or more of the components of the units **634** and **650**. To further reduce the weight, the chassis **635** and the multiple use module chassis **602** are formed from low weight materials such as, for example, carbon fiber epoxy composites, polycarbonate ABS-plastic blend, glass reinforced nylon, acetal, straight ABS, aluminum or magnesium. According to one illustrative embodiment, the weight of the entire system **600** is less than about 85 pounds, including the multiple use module, heart, batteries, gas tank, and priming, nutritional, preservative and perfusion fluids, and less than about 50 pounds, excluding such items. According to another illustrative embodiment, the weight of the disposable module **634** is less than about 12 pounds, excluding any solutions. According to a further illustrative embodiment, the multiple use module **650**, excluding all fluids, batteries **352a-352c** and oxygen supply **172**, weighs less than about 50 pounds.

(117) With continued reference to FIGS. **19A-19C**, various views are shown of the implementation **600** of FIGS. **18A** and **18B** with the top **614** and upper front panel **613** removed and the front mid panel **616** open, according to an illustrative embodiment of the invention. With reference to FIGS. **19A-19C**, the system **100** is structured as a single use disposable module **634** (shown and described in detail below with reference to FIGS. **24A-25C**) and a multiple use module **650** (shown without the single use module in FIG. **20**). As discussed in further detail below, according to one feature of the illustrative embodiment, all of the blood contacting components of the system **100** are included in the single use disposable module **634** so that after a use, the entire single use module **634** may be discarded, a new module **634** installed, and the system **100** available for use again within a very brief amount of time.

(118) According to the illustrative embodiment, the single use module **634** includes a chassis **635** for supporting all of the components of the single use module **634**. As described in more detail with regard to FIGS. **24A-25C**, the components of the single use module **634** include the organ chamber assembly **104**, described above in detail with respect to FIGS. **5A-5F**, the perfusion fluid reservoir **160**, the oxygenator **114**, the perfusion fluid pump interface **300**, and all of the various fluid flow conduits and peripheral monitoring components **633**.

(119) As shown in FIGS. **19A-20A**, with the top **614** removed and the front panel **616** open, an operator has easy access to many of the components of the disposable **634** and multiple use **650** modules. For example, the operator may install, remove and view the levels of the nutrient **116** and preservative **118** supplies of the nutritional subsystem **115**. The operator may also control operation of the nutrient **116** and preservative **118** infusion pump **182**. The operator may also cannulate an organ, such as the heart **102**, into the organ chamber assembly **104**. As described in detail below with reference to FIGS. **21A-21C**, this configuration also provides the operator with sufficient access to install and/or remove the single use module **634** to/from the multiple use module **650**.

(120) FIG. **20A** shows a front perspective view of the multiple use module **650** with the single use module **634** removed. As shown, the multiple use module **650** includes: the cart **604**; the lower section **602b** of the housing **602**, along with all of the components externally mounted to it, along with those contained therein (described in further detail below, with reference to FIGS. **21A-21C** and **23A-23C**); the upper section **602a** of the housing **602** and all of the components externally mounted to it, including the top cover **614**, the handles **610**, **612a**, and **612b**, and the front panel **616**; the operator interface module **146**; and the perfusion fluid pump motor assembly **106**. As described in detail below with reference to FIGS. **21A-21C**, the multiple use module **650** also includes a bracket assembly **638** for receiving and locking into place the single use module **634**.

(121) As shown in FIG. 20A, and described in further detail below with reference to FIGS. 22A-22C, the multiple use module 650 also includes a front-end interface circuit board 636 for interfacing with a front-end circuit board (shown in FIG. 24D at 637) of the disposable module 634. As also described in detail with reference to FIGS. 22A-22C, power and drive signal connections between the multiple use module 650 and the disposable module 634 are made by way of corresponding electromechanical connectors 640 and 647 on the front-end interface circuit board 636 and the front-end circuit board 637, respectively. By way of example, the front-end circuit board 637 receives power for the disposable module 634 from the front-end interface circuit board 636 via the electromechanical connectors 640 and 647. The front-end circuit board 637 also receives drive signals for various components (e.g., the heater assembly 110, and the oxygenator 114) from the controller 150 via the front-end interface circuit board 636 and the electromechanical connectors 640 and 647. The front-end circuit board 637 and the front-end interface circuit board 636 exchange control and data signals (e.g., between the controller 150 and the disposable module 134) by way of optical connectors (shown in FIG. 22B at 648). As described in more detail with reference to FIGS. 22A-22F, the connector configuration employed between the front-end 637 and front-end interface 636 circuit boards ensures that critical power and data interconnections between the single and multiple use modules 634 and 650, respectively, continue to operate even during transport over rough terrain, such as may be experienced during organ transport.

(122) As shown in FIG. 20A, according to another feature, the upper section 602a of the housing 602 includes a fluid tight basin 652, which is configured to capture any perfusion fluid 108 and/or nutritional 116 and/or preservative 118 solution that may inadvertently leak. The basin 652 also prevents any leaked fluid 108 or solution 116/118 from passing into the lower section 602b of the housing 602. In this way, the basin 652 shields the electronic components of the system 100 from any such leaked fluid 108 or solution 116/118. Shielded components include, for example, the power board 720 shown in and discussed in further detail below with reference to FIGS. 23C and 23D. The basin 652 includes a section 658, which extends over and shields the perfusion fluid pump 106 from any inadvertently leaked fluid. According to another feature, the basin 652 is sized to accommodate the entire volume of perfusion fluid 108 (including the maintenance solutions 116/118) contained within the system 100 at any particular time.

(123) Referring also to FIG. 20B, according to a further feature of the illustrative embodiment, an outer side 659 of the pump covering portion 658 of the basin 652 includes a slot 660. As described in further detail below with reference to FIGS. 21A-21C and 24A, the slot 660 engages with a projection 662 on the single use module 634 during installation of the single use module 634 into the multiple use module 650.

(124) Turning now to the installation of the single use module 634 into the multiple use module 650, FIG. 21A shows a detailed view of the above-mentioned bracket assembly 638 located on the multiple use module 650 for receiving and locking into place the single use module 634. FIG. 21B shows a side perspective view of the single use module 634 being installed onto the bracket assembly 638 and into the multiple use module 650, and FIG. 21C shows a side view of the single use module 634 installed within the multiple use module 650. With reference to FIGS. 21A and 21B, the bracket assembly 638 includes two mounting brackets 642a and 642b, which mount to an internal side of a back panel 654 of the upper housing section 602a via mounting holes 644a-644d and 646a-646d, respectively. A cross bar 641 extends between and rotatably attaches to the mounting brackets 642a and 642b. Locking arms 643 and 645 are spaced apart along and radially extend from the cross bar 641. Each locking arm 643 and 645 includes a respective downward extending locking projection 643a and 645b. A lever 639 attaches to and extends radially upward from the cross bar 641. Actuating the lever 639 in the direction of the arrow 651 rotates the locking arms 643 and 645 toward the back 606b of the housing 602. Actuating the lever 639 in the direction of the arrow 653 rotates the locking arms 643 and 645 toward the front 606a of the housing 602.

(125) As described above with respect to FIG. 10, the perfusion pump interface assembly 300 includes four projecting heat staking points 321a-321d. As shown in FIG. 24A, during assembly, the projections 321a-321d are aligned with corresponding apertures 657a-657d and heat staked through the apertures 657a-657d into the projections 321a-321d to rigidly mount the outer side 304 of the pump interface assembly 300 onto the C-shaped bracket 656 of the single use module chassis 635.

(126) With reference to FIGS. 10, 20B, 21A, 21B and 24A, during installation, in a first step, the single use module 634 is lowered into the multiple use module 650 while tilting the single use module 634 forward (shown in FIG. 21B). This process slides the projection 662 of FIG. 24A into the slot 660 of FIG. 20B. As shown in FIG. 10, it also positions the flange 328 of the pump interface assembly 300 within the docking port 342 of the perfusion pump assembly 106, and the tapered projections 323a and 323b of the pump interface assembly 300 on the clockwise side of corresponding ones of the features 344a and 344b of the pump assembly bracket 346. In a second step, the single use module 634 is rotated backwards until locking arm cradles 672 and 674 of the single use module chassis 635 engage projections 643 and 645 of spring-loaded locking arm 638, forcing the projections 643 and 645 to rotate upward (direction 651), until locking projections 643a and 645a clear the height of the locking arm cradles 672 and 674, at which point the springs cause the locking arm 638 to rotate downward (direction 653), allowing locking projections 643a and 645a to releasably lock with locking arm cradles 672 and 674 of the disposable module chassis 635. This motion causes the curved surface of 668 of the disposable module chassis projection 662 of FIG. 24A to rotate and engage with a flat side 670 of the basin slot 660 of FIG. 20B. Lever 639 can be used to rotate the locking arm 638 upwards (direction 651) to release the single use module 635.

(127) As shown in FIG. 10, this motion also causes the pump interface assembly 300 to rotate in a counterclockwise direction relative to the pump assembly 106 to slide the flange 328 into the slot 332 of the docking port 342, and at the same time, to slide the tapered projections 323a and 323b under the respective bracket features 344a and 344b. As the tapered projections 323a and 323b slide under the respective bracket features 344a and 344b, the inner surfaces of the bracket features 344a and 344b engage with the tapered outer surfaces of the tapered projections 323a and 323b to draw the inner side 306 of the pump interface assembly 300 toward the pump driver 334 to form the fluid tight seal between the pump interface assembly 300 and the pump assembly 106. The lever 639 may lock in place to hold the disposable module 634 securely within the multiple use module 650.

(128) As mentioned briefly above with reference to FIG. 20A, interlocking the single use module 374 into the multiple use module 650 forms both electrical and optical interconnections between the front-end interface circuit board 636 on the multiple use module 650 and the front-end circuit board 637 on the single use module 634. The electrical and optical connections enable the multiple use module 650 to power, control and collect information from the single module 634. FIG. 22A is a conceptual drawing showing various optical couplers and electromechanical connectors on the front-end circuit board 637 of the single-use disposable module 634 used to communicate with corresponding optical couplers and electromechanical connectors on the front-end interface circuit board 636 of the multiple use module 650. Since this correspondence is one for one, the various optical couplers and electromechanical connectors are described only with reference to the front-end circuit board 637, rather than also depicting the front-end circuit board 650.

(129) According to the illustrative embodiment, the front-end circuit board 637 receives signals from the front-end interface circuit board 636 via both optical couplers and electromechanical connectors. For example, the front-end circuit board 637 receives power 358 (also shown in FIG. 14) from the front-end interface circuit board 636 via the electromechanical connectors 712 and 714. The front-end circuit board 637 the power to the components of the single use module 634, such as the various sensors and transducers of the single use module 634. Optionally, the front-end circuit board 637 converts the power to suitable levels prior to distribution. The front-end interface circuit board 636 also provides the heater drive signals 281a and 281b of FIG. 13 to the applicable connections 282a on the heater 246 of FIG. 6E via the electromechanical connectors 704 and 706. Similarly, the electromechanical connectors 708 and 710 couple the heater drive signals 283a and 283b of FIG. 13 to the applicable connections in 282b of the heater 248. The front-end circuit board 637 may receive a defibrillation command from the front-end interface circuit board 636 via the electromechanical connector 687. In response, the front-end circuit board 637 generates the defibrillation signal 143 having suitable current and voltage levels, and as shown in FIG. 5E, couples the signal 143 to the organ chamber assembly 104 via the electrical interface connections 235a-235b.

(130) In another illustrative embodiment, the defibrillation command can be provided from an external source (not shown), rather than through the

circuit board **636**. As an example, with reference to FIG. 5E and FIG. 1, an external defibrillation device can be plugged into the electrical coupler **613** shown in FIG. 24E, which is connected to the electrical interface connections **235a-235b**. The external defibrillation device sends a defibrillation signal **143** through the coupler **613** and the interface connections **235a** and **235b** to electrodes **142** and **144**. The electrodes **142** and **144** then deliver the signal **143** to the heart **102**. This alternative embodiment allows the user to provide defibrillation (and pacing) without passing the signal **143** through the circuit boards **618**, **636**, and **637**. An exemplary external defibrillation device may include the Zoll M-Series Portable Defibrillator.

(131) According to the illustrative embodiment, the front-end circuit board **637** receives signals from temperature, pressure, fluid flow-rate, oxygenation/hematocrit and ECG sensors, amplifies the signals, converts the signals to a digital format and provides them to the front-end interface circuit board **636** by way of optical couplers. For example, the front-end circuit board **637** provides the temperature signal **121** from the sensor **120** on the heater plate **250** (shown in FIGS. 6A and 13) to the front-end interface circuit board **636** by way of the optical coupler **676**. Similarly, the front-end circuit board **637** provides the temperature signal **123** from the sensor **122** on the heater plate **252** (shown in FIGS. 6A and 13) to the front-end interface circuit board **636** by way of the optical coupler **678**. The front-end circuit board **637** also provides the perfusion fluid temperature signals **125** and **127** from the thermistor sensor **124** (shown in FIGS. 6A and 13) to the front-end interface circuit board **636** via respective optical couplers **680** and **682**. Perfusion fluid pressure signals **129**, **131** and **133** are provided from respective pressure transducers **126**, **128** and **130** to the front-end interface circuit board **636** via respective optical couplers **688**, **690** and **692**. The front-end circuit board **637** also provides perfusion fluid flow rate signals **135**, **137** and **139** from respective flow rate sensors **134**, **136** and **138** to the front-end interface circuit board **636** by way of respective optical couplers **694**, **696** and **698**. Additionally, the front-end circuit board **637** provides the oxygen saturation **141** and hematocrit **145** signals from the oxygen saturation sensor **140** to the front-end interface circuit board **636** by way of respective optical couplers **700** and **702**.

(132) In other illustrative embodiments, one or more of the foregoing sensors are wired directly to the main system board **718** (described below with reference to FIG. 23D) for processing and analysis, thus by-passing the front-end interface board **636** and front-end board **637** altogether. Such embodiments may be desirable where the user prefers to re-use one or more of the sensors prior to disposal. In one such example, the flow rate sensors **134**, **136** and **138** and the oxygen and hematocrit sensor **140** are electrically coupled directly to the system main board **718** through electrical coupler **611** shown in FIG. 23C, thus by-passing any connection with the circuit boards **636** and **637**.

(133) As described above with respect to FIGS. 11-16, the controller **150** employs the signals provided to the front-end interface circuit board **636**, along with other signals, to transmit data and otherwise control operation of the system **100**. As described with respect to FIGS. 17A-17J, the controller **150** also displays sensor information, and may display to the operator various alarms relating to the sensor information by way of the operator interface module **146**.

(134) FIG. 22B illustrates the operation of an exemplary electromechanical connector pair of the type employed for the electrical interconnections between the circuit boards **636** and **637**. Similarly, FIG. 22C illustrates the operation of an optical coupler pair of the type employed for the optically coupled interconnections between the circuit boards **636** and **637**. One advantage of both the electrical connectors and optical couplers employed is that they ensure connection integrity, even when the system **100** is being transported over rough terrain, for example, such as being wheeled along a tarmac at an airport, being transported in an aircraft during bad weather conditions, or being transported in an ambulance over rough roadways. Additionally, the optical couplers electrically isolate the temperature, pressure and ECG sensors from the rest of the system **100**, which prevents a defibrillation signal from damaging the system **100**. The power for the front-end board **637** is isolated in a DC power supply located on the front-end interface board **636**.

(135) As shown in FIG. 22B, the electromechanical connectors, such as the connector **704**, include a portion, such as the portion **703**, located on the front-end interface circuit board **636** and a portion, such as the portion **705**, located on the front-end circuit board **637**. The portion **703** includes an enlarged head **703a** mounted on a substantially straight and rigid stem **703b**. The head **703** includes an outwardly facing substantially flat surface **708**. The portion **705** includes a substantially straight and rigid pin **705** including an end **705a** for contacting the surface **708** and a spring-loaded end **705b**. Pin **705** can move axially in and out as shown by the directional arrow **721** while still maintaining electrical contact with the surface **708** of the enlarged head **703a**. This feature enables the single use module **634** to maintain electrical contact with the multiple use module **650** even when experiencing mechanical disturbances associated with transport over rough terrain. An advantage of the flat surface **708** is that it allows for easy cleaning of the interior surface of the multiple use module **650**. According to the illustrative embodiment, the system **100** employs a connector for the electrical interconnection between the single use disposable **634** and multiple use **650** modules. An exemplary connector is part no. 101342 made by Interconnect Devices. However, any suitable connector may be used.

(136) Optical couplers, such as the optical couplers **684** and **687** of the front-end circuit board **637**, are used and include corresponding counterparts, such as the optical couplers **683** and **685** of the front-end interface circuit board **636**. The optical transmitters and optical receiver portions of the optical couplers may be located on either circuit board **636** or **637**. For example, in the case of the ECG signal **379**, the optical transmitter **684** is located on the circuit board **637** for receiving the electrical signal **379** and optically coupling it to the optical receiver **683** on the circuit board **636**. In the case where the defibrillator signal is transmitted through the circuit boards **636** and **637** (rather than directly to the main board **718**), the optical transmitter **685** on the circuit board **636** optically couples the signal to the optical receiver **687** on the circuit board **637**.

(137) As in the case of the electromechanical connectors employed, allowable tolerance in the optical alignment between the optical transmitters and corresponding optical receivers enables the circuit boards **636** and **637** to remain in optical communication even during transport over rough terrain. According to the illustrative embodiment, the system **100** uses optical couplers made under part nos. 5FH485P and/or 5FH203PFA by Osram. However, any suitable coupler may be used.

(138) The couplers and connectors facilitate the transmission of data within the system **100**. The front-end interface circuit board **636** and the front-end board **637** transmit data pertaining to the system **100** in a paced fashion. As shown in FIG. 22C, circuit board **636** transmits to the front-end board **637** a clock signal that is synchronized to the clock on the controller **150**. The front-end circuit board **637** receives this clock signal and uses it to synchronize its transmission of system data (such as temperatures, pressures, ECG, r-wave detection, or other desired information) with the clock cycle of the controller **150**. This data is digitized by a processor on the front-end circuit board **637** according to the clock signal and a pre-set sequence of data type and source address (i.e., type and location of the sensor providing the data). The front-end interface circuit board **636** receives the data from the front-end board **637** and transmits the data set to the main board **618** for use by the controller **150** in evaluation, display, and system control, as described above with reference to FIGS. 11, 12 and 14. Additional optical couplers can be added between the multiple use module and single use module for transmission of control data from the multiple use module to the single use module, such data including heater control signals or pump control signals.

(139) Having described the mechanical, electrical and optical interconnections between the single use module **634** and the multiple use module **650**, additional components of the multiple use module **650** will now be discussed with respect to FIGS. 23A-23D, followed by a description of the mechanical arrangement of the components of the single use module **634** with respect to FIGS. 24A-28C. As shown in FIGS. 23A-23D, with the walls of the housing **602** removed, in addition to those components previously discussed, the multiple use module **650** includes an onboard gas supply **172**, located in the lower section **602b** of the housing **602**. The gas supply **172** is depicted in FIGS. 23A-23D as a tank, positioned within the gas tank bay **630** by a support structure **712**, which abuts the tank **172**. Optionally, the gas supply **172** may be further secured within the gas tank bay **630** by a strap and buckle assembly **714** or other suitable mechanism. With particular reference to FIG. 23B and as described above with reference to FIG. 1, the gas supply **172** provides gas to the system **100** through the gas regulator **174** and the gas flow chamber **176**. The gas pressure sensor **132** measures the gas pressure in the gas supply **172**, and the gas pressure gauge **178** provides a visual indication of the fullness of the gas supply **172**. Additionally, an electrical connection between the controller **150** and the gas flow chamber **176** enables the controller **150** to regulate automatically

the gas flow into the oxygenator **114**.

(140) As shown most clearly in FIG. 23C, the battery bay **628** houses the batteries **352a-352c**. As noted above with reference to FIG. 14, a lock-out mechanism is used to prevent more than one of the batteries **352a-352c** from being removed from the battery bay **628** at a given time while the system **100** is operating.

(141) As discussed above, the system **100** includes a plurality of interconnected circuit boards for facilitating power distribution and data transmission to, from and within the system **100**. Particularly, as discussed above with reference to FIGS. 22A-22E and as shown in FIG. 23C, the multiple use module **650** includes a front-end interface circuit board **636**, which optically and electromechanically couples to the front-end circuit board **637** of the single use module **650**. As also shown in FIG. 23C, the system **100** further includes a main board **718**, a power circuit board **720**, and a battery interface board **711** located on the multiple use module **650**. The main board **718** is configured to allow the system **100** to be fault tolerant, in that if a fault arises in the operation of a given circuit board (as shown in FIG. 23D), the main board **718** saves pumping and heating parameters in non-volatile memory. When the system **100** reboots, it can re-capture and continue to perform according to such parameters.

(142) Referring to the conceptual drawing of FIG. 23D, cabling **731** brings power (such as AC power **351**) from a power source **350** to the power circuit board **720** by way of connectors **744** and **730**. The power supply **350** converts the AC power to DC power and distributes the DC power as described above with reference to the power subsystem of FIG. 14. Referring also to FIGS. 14 and 22A, the power circuit board **720** couples DC power and a data signal **358** via respective cables **727** and **729** from the connectors **726** and **728** to corresponding connectors **713** and **715** on the front-end interface circuit board **636**. Cable **729** carries both power and a data signal to the front-end interface board **636**. Cable **727** carries power to the heater **110** via the front-end interface board **636**. The connectors **713** and **715** interfit with corresponding connectors **712** and **714** (described above with respect to FIG. 22A) on the front-end circuit board **637** on the single use module **634** to provide power to the single use module **634**.

(143) As shown in FIG. 23D, the power circuit board **720** also provides DC power **358** and a data signal from the connectors **732** and **734**, respectively, on the power circuit board **720** to corresponding connectors **736** and **738** on the main circuit board **718** by way of the cables **733** and **735**. Referring also to FIGS. 14 and 19A, the cable **737** couples DC power **358** and a data signal from a connector **740** on the main circuit board **718** to the operator interface module **146** by way of a connector **742** on the operator interface module cradle **623**. The power circuit board **720** also provides DC power **358** and a data signal from connectors **745** and **747** via cables **741** and **743** to connectors **749** and **751** on a battery interface board **711**. Cable **741** carries the DC power signal and cable **743** carries the data signal. Battery interface board **711** distributes DC power and data to batteries **352a**, **352b** and **352c**. Batteries **352a**, **352b** and **352c** contain electronic circuits that allow them to communicate with each other to monitor the respective charges, as described above in-reference to FIG. 14, so that the controller **150** can monitor and control the charging and discharging of the batteries **352a-352c**.

(144) According to some illustrative embodiments, the controller **150** is located on the main circuit board **718** and performs all control and processing required by the system **100**. However, in other illustrative embodiments, the controller **150** is distributed, locating some processing functionality on the front-end interface circuit board **636**, some on the power circuit board **720**, and/or some in the operator interface module **146**. Suitable cabling is provided between the various circuit boards, depending on whether and the degree to which the controller **150** is distributed within the system **100**.

(145) As described above with reference to FIGS. 19A-19C and 23A-23C, the system **100** mechanically divides into the single use disposable module **634** and the multiple use module **650**. As also described above, according to the illustrative embodiment, the single use module **634** includes all or substantially all of the perfusion fluid **108** contacting elements/assemblies of the system **100**, along with various peripheral components, flow conduits, sensors and support electronics for operating the blood contacting components. As discussed above with reference to FIGS. 22A and 23D, according to the illustrative embodiment, the module **634** does not include a processor, instead relying on the controller **150**, which may, for example, be distributed between the front-end interface circuit board **636**, the power circuit board **720**, the operator interface module **146**, and the main circuit board **718**, for control. However, in other illustrative embodiments, the single use module **634** may include its own controller/processor, for example, on the front-end circuit board **637**.

(146) Referring to FIGS. 24A-28C, the single use module **634** will next be described in terms of the components included therein. After that, exemplary forward and retrograde flow modes are traced through the described components.

(147) Referring first to FIG. 24A, the disposable module **634** includes a chassis **635** having upper **750a** and lower **750b** sections. The upper section **750a** includes a platform **752** for supporting various components. The lower section **750b** supports the platform **752** and includes structures for pivotably connecting with the multiple use module **650**. More particularly, the lower chassis section **750b** includes the C-shaped mount **656** for rigidly mounting the perfusion fluid pump interface assembly **300**, and the projection **662** for sliding into and snap fitting with the slot **660** of FIG. 20B. The lower chassis section **750b** also provides structures for mounting the oxygenator **114**. As shown in FIGS. 25A and 25C, the lower section **750b** further includes structures for mounting the heater assembly **110**. Additionally, the reservoir **160** mounts to the underside of the platform **725** and extends into the lower chassis section **750b**. Various sensors, such as the O_2 saturation and hematocrit sensor **140** (shown in FIG. 24A and described in detail below with reference to FIGS. 28A-28C), the flow rate sensor **136** (shown in FIG. 24A), the flow rate sensor **138** (shown in FIG. 25B), are located within and/or mount to the lower chassis section **750b**. The flow pressure compliance chamber **188** (shown in FIG. 25B) is also located in the lower chassis section **750b**. As shown in FIG. 24D, the lower chassis section **750b** also mounts the front-end circuit board **637**. Conduits located in the lower chassis section **750b** are described in further detail below with reference to the normal and retrograde flow paths through the single use module **634**.

(148) Referring to FIGS. 24A-25C, and as mentioned above, the upper chassis section **750a** includes the platform **752**. The platform **752** includes handles **752a** and **752b** formed therein to assist in installing and removing the single use module **634** from the multiple use module **650**. Alternatively, such handles can be located on the platform **757** to allow for easier accessibility during installation of the single use module into the multiple use module. As shown most clearly in FIG. 24C, an angled platform **757** mounts onto the platform **752**. The organ chamber assembly **104** mounts to the angled platform **757**. According to the illustrative embodiment, with the single use module **634** installed within the multiple use module **650**, the platform **757** is angled at about 10° to about 80° relative to horizontal, to provide an optimal angle of operation for the heart **102** when placed within the organ chamber assembly **104**. In some illustrative embodiments, the platform **757** is angled at about 20° to about 60° , or about 30° to about 50° relative to horizontal. The flow mode selector valve **112**, the flow rate sensor **134**, and the perfusion fluid flow pressure compliance chambers **184** and **186** also mount onto the angled platform **757**.

(149) Referring to FIG. 24E, several fluid ports mount to the platform **752**. For example, a fluid sampling port **754** enables an operator to sample the flow into and/or out of the aorta **158** via the cannulation interface **162** on the organ chamber assembly **104**. A fluid sampling port **755** enables the operator to sample the flow into the left atrium **152** via the interface **170** on the organ chamber assembly **104**. Additionally, a fluid port **758** enables the operator to sample the coronary flow out of the pulmonary artery **164** via the pulmonary artery interface **166** on the organ chamber **104**. According to the illustrative embodiment, the operator turns the a respective valve **754a**, **755a** or **758a** to obtain flow from the sampling ports **754**, **755** and **758**. Flow from the particular port selected is provided at a single common outlet **764**. According to one feature, only flow from the left most port selected is provided at the outlet **764**. By way of example, if the operator opens both ports **755** and **758**, only flow from port **755** is provided at the outlet **764**. In this way, system **100** reduces the likelihood of an operator mixing samples from multiple ports.

(150) The single use module **634** also includes a general injection port **762**, operable with the valve **762a**, for enabling the operator to inject medication into the perfusion fluid **108**, for example, via the reservoir **160**. Both the sampling **764** and injection **762** ports mount to the platform **752**. Also located on the upper chassis section **750a** is an infusion port **766**, operable with the valve **766a**, for flowing the nutritional **116** and preservative **118** fluids into the perfusion fluid **108**. The upper chassis section **750a** also includes a tube **774** for loading the exsanguinated blood from the donor

into the reservoir **160**. As shown in FIG. 24D, the single use module **634** also includes non-vented caps **776** for replacing vented caps on selected fluid ports that are used while running a sterilization gas through the single use module **634** during sterilization. Preferably, such sterilization takes place prior to packaging the single use module **634** for sale.

(151) The upper chassis section **750a** also includes the flow clamp **190** for regulating back pressure applied to the left atrium **152** when the heart **102** is cannulated and operating in normal flow mode in the organ chamber assembly **104**. The upper chassis section **750a** further includes a trickle valve **768**. The trickle valve **768** may be opened and closed with the handle **768a** to regulate a small fluid flow to the left atrium **152** to moisten the left atrium **152** during retrograde flow mode. The upper chassis section **750a** also includes ports **770** for infusion of additional solutions and **772** for purging the oxygenator **114**, operable with respective valves **770a** and **772a**.

(152) As shown most clearly in FIGS. 24A and 24D, the upper chassis section **750** further includes the flow pressure probes **126**, **128** and **130**. As described above with reference to FIG. 1, the probe **126** measures the pressure of the perfusion fluid **108** flowing into/out of the aorta **158**. The probe **128** measures the pressure of the perfusion fluid **108** flowing into the left atrium **152** through the pulmonary vein **168**. The probe **130** measures the pressure of the perfusion fluid **108** flowing out of the pulmonary artery **164**. Each probe includes a respective connector **126a**, **128a** and **130a** (shown shortened for clarity) for coupling a respective signal **129**, **131**, and **133** to the front-end circuit board **637**.

(153) Referring particularly to the single use module **654** cross-sectional side view of FIG. 24C, the reservoir **160** includes several components. More specifically, the reservoir **160** includes four inlets: **782**, **784**, **786** and **788**. The inlet **782** transfers perfusion fluid **108** from the drain **201** of the organ chamber **194** into the reservoir **160**. The inlet **784** receives exsanguinated blood from the tube **774**. The inlet **786** receives oxygenated perfusion fluid **108** from the oxygenator **114**, and the inlet **788** receives perfusion fluid **108** out of the aorta **158** via the back pressure clamp **190**. The reservoir **160** also has an outlet **790**, which provides the perfusion fluid to the one way inlet valve **191**. The reservoir **160** further includes a defoamer **778** and a filter **780**. The defoamer **778** removes bubbles out of the perfusion fluid **108** as it enters the reservoir **160**. According to the illustrative embodiment, the defoamer is made of porous polyurethane foam with an antifoam coating. The filter **780** is a polyester felt, which filters debris, blood particles, emboli, and air bubbles out of the perfusion fluid as it enters the reservoir **160**.

(154) As mentioned above in the summary, the O.sub.2 saturation and hematocrit sensor **140** employed in the single use module **634** includes important advantages over prior art approaches. FIGS. 28A-28C depict an illustrative embodiment of the O.sub.2 saturation and hematocrit sensor **140** of the invention. As shown in FIG. 28A, the sensor **140** includes an in-line cuvette shaped section of tube **812** connected to the conduit **798**, which has at least one optically clear window through which an infrared sensor can provide infrared light. Exemplary sensors used in the in-line cuvette-shaped tube **812** are those made by Datamed, BL0P4. As shown in the cross-sectional view of FIG. 28B, the cuvette **812** is a one-piece molded part having connectors **801a** and **801b**. The connectors **801a** and **801b** are configured to adjoin to connecting receptacles **803a** and **803b**, respectively, of conduit ends **798a** and **798b**. This interconnection between cuvette **812** and conduit ends **798a** and **798b** is configured so as to provide a substantially constant cross-sectional flow area inside conduit **798** and cuvette **812**. The configuration thereby reduces, and in some embodiments substantially removes, discontinuities at the interfaces **814a** and **814b** between the cuvette **812** and the conduit **798**. Reduction/removal of the discontinuities enables the blood based perfusion fluid **108** to flow through the cuvette with reduced lysing of red blood cells and reduced turbulence, which enables a more accurate reading of perfusion fluid oxygen levels. This also reduces damage to the perfusion fluid **108** by the system **100**, which ultimately reduces damage done to the heart **102** while being perfused by the system **100**.

(155) According to the illustrative embodiment, the cuvette **812** is formed from a light transmissive material, such as any suitable light transmissive glass or polymer. As shown in FIG. 28A, the sensor **140** also includes an optical transceiver **816** for directing light waves at perfusion fluid **108** passing through the cuvette **812** and for measuring light transmission and/or light reflectance to determine the amount of oxygen in the perfusion fluid **108**. As illustrated in FIG. 28C, in some embodiments a light transmitter is located on one side of the cuvette **812** and a detector for measuring light transmission through the perfusion fluid **108** is located on an opposite side of the cuvette **812**. FIG. 28C depicts a top cross-sectional view of the cuvette **812** and the transceiver **816**. The transceiver **816** fits around cuvette **812** such that transceiver interior flat surfaces **811** and **813** mate against cuvette flat surfaces **821** and **823**, respectively, while the interior convex surface **815** of transceiver **816** mates with the cuvette **812** convex surface **819**. In operation, when UV light is transmitted from the transceiver **816**, it travels from flat surface **811** through the fluid **108** inside cuvette **812**, and is received by flat surface **813**. The flat surface **813** may be configured with a detector for measuring the light transmission through the fluid **108**.

(156) The fluid flow path through the single use module **634** in both normal and retrograde flow modes will now be described with reference to FIGS. 24A-24D and FIG. 25A. As described above with reference to FIGS. 1-4, the system **100** can maintain the heart **102** in two modes of operation; a normal flow mode, shown in FIG. 3, and a retrograde flow mode shown in FIG. 4. As mentioned above with regard to FIG. 1, to change between normal and retrograde flow modes, the system **100** provides the flow mode selector valve **112**, shown in detail in FIGS. 26A and 26B. To operate in normal flow mode, the operator sets the flow mode selector valve handle **112e** to the position indicated in FIG. 24A. This has the effect of aligning the flow paths through the selector valve **112** as shown in FIG. 26A. Specifically, in normal flow mode, fluid can flow into port **112b**, through the flow channel **112f** and out the port **112c**. Additionally, fluid can flow into port **112d**, through the flow channel **112g** and out the port **112a**. To operate in retrograde flow mode, the operator sets the flow mode selector valve handle **112e** to the position indicated in FIG. 24B. This has the effect of aligning the flow paths through the selector valve **112** as shown in FIG. 26B. Specifically, in retrograde flow mode, fluid can flow into port **112b**, through the flow channel **112h** and out the port **112d**.

(157) Referring to FIG. 24A, in normal flow mode, the reservoir **160** provides the perfusion fluid **108** to the one way inlet valve **191** of the perfusion pump interface assembly **300**. Referring to FIG. 25A, the perfusion pump **106** pumps the perfusion fluid **108** out the outlet valve **310**. Referring to FIG. 25C, the perfusion fluid **108** then flows through the conduit **792** and the compliance chamber **188** and into the inlet **110a** of the heater assembly **110**. The heater assembly **110** heats the perfusion fluid **108** and then flows it out the heater outlet **110b**. Referring to FIG. 24A, the heated perfusion fluid **108** flows from the heater outlet **110b** in the lower chassis section **750b** through the chassis plate **752** and into the port **112b** of the mode select valve **112** via the conduit **794**. Referring also to FIG. 24D, the perfusion fluid **108** flows out the mode valve port **112c**, through the compliance chamber **186**, the conduit **796**, and the pressure sensor **128** into the pulmonary vein cannulation interface **170** on the organ chamber assembly **104**.

(158) Referring to FIG. 24A, in normal flow mode, the heart **102** pumps the perfusion fluid **108** out the pulmonary artery **164** through the pulmonary artery interface **166** and the pressure sensor **130**. The conduit **796** then flows the perfusion fluid **108** from the pulmonary artery interface **166** through the plate **752** and through the O.sub.2 saturation and hematocrit sensor **140**. Referring also to FIGS. 25A and 25C, the conduit **798** then flows the perfusion fluid **108** from the sensor **140** through the flow-rate sensor **136** into the oxygenator **114**. The conduit **800** flows the perfusion fluid **108** from the oxygenator **114** back into the reservoir **160** by way of the reservoir inlet **786**.

(159) Referring to FIGS. 24A, 24D and 24E, in normal flow mode, the heart **102** also pumps the perfusion fluid **108** out of the aorta **158** through the aorta interface **162** and the pressure sensor **126**. The conduit **802** flows the perfusion fluid **108** from the pressure sensor **126** through the flow rate sensor **134** and back into the port **112d** on the flow mode selector valve **112**. A clamp **804** holds the conduit **802** in place. A conduit **806** flows the perfusion fluid **108** out the port **112a** from the flow mode selector valve **112** through the compliance chamber **184** and the back pressure adjustment clamp **190**. As mentioned above, the clamp **190** may be adjusted to restrict flow through the conduit **806** to adjust the back pressure seen by the aorta **158** during normal flow mode to more realistically simulate normal physiologic conditions. The compliance chamber **184**, which can expand and contract as perfusion fluid **108** is pumped into and out of it, interoperates with the clamp **190** to dampen flow pressure spikes to further improve simulation of near-normal physiologic conditions. The after-load clamp **190** is configured to closely emulate systemic vascular resistance of the human body which affects aortic pressure, left atrial pressure, and coronary flow. A conduit **808** returns the perfusion fluid **108** into the reservoir **160** by way of the reservoir inlet **788**.

(160) In retrograde flow mode, the flow mode selector valve **112** is positioned as shown in FIG. 24B. Referring to FIG. 24B, the reservoir **160**

provides the perfusion fluid **108** to the inlet valve **191**. As shown in FIG. 25A, the perfusion pump **106** pumps the perfusion fluid **108** out the outlet valve **310**. As shown in FIG. 25C, the perfusion fluid **108** then flows through the conduit **792** and the compliance chamber **188** and into the inlet **110a** of the heater assembly **110**. The heater assembly **110** heats the perfusion fluid **108** and then flows it out the heater outlet **110b**. Referring to FIG. 24B, the heated perfusion fluid **108** flows from the heater outlet **110b** in the lower chassis section **750b** through the chassis plate **752** and into the input **112b** of the mode select valve **112** via the conduit **794**. Referring also to FIG. 24D, the perfusion fluid **108** flows out the mode valve outlet **112d**, into the conduit **802**, through the flow rate sensor **134**, the pressure sensor **126** and into the aorta **158** via the aorta interface **162**. The perfusion fluid **108** then flows through the coronary sinus **155** and the rest of the coronary vasculature.

(161) Referring to FIG. 24B, in retrograde flow mode, the heart **102** pumps the perfusion fluid **108** out of the pulmonary artery **164** and through the pulmonary artery interface **166** and the pressure sensor **130**. The conduit **796** then flows the perfusion fluid from the pulmonary artery interface **166** through the plate **752** and into the O.sub.2 saturation and hematocrit sensor **140**. Referring also to FIGS. 25A and 25C, the conduit **798** then flows the perfusion fluid **108** from the sensor **140** through the flow rate sensor **136** into the oxygenator **114**. The conduit **800** flows the perfusion fluid **108** from the oxygenator **114** back into the reservoir **160** by way of the reservoir inlet **786**. In retrograde flow mode, substantially no perfusion fluid is pumped into or out of the left atrium **152** via the pulmonary vein **168** and the pulmonary vein interface **170**, with the exception of a small amount of perfusion fluid diverted by the trickle valve **768** from the conduit **794** around the flow mode selector valve **112** into the compliance chamber **186**. As mentioned above, the trickle flow provides sufficient perfusion fluid **108** to keep the left atrium **152** moistened during retrograde flow.

(162) As described above, the illustrative embodiment of the system **100** has one or more sensors or probes for measuring fluid flow and pressure. The probes and/or sensors may be obtained from standard commercial sources. The flow rate sensors **134**, **136** and **138** are conventional, ultrasonic flow sensors, such as those available from Transonic Systems Inc., Ithaca, N.Y. The fluid pressure probes **126**, **128** and **130** may be conventional, strain gauge pressure sensors available from MSI or G.E. Thermometrics. Alternatively, a pre-calibrated pressure transducer chip can be embedded into organ chamber connectors and wired to a data collection site such as the front-end board **637**.

(163) Having described the electrical and mechanical components and functionality of illustrative embodiments of the system **100** and certain modes of operation thereof, the system **100** will next be described with reference to the illustrative organ harvest and transplant procedures of FIGS. 29A and 29B. More particularly, FIG. 29A is a flow diagram **900** depicting exemplary methodologies for harvesting the donor heart **102** and cannulating it into the system **100** at a donor location. FIG. 29B depicts particular points of care for handling the heart **102** in preparation for cannulation, and FIG. 30 is a flow diagram **902** of exemplary methodologies for removing the donor organ **102** from the system **100** and transplanting it into a patient at a recipient site.

(164) As shown in FIG. 29A, the process of obtaining and preparing the heart **102** for cannulation and transport begins by providing a suitable organ donor **904**. The organ donor is brought to a donor location, whereupon the process of receiving and preparing the donor heart **102** for cannulation and transport proceeds down two intersecting pathways **906** and **908**. The pathway **906** principally involves preparing the donor heart **102** for transplant, while the pathway **908** principally involves preparing the system **100** to receive the donor heart **102** and then transporting the heart **102** via system **100** to the recipient site.

(165) With particular reference to FIG. 29A, the first pathway **906** includes exsanguinating the donor **910**, arresting the donor heart **914**, explanting the heart **916**, and preparing the heart **102** for cannulation **918** into the system **100**. In particular, in the exsanguination step **910**, the donor's blood is removed and set aside so it can be used to perfuse the heart **102** during preservation on the system **100**. This step is performed by inserting a catheter into either the arterial or venous vasculature of the donor to allow the donor's blood to flow out of the donor and be collected into a blood collection bag. The donor's blood is allowed to flow out until the necessary amount of blood is collected, typically 1.0-2.5 liters, whereupon the catheter is removed. The blood extracted through exsanguination is then filtered and added to a fluid reservoir **160** of the system **100** in preparation for use with the system **100**. Alternatively, the blood can be exsanguinated from the donor and filtered for leukocytes and platelets in a single step that uses an apparatus having a filter integrated with the cannula and blood collection bag. An example of such a filter is a Pall BC2B filter. After the donor's blood is exsanguinated, the donor heart **102** is injected in step **914** with a cardioplegic solution to temporarily halt beating in preparation for harvesting the heart **102**.

(166) After the heart **102** is arrested, the heart **102** is explanted **916** from the donor and prepared **918** for loading onto the system **100**. In general, the steps of explanting the heart **916** and preparing for loading **918** involve severing the connections between the vasculature of the heart **102** and the interior chest cavity of the donor, suturing various of the severed connections, then lifting the heart **102** from the chest cavity.

(167) More particularly, as shown in FIG. 29B, the right and left pulmonary arteries **164a** and **164b** are severed, and the right pulmonary artery **164a** is tied-off by a surgical thread **901a** or other suitable mechanism. The tying prevents fluid from flowing through the severed end **903a** of the left pulmonary artery **164a**. As described above with reference to FIGS. 24A-24B, the left pulmonary artery **164b** remains unsutured to allow it to be cannulated to the organ chamber assembly **104**, thereby allowing perfusion fluid **108** to flow through the left pulmonary artery **164b**, through the pulmonary artery cannulation interface **170**, and back to the reservoir **160**. The left pulmonary veins **168b** and **169b** and the right pulmonary veins **168a** and **169a** are also severed, and all except a single pulmonary vein **169b** are tied off with surgical thread **901b**, **901c**, and **901d**, respectively. This prevents fluid from flowing through the severed ends **903b** and **903c** of the right pulmonary veins **168a** and **169a**, or through the severed end **903d** of the left pulmonary vein **168b**, but allows the untied pulmonary vein to be cannulated to the organ chamber assembly **104** through the pulmonary vein interface **170**. As described above with reference to FIGS. 24A-24B, this arrangement allows the perfusion fluid **108** to flow through the right pulmonary artery **164b**, through the pulmonary artery interface **166**, and back to the oxygenator **114**. Alternatively, blood can be expelled from the right ventricle via cannulating the pulmonary arterial trunk. The pulmonary arterial trunk is not shown but includes the segment of pulmonary artery **164** between the branches **164a** and **164b** of the pulmonary artery **164** and the right ventricle **159**. The superior vena cava **161** is also severed and, once the heart is connected to the system **100** and begins beating, is tied with thread **901e** to prevent fluid from flowing through its end **903e**. The inferior vena cava **163** is similarly severed and tied with thread **901f** or oversewn to prevent fluid from flowing through its end **903f**. The aorta **158** is also severed (in the illustrated embodiment at a point downstream from the coronary sinus **155**) but is not tied off, allowing it to be cannulated to the organ chamber assembly **104**. In one embodiment, the aorta **158** is cannulated to an aortic connector, which can be easily attached to the aorta interface **170**.

(168) With continued reference to the flow chart of FIG. 29A, after the heart vasculature is severed and appropriately tied, the heart **102** is then loaded onto the system **100** by inserting it into the organ chamber assembly **104** and cannulating the aorta **158**, left pulmonary artery **164b**, and a pulmonary vein **169b** to the appropriate points in the organ chamber assembly **104**.

(169) Often, hearts obtained from donors who have also donated their lungs are missing part or all of the left atrium **152**. In this situation, the heart **102** can still be instrumented and perfused in the retrograde mode by cannulating the aorta **158** and either the right pulmonary artery **164a** or pulmonary artery trunk (not shown, but described above), and allowing any remaining left atrium **152** portion to remain open during the preservation period.

(170) With continued reference to FIG. 29A, during the preparation of the heart via path **906**, the system **100** is prepared through the steps of path **908** so it is primed and waiting to receive the heart **102** for cannulation and transport as soon as the heart **102** is prepared. By quickly transferring the heart **102** from the donor to the system **100**, and subsequently perfusing the heart **102** with the perfusion fluid **108**, a medical operator can minimize the amount of time the heart **102** is deprived of oxygen and other nutrients, and thus reduce ischemia and other ill effects that arise during current organ care techniques. In certain embodiments, the amount of time between infusing the heart **102** with cardioplegic solution and beginning flow of the perfusion fluid **108** through the heart **102** via the system **100** is less than about 15 minutes. In other illustrative embodiments, the between-time is less than about ½ hour, less than about 1 hour, less than about 2 hours, or even less than about 3 hours. Similarly, the time between transplanting the

heart into an organ care system **100** and bringing the heart **102** to a near physiological temperature (e.g., between about 34 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C.) occurs within a brief period of time so as to reduce ischemia within the heart tissues. In some illustrative embodiments, the period of time is less than about 5 minutes, while in other applications it may be less than about ½ hour, less than about 1 hour, less than about 2 hours, or even less than about 3 hours. According to some illustrative embodiments, the heart can be transferred directly from the donor to the system **100**, without the use of cardioplegia, and in such applications the time to beginning the flow of warm perfusion fluid **108** and/or time to the heart reaching near physiologic temperature is similarly less than about 5 minutes, less than about ½ hour, less than about 1 hour, less than about 2 hours, or even less than about 3 hours. In one implementation, the donor heart is not arrested prior to removal from the donor, and is instrumented onto the system **100** while the heart **102** is still beating.

(171) As shown in FIG. 29A, the system **100** is prepared in pathway **908** through a series of steps, which include preparing the single use module **634** (step **922**), priming the system **100** with priming solution (step **924**), filtering the blood from the donor and adding it to the system **100** reservoir **160** (step **912**), and connecting the heart **102** into the system **100** (step **904**). In particular, the step **922** of preparing the single use module **634** includes assembling the disposable single use module **634**. Suitable assemblies are shown, for example, in FIGS. 24A-24D, FIGS. 25A-25C, and FIG. 26. After the module **634** is assembled, or provided in the appropriate assembly, it is then inserted into multiple use module **650** through the process described above with reference to FIGS. 21A-21C.

(172) In step **924**, the loaded system **100** is primed with priming solution, as described in more particular detail below with reference to Table 1. According to one feature, to aid in priming, the system **100** provides an organ bypass conduit **810** shown installed into the organ chamber assembly **104** in FIG. 27A. As depicted, the bypass conduit includes three segments **810a-810c**. Segment **810a** attaches to the pulmonary artery cannulation interface **170**. The segment **810b** attaches to the aorta cannulation interface **810b**, and the segment **810c** attaches to the pulmonary vein cannulation interface **166**. Using the bypass conduit **810** so attached/cannulated into the organ chamber assembly **104**, an operator can cause the system **100** to circulate the perfusion fluid **108** through all of the paths used during actual operation. This enables the system **100** to be thoroughly tested and primed prior to cannulating the heart **102** into place.

(173) In the next step **912**, blood from the donor is filtered and added to the reservoir **160**. The filtering process helps reduce the inflammatory process through the complete or partial removal of leukocytes and platelets. Additionally, the donor blood is mixed with one or more nutritional **116** and/or preservative **118** solutions to form the perfusion fluid **108**. In step **926**, the system **100** is primed with the perfusion fluid **108** by pumping it through the system **100** in the retrograde flow mode, as described above in reference to FIG. 24B, and with the bypass conduit **810** in place. As the perfusion fluid **108** circulates through the system **100** in priming step **926**, it is warmed to the desired temperature as it passes through heater assembly **110**. The desired temperature range and heating applications are described above in reference to FIGS. 6A through 6E, and in respect to FIG. 13. In step **920**, after the system **100** is primed with the perfusion fluid **108**, the bypass conduit **810** is removed, and the heart **102** is instrumented, as described above and shown in FIG. 27B, onto the system **100**.

(174) After the heart **102** is instrumented onto the system **100**, the pump **104** is activated and the flow mode valve **112** is positioned in retrograde flow mode (described above with reference to FIGS. 1 and 4) to pump the perfusion fluid **108** in retrograde flow mode through the aorta into the vasculature of the heart **102**. The pumping of the warm, oxygen and nutrient enriched perfusion fluid **108** through the heart **102** allows the heart **102** to function ex vivo in a near normal physiologic state. In particular, the warm perfusion fluid **108** warms the heart **102** as it perfuses through it, which may cause the heart **102** to resume beating in its natural fashion. In some instances, it is desirable to assist the heart **102** in resuming its beating, which may be done by providing hand massage or a defibrillation signal **143** (shown in FIG. 22E) to the heart **102**. This may be done as described above with reference to the organ chamber assembly of FIGS. 5A-5F and operator interface **146** of FIGS. 17A-17J.

(175) After the heart is instrumented onto the system **100** at step **920**, subsequent steps **928** and **930** allow the operator to test the heart **102** and the system **100**, and to evaluate their respective conditions. Illustratively, step **928** involves evaluating ECG signals **379** and **381** from the sensors **142** and **144** (positioned as shown in FIG. 27A), respectively, as well as hematocrit **145** and oxygen saturation **141** levels of the perfusion fluid **108** from the sensor **140**. As further described in reference to FIG. 12 and FIGS. 17A-17I, the operator can also monitor the fluid flows, pressures, and temperatures of the system **100** while the heart **102** is cannulated. As described above with reference to FIGS. 5E and 5F, the testing step **928** may also include having the operator touch/examine the heart **102** by lifting an outer lid **196** of the organ chamber **104** and touching/examining the heart **102** indirectly through the flexible membrane **198b**. During the evaluation step **930**, based on the data and other information obtained during testing **928**, the operator determines whether and how to adjust the system **100** properties (e.g., fluid flows, pressures, and temperatures), and whether to provide additional defibrillation, or other needed modes of treatment to the heart **102**. The operator makes any such adjustments in step **932**, then repeats steps **928** and **930** to re-test and re-evaluate the heart **102** and the system **100**. In certain embodiments, the operator may also opt to perform surgical, therapeutic or other procedures on the heart **102** during the adjustment step **932**. For example, the operator can conduct an evaluation of the physiological fitness of the heart, such as for example, performing an ultrasound or other imaging test, performing an echocardiogram or diagnostic test on the heart, measuring arterial blood gas levels and other evaluative tests.

(176) In another application, during or after step **932**, the system **100** allows a medical operator to evaluate the organ for compatibility with an intended recipient after explantation but prior to implantation into the donor. For example, the operator can perform a Human Leukocyte Antigen (HLA) matching test on the organ while the organ is cannulated to the system **100**. Such tests may require 12 hours or longer and are performed to ensure compatibility of the organ with the intended recipient. The preservation of an organ using the system **100** described above may allow for preservation times in excess of the time needed to complete an HLA match, potentially resulting in improved post-transplant outcomes. In the HLA matching test example, the HLA test can be performed on the heart while a preservation solution is pumping into the heart.

(177) According to a further illustrative embodiment, after the heart is functioning as determined by the step **932**, the operator can perform surgery on the heart or provide therapeutic or other treatment, such as immunosuppressive treatments, chemotherapy, genetic testing and therapies, or irradiation therapy. Because the system **100** allows the heart **102** to be perfused under near physiological temperature, fluid flow rate, and oxygen saturation levels, the heart **102** can be maintained after the adjustment step **932** for a long period of time (e.g., for a period of at least 3 days or more, greater than at least 1 week, at least 3 weeks, or a month or more) to allow for repeated evaluation and treatment.

(178) According to the illustrative embodiment, the testing **928**, evaluation **930** and adjustment **932** steps may be conducted with the system **100** operating in retrograde flow mode, or may be conducted with the system **100** operating in normal flow mode. In normal flow mode, the operator can test the function of the heart **102** under normal or near normal physiologic blood flow conditions. Based on the evaluation **930**, the settings of the system **100** may be adjusted in step **932**, if necessary, to modify the flow, heating and/or other characteristics to stabilize the heart **102** in step **934** in preparation for transport to the recipient site in step **936**. After the heart **102** and the system **100** is tested and evaluated to ensure appropriate performance, the system **100** with the loaded heart **102** is transported to the recipient site at step **936**.

(179) Referring now to FIG. 30, the first phase **942** of the transplant process involves repeating the testing **928** and evaluation **930** steps undertaken just prior to leaving the donor site **936**. If the function and characteristics of the heart **102** are not acceptable, the system **100** can be adjusted **942** as appropriate, for example, to provide appropriate fluid oxygenation or nutritional levels, or to increase or decrease the appropriate fluid temperature. As noted above, surgical and/or other therapeutic/remedial procedures may be performed on the heart **102**, along with the testing **928** and evaluation **930**. According to the illustrative embodiment, testing at the recipient site may be performed in retrograde flow mode, normal flow mode, or a combination of both.

(180) At step **946**, after testing is complete, the system **100** is placed in normal/forward flow mode. In certain embodiments, this step **946** is not initiated until the left atrium **152** and pulmonary vein **164** are cannulated, there is adequate operating volume in the system, the heart exhibits stable electrical activity, the ABG and electrolytes are within acceptable ranges, SvO₂ is >80%, and blood temperature is between about 34 degrees C. and

about 36 degrees C. The step **946** may be accomplished by slowing and/or stopping the retrograde pumping of the system **100**, then restarting the pumping in forward mode. In certain embodiments, prior to restarting in forward mode, the user opens the aortic sampling port **754a**, releases the pressure control clamp **190** by turning it counterclockwise, then increases the flow rate of pump **106** to about 1.0 L/min, sets the flow control valve **112** to normal/forward flow, and increases the flow rate of pump **106** to about 2.0 L/min to allow the blood **102** to displace air in the perfusate lines (e.g., **802**) of the system **100** and pass through the left side of the heart **102** and down the reservoir return line **808**. The user then closes the aortic sampling port **754a**.

(181) The flow rate of the perfusion fluid **108** emitted from the pump **106** is then increased at step **950** to a level of the clinician's choosing (typically between about 1 L/min to about 5 L/min) to approximate the physiologic flow rate provided by the heart **102** while functioning in normal beating mode. The heart **102** and the system **100** are again tested at step **952** in a similar fashion to that described above with respect to steps **928** and **930**. The clinician may also choose to perform any other tests or evaluations on the heart, for example echocardiogram, electrolyte measurements, cardiac enzyme measurements, metabolite measurements, intravascular ultrasound evaluation, pressure-volume loop evaluation, and Millar pressure evaluation.

(182) In the third phase **946** at the recipient site, the heart **102** is prepared for implantation into the recipient. This phase includes the step **956** of powering down the pump **106** to stop the flow of perfusion fluid **108**. Next, in step **958**, the heart **102** is arrested, for example by injecting it with cardioplegic solution in a similar fashion to what is done in step **914** at the donor site. In step **960**, the heart **102** is de-cannulated and removed from the organ chamber assembly **106**. In step **962**, the heart **102** is transplanted into the recipient patient by first removing the sutures **901a-901f**, then inserting the heart **102** into the recipient's chest cavity, and suturing the various heart vesicles (e.g., **158**, **164a**, **164b**, **168a**, **168b**, **169a**, **169b**, and **903a-903f**) to their appropriate mating vesicles within the recipient.

(183) While external devices and methods have been described to defibrillate the heart, deliver pacing signals to the heart, and perform blood chemistry analyses from samples taken from the perfusion fluid, it may also be beneficial to integrate these features into the portable system. Such features include defibrillation, pacing, diagnostic ECG sensing, and blood chemistry analyses.

(184) As described above, the system **100** employs a priming solution, and also employs a perfusion fluid **108** that combines a nutritional supplement **116** solution and a preservative solution **118** with a blood product or synthetic blood product to form the perfusion fluid **108**. The priming, supplement **116**, and preservative **118** solutions are described next.

(185) According to certain embodiments, solutions with particular solutes and concentrations are selected and proportioned to enable the organ to function at physiologic or near physiologic conditions. For example, such conditions include maintaining organ function at or near a physiological temperature and/or preserving an organ in a state that permits normal cellular metabolism, such as protein synthesis.

(186) In certain embodiments solutions are formed from compositions by combining components with a fluid, from more concentrated solutions by dilution, or from more dilute solutions by concentration. In exemplary embodiments, suitable solutions include an energy source, one or more stimulants to assist the organ in continuing its normal physiologic function prior to and during transplantation, and one or more amino acids selected and proportioned so that the organ continues its cellular metabolism during perfusion. Cellular metabolism includes, for example conducting protein synthesis while functioning during perfusion. Some illustrative solutions are aqueous based, while other illustrative solutions are non-aqueous, for example organic solvent-based, ionic-liquid-based, or fatty-acid-based.

(187) The solutions may include one or more energy-rich components to assist the organ in conducting its normal physiologic function. These components may include energy rich materials that are metabolizable, and/or components of such materials that an organ can use to synthesize energy sources during perfusion. Exemplary sources of energy-rich molecules include, for example, one or more carbohydrates. Examples of carbohydrates include monosaccharides, disaccharides, oligosaccharides, polysaccharides, or combinations thereof, or precursors or metabolites thereof. While not meant to be limiting, examples of monosaccharides suitable for the solutions include octoses; heptoses; hexoses, such as fructose, allose, altrose, glucose, mannose, gulose, idose, galactose, and talose; pentoses such as ribose, arabinose, xylose, and lyxose; tetroses such as erythrose and threose; and trioses such as glyceraldehyde. While not meant to be limiting, examples of disaccharides suitable for the solutions include (+)-maltose (4-O-(α -D-glucopyranosyl)- α -D-glucopyranose), (+)-cellobiose (4-O-(β -D-glucopyranosyl)-D-glucopyranose), (+)-lactose (4-O-(β -D-galactopyranosyl)- β -D-glucopyranose), sucrose (2-O-(α -D-glucopyranosyl)- β -D-fructofuranoside). While not meant to be limiting, examples of polysaccharides suitable for the solutions include cellulose, starch, amylose, amylopectin, sulfomucopolysaccharides (such as dermatane sulfate, chondroitin sulfate, sulodexide, mesoglycans, heparan sulfates, idosanes, heparins and heparinoids), and glycogen. In some embodiments, monosaccharides, disaccharides, and polysaccharides of both aldoses, ketoses, or a combination thereof are used. One or more isomers, including enantiomers, diastereomers, and/or tautomers of monosaccharides, disaccharides, and/or polysaccharides, including those described and not described herein, may be employed in the solutions described herein. In some embodiments, one or more monosaccharides, disaccharides, and/or polysaccharides may have been chemically modified, for example, by derivatization and/or protection (with protecting groups) of one or more functional groups. In certain embodiments, carbohydrates, such as dextrose or other forms of glucose are preferred.

(188) Other possible energy sources include adenosine triphosphate (ATP), co-enzyme A, pyruvate, flavin adenine dinucleotide (FAD), thiamine pyrophosphate chloride (co-carboxylase), β -nicotinamide adenine dinucleotide (NAD), β -nicotinamide adenine dinucleotide phosphate (NADPH), and phosphate derivatives of nucleosides, e.g., nucleotides, including mono-, di-, and tri-phosphates (e.g., UTP, GTP, GDP, and UDP), coenzymes, or other bio-molecules having similar cellular metabolic functions, and/or metabolites or precursors thereof. For example, phosphate derivatives of adenosine, guanosine, thymidine (5-Me-uridine), cytidine, and uridine, as well as other naturally and chemically modified nucleosides are contemplated.

(189) In certain embodiments, one or more carbohydrates is provided along with a phosphate source, such as a nucleotide. The carbohydrate helps enable the organ to produce ATP or other energy sources during perfusion. The phosphate source may be provided directly through ATP, ADP, AMP or other sources. In other illustrative embodiments, a phosphate is provided through a phosphate salt, such as glycerophosphate, sodium phosphate or other phosphate ions. A phosphate may include any form thereof in any ionic state, including protonated forms and forms with one or more counter ions.

(190) The solutions may include one or more organ stimulants for assisting the organ's normal physiologic function during perfusion. In some illustrative embodiments, where the transplanted organ is a heart, cardio stimulants are provided to enable the heart to continue functioning (e.g., continue beating) during perfusion and transplantation. Such stimulants may include, for example, catecholamines, such as epinephrine and/or norepinephrine, which facilitate beating of the heart. Other cardio stimulants may be used, such as certain forms of peptides and/or polypeptides (e.g., vasopressin, Anthropleurin-A and Anthropleurin-B), and/or β .1/ β .2-adrenoreceptor blocking agents (such as CGP 12177), bupranolol, pindolol, alprenolol, and cardiac glycosides. One or more natural products may also be used, such as digitalis (digoxin), palustrin, and/or ferulic acid. Stimulants such as those mentioned above can be included with the solutions or added at the point of use by the user.

(191) In some instances, additional components are provided to assist the organ in conducting its metabolism during perfusion. These components include, for example, forms or derivatives of adenine and/or adenosine, which may be used for ATP synthesis, for maintaining endothelial function, and/or for attenuating ischemia and/or reperfusion injury. According to certain implementations, a magnesium ion source is provided with a phosphate, and in certain embodiments, with adenosine to further enhance ATP synthesis within the cells of the perfused organ.

(192) Solutions described herein may include one or more amino acids, preferably a plurality of amino acids, to support protein synthesis by the organ's cells. Suitable amino acids include, for example, any of the naturally occurring amino acids. The amino acids may be, in various enantiomeric or diastereomeric forms. For example, solutions may employ either D- or L-amino acids, or a combination thereof, e.g., solutions enantioenriched in

more of the D- or L-isomer or racemic solutions. Suitable amino acids may also be non-naturally occurring or modified amino acids, such as citrulline, ornithine, homocysteine, homoserine, .beta.-amino acids such as .beta.-alanine, amino-caproic acid, or combinations thereof.

(193) Certain exemplary solutions include some but not all naturally occurring amino acids. In some embodiments, solutions include essential amino acids. For example, a solution may be prepared with one or more or all of the following amino-acids: Glycine Alanine Arginine Aspartic Acid Glutamic Acid Histidine Isoleucine Leucine Methionine Phenylalanine Proline Serine Threonine Tryptophan Tyrosine Valine Lysine acetate

(194) In certain embodiments, non-essential and/or semi-essential amino acids are not included in the solutions. For example, in some embodiments, asparagine, glutamine, and/or cysteine are not included. In other embodiments, the solution contains one or more non-essential and/or semi-essential amino acids. Accordingly, in other embodiments, asparagine, glutamine, and/or cysteine are included.

(195) The solutions may also contain electrolytes, particularly calcium ions for facilitating enzymatic reactions, cardiac contractility, and/or coagulation within the organ. Other electrolytes may be used, such as sodium, potassium, chloride, sulfate, magnesium and other inorganic and organic charged species, or combinations thereof. It should be noted that any component provided hereunder may be provided, where valence and stability permit, in an ionic form, in a protonated or unprotonated form, in salt or free base form, or as ionic or covalent substituents in combination with other components that hydrolyze and make the component available in aqueous solutions, as suitable and appropriate.

(196) In certain embodiments, the solutions contain buffering components. For example, suitable buffer systems include 2-morpholinoethanesulfonic acid monohydrate (MES), cacodylic acid, H.sub.2CO.sub.3/NaHCO.sub.3 (pK.sub.a1), citric acid (pK.sub.a3), bis(2-hydroxyethyl)-imino-tris-(hydroxymethyl)-methane (Bis-Tris), N-(carbamoylmethyl)iminodiacetic acid (ADA), 3-bis [tris(hydroxymethyl)methylamino]propane (Bis-Tris Propane) (pK.sub.a1), piperazine-1,4-bis(2-ethanesulfonic acid) (PIPES), N-(2-Acetamido)-2-aminoethanesulfonic acid (ACES), imidazole, N,N-bis(2-hydroxyethyl)-2-aminoethanesulfonic acid (BES), 3-(N-morpholino)propanesulphonic acid (MOPS), NaH.sub.2PO.sub.4/Na.sub.2HPO.sub.4 (pK.sub.a2), N-tris(hydroxymethyl)methyl-2-aminoethanesulfonic acid (TES), N-(2-hydroxyethyl)-piperazine-N'-2-ethanesulfonic acid (HEPES), N-(2-hydroxyethyl)piperazine-N'-(2-hydroxypropanesulfonic acid) (HEPPSO), triethanolamine, N-[tris(hydroxymethyl)methyl]glycine (Tricine), tris(hydroxymethyl)aminoethane (Tris), glycnamide, N,N-bis(2-hydroxyethyl) glycine (Bicine), glycylglycine (pK.sub.a2), N-tris(hydroxymethyl)methyl-3-aminopropanesulfonic acid (TAPS), or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the solutions contain sodium bicarbonate, potassium phosphate, or TRIS buffer.

(197) The solutions may include other components to help maintain the organ and protect it against ischemia, reperfusion injury and other ill effects during perfusion. In certain exemplary embodiments, these components may include hormones (e.g., insulin), vitamins (e.g., an adult multi-vitamin, such as multi-vitamin MVI-Adult), and/or steroids (e.g., dexamethasone and SoluMedrol).

(198) In another aspect, a blood product is provided with the solution to support the organ during metabolism. Exemplary suitable blood products may include whole blood and/or one or more components thereof such as blood serum, plasma, albumin, and red blood cells. In embodiments where whole blood is used, the blood may be passed through a leukocyte and platelet depleting filter to reduce pyrogens, antibodies and/or other items that may cause inflammation in the organ. Thus, in some embodiments, the solution employs whole blood that has been at least partially depleted of leukocytes and/or whole blood that has been at least partially depleted of platelets.

(199) The solutions are preferably provided at a physiological temperature and maintained thereabout throughout perfusion and recirculation. As used herein, "physiological temperature" is referred to as temperatures between about 25 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C., for example, between about 30 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C., such as between about 34 degrees C. and about 37 degrees C.

(200) Table 1 sets forth components that are used in an exemplary aqueous priming solution. The component amounts in Table 1 are relative to each other and to the amount of aqueous solvent employed in the solution (about 500 mL in the exemplary embodiment) and may be scaled as appropriate. In certain embodiments, the quantity of aqueous solvent varies $\pm$ about 10%.

(201) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Composition of Exemplary Priming Solution (about 500 mL aqueous solution) Component Amount Specification Mannitol 12.5 g. $\pm$ about 10% Sodium Chloride 4.8 g. $\pm$ about 10% Potassium Chloride 185 mg. $\pm$ about 10% Magnesium Sulfate 185 mg. $\pm$ about 10% heptahydrate Sodium 900 mg. $\pm$ about 10%. Glycerophosphate

(202) The exemplary priming solution is added to the system **100** through priming step **924**, as more fully described with reference to FIG. **29A**.

(203) With regard to the nutritional supplement solution **116**, in certain embodiments it includes one or more carbohydrates and may also include a phosphate source. The nutritional supplement solution **116** is typically maintained at a pH of about 5.0 to about 6.5, for example about 5.5 to about 6.0.

(204) Table 2 sets forth components that are used in an exemplary nutritional supplement solution **116**. In some embodiments, the nutritional solution **116** further includes sodium glycerol phosphate. The amount of components in Table 2 is relative to the amount of aqueous solvent employed in the solution **116** (about 500 mL) and may be scaled as appropriate. In some embodiments, the quantity of aqueous solvent varies $\pm$ about 10%.

(205) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 Components of Exemplary Nutritional Solution (about 500 mL) Component Amount Specification Dextrose 40 g. $\pm$ about 10%.

(206) In certain embodiments the nutritional solution **116** includes one or more carbohydrates and may also include a phosphate source. The nutritional solution **116** is typically maintained at a pH of about 5.0 to about 6.5, for example of about 5.5 to about 6.0.

(207) The preservation solution **118** may include one or more preservatives. In an exemplary embodiment, one or more cardio stimulants are included for assisting normal physiologic function of the heart **102** during perfusion and transplantation. Such stimulants may include, for example, catecholamines, such as epinephrine and/or norepinephrine, which facilitate beating of the heart.

(208) Other components may be added to the preservation solution **118**, including, for example, adenosine, magnesium, phosphate, calcium, and/or sources thereof. In some instances, additional components are provided to assist the organ in conducting its metabolism during perfusion. These components include, for example, forms of adenosine, which may be used for ATP synthesis, for maintaining endothelial function, and/or for attenuating ischemia and/or reperfusion injury. Components may also include other nucleosides, such as guanosine, thymidine (5-Me-uridine), cytidine, and uridine, as well as other naturally and chemically modified nucleosides including nucleotides thereof. According to some implementations, a magnesium ion source is provided with a phosphate source, and in certain embodiments, with adenosine to further enhance ATP synthesis within the cells of the perfused organ. A plurality of amino acids may also be added to support protein synthesis by the heart's **102** cells. Applicable amino acids may include, for example, any of the naturally-occurring amino acids, as well as those mentioned above.

(209) Table 3 sets forth components that may be used in a solution **118** for preserving an organ as described herein. The solution **118** may include one or more of the components described in Table 3.

(210) TABLE-US-00003 TABLE 3 Component of Exemplary Composition for Preservative Solution Exemplary Concentration Ranges in Component Preservative Solution Alanine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Arginine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Asparagine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Aspartic Acid about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Cysteine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Cystine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Glutamic Acid about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Glutamine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Glycine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Histidine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Hydroxyproline about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Isoleucine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Leucine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Lysine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Methionine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Phenylalanine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Proline about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Serine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Threonine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Tryptophan about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Tyrosine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Valine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Adenine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L ATP about 10 ug/L-about 100 g/L Adenylic Acid about 10 ug/L-about 100 g/L ADP about 10 ug/L-about 100 g/L AMP about 10 ug/L-about 100 g/L Ascorbic Acid about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L D-Biotin about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L Vitamin D-12 about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L Cholesterol about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L Dextrose (Glucose) about 1 g/L-about 150 g/L Multi-vitamin Adult about 1 mg/L-about 20 mg/L or 1 unit vial Epinephrine about 1 ug/L-about 1 g/L Folic Acid about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L Glutathione about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L Guanine about 1 ug/L-about 10

g/L Insulin about 1 g/L-about 100 g/L Riboflavin about 1 g/L-about 10 g/L Ribose about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L Thiamine About 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Uracil about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L Calcium Chloride about 1 mg/L-about 100 g/L NaHCO₃ about 1 mg/L-about 100 g/L Magnesium sulfate about 1 mg/L-about 100 g/L Potassium chloride about 1 mg/L-about 100 g/L Sodium about 1 mg/L-about 100 g/L glycerophosphate Sodium Chloride about 1 mg/L-about 100 g/L Sodium Phosphate about 1 mg/L-about 100 g/L Insulin about 1 IU-about 150 IU Serum albumin about 1 g/L-about 100 g/L Pyruvate about 1 mg/L-about 100 g/L Coenzyme A about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L Serum about 1 ml/L-about 100 ml/L Heparin about 500 U/L-about 1500 U/L Solumedrol about 200 mg/L-about 500 mg/L Dexamethasone about 1 mg/L-about 1 g/L FAD about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L NADP about 1 ug/L-about 10 g/L adenosine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L guanosine about 1 mg/L-about 10 g/L GTP about 10 ug/L-about 100 g/L GDP about 10 ug/L-about 100 g/L GMP about 10 ug/L-about 100 g/L

(211) Table 4 sets forth components that are used in an exemplary preservative solution **118**. The amounts provided in Table 4 describe preferred amounts relative to other components in the table and may be scaled to provide compositions of sufficient quantity. In some embodiments, the amounts listed in Table 4 can vary by $\pm$ about 10% and still be used in the solutions described herein.

(212) TABLE-US-00004 TABLE 4 Components of Exemplary Preservative Solution Component Amount Adenosine About 675 mg-About 825 mg Calcium Chloride dihydrate About 2100 mg-About 2600 mg Glycine About 315 mg-About 385 mg L-Alanine About 150 mg-About 200 mg L-Arginine About 600 mg-About 800 mg L-Aspartic Acid About 220 mg-About 270 mg L-Glutamic Acid About 230 mg-About 290 mg L-Histidine About 200 mg-About 250 mg L-Isoleucine About 100 mg about 130 mg L-Leucine About 300 mg-About 380 mg L-Methionine About 50 mg-About 65 mg L-Phenylalanine About 45 mg-About 60 mg L-Proline About 110 mg-About 140 mg L-Serine About 80 mg-About 105 mg L-Threonine About 60 mg-About 80 mg L-Tryptophan About 30 mg-About 40 mg L-Tyrosine About 80 mg-About 110 mg L-Valine About 150 mg-About 190 mg Lysine Acetate About 200 mg-About 250 mg Magnesium Sulfate About 350 mg-About 450 mg Heptahydrate Potassium Chloride About 15 mg-About 25 mg Sodium Chloride About 1500 mg-About 2000 mg Dextrose About 25 gm-About 120 gm Epinephrine About 0.25 mg-About 1.0 mg Insulin About 75 Units-About 150 Units MVI-Adult 1 unit vial SoluMedrol About 200 mg-500 mg Sodium Bicarbonate About 10-25 mEq

(213) In the exemplary embodiment of a solution **118**, the components in Table 4 are combined in the relative amounts listed therein per about 1 L of aqueous fluid to form the solution **118**. In some embodiments, the components in Table 4 are combined in the relative amounts listed therein per about 500 mL of aqueous fluid and then combined with the solution **116**, also about 500 mL, to provide a maintenance solution **116/118** of about 1 L of aqueous fluid. In some embodiments the quantity of aqueous fluid in solutions **116**, **118**, and/or **116/118** can vary $\pm$ about 10%. The pH of the solution **118** may be adjusted to be between about 7.0 and about 8.0, for example about 7.3 and about 7.6. The solution **118** may be sterilized, for example by autoclaving, to provide for improved purity.

(214) Table 5 sets forth another exemplary preservative solution **118**, comprising a tissue culture media having the components identified in Table 5 and combined with an aqueous fluid, which may be used in the perfusion fluid **108** as described herein. The amounts of components listed in Table 5 are relative to each other and to the quantity of aqueous solution used. In some embodiments, about 500 mL of aqueous fluid is used. In other embodiments about 1 L of aqueous fluid is used. For example, combination of about 500 mL of preservative solution **118** with 500 mL of nutritional solution **116** affords a maintenance solution **116/118** of about 1 L. In some embodiments, the quantity of aqueous solution can vary $\pm$ about 10%. The component amounts and the quantity of aqueous solution may be scaled as appropriate for use. The pH of the preservative solution **118**, in this embodiment, may be adjusted to be about 7.0 to about 8.0, for example about 7.3 to about 7.6.

(215) TABLE-US-00005 TABLE 5 Composition of Another Exemplary Preservative Solution (about 500 mL aqueous solution) Tissue Culture Component Amount Specification Adenosine 750 mg. $\pm$ about 10% Calcium Chloride dihydrate 2400 mg $\pm$ about 10% Glycine 350 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Alanine 174 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Arginine 700 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Aspartic Acid 245 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Glutamic Acid 258 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Histidine 225 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Isoleucine 115.5 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Leucine 343 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Methionine 59 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Phenylalanine 52 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Proline 126 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Serine 93 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Threonine 70 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Tryptophan 35 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Tyrosine 92 mg $\pm$ about 10% L-Valine 171.5 mg $\pm$ about 10% Lysine Acetate 225 mg $\pm$ about 10% Magnesium Sulfate 400 mg $\pm$ about 10% Heptahydrate Potassium Chloride 20 mg $\pm$ about 10% Sodium Chloride 1750 mg $\pm$ about 10%

(216) Since amino acids are the building blocks of proteins, the unique characteristics of each amino acid impart certain important properties on a protein such as the ability to provide structure and to catalyze biochemical reactions. The selection and concentrations of the amino acids provided in the preservative solutions provide support of normal physiologic functions such as metabolism of sugars to provide energy, regulation of protein metabolism, transport of minerals, synthesis of nucleic acids (DNA and RNA), regulation of blood sugar and support of electrical activity, in addition to providing protein structure. Additionally, the concentrations of specific amino acids found in the preservative solutions can be used to predictably stabilize the pH of the maintenance solution **116/118** and perfusion fluid **108**.

(217) Certain embodiments of the preservative solution **118** include epinephrine and a plurality of amino acids. In certain embodiments, the preservative solution **118** includes electrolytes, such as calcium and magnesium.

(218) In one embodiment, a maintenance solution **116/118** is made from the combination of the preservative solution **118**, including one or more amino acids, and the nutritional solution **116**, including one or more carbohydrates, such as glucose or dextrose. The maintenance solution **116/118** may also have additives, such as those described herein, administered at the point of use just prior to infusion into the organ perfusion system. For example, additional additives that can be included with the solution or added at the point of use by the user include hormones and steroids, such as dexamethasone and insulin, as well as vitamins, such as an adult multi-vitamin, for example adult multivitamins for infusion, such as MVI-Adult. Additional small molecules and large bio-molecules may also be included with the solution or added at the point of use by the user at port **762**, for example, therapeutics and/or components typically associated with blood or blood plasma, such as albumin.

(219) In some embodiments, therapeutics that may be included in the compositions, solutions, and systems described herein include hormones, such as thyroid hormones, for example T.sub.3 and/or T.sub.4 thyroid hormones. Further therapeutics that may be included include drugs such as anti-arrhythmic drugs, for example, for heart therapy, and beta blockers. For instance, in certain embodiments, one or more thyroid hormones, one or more anti-arrhythmic drugs, and one or more beta blockers are added to the nutritional solution **116**, the preservative solution **118**, and/or the maintenance solutions **116/118** either before or during perfusion of the organ. The above therapeutics may also be added directly to the system, for example, to the perfusion fluid **108**, before or during perfusion of the organ.

(220) With further reference to Table 4, certain components used in the exemplary preservation solution **118** are molecules, such as small organic molecules or large bio-molecules, that would be inactivated, for example through decomposition or denaturing, if passed through sterilization. According to the system **100**, the inactivatable components of the solution **118** may be prepared separately from the remaining components of the solution **118**. The separate preparation involves separately purifying each component through known techniques. The remaining components of the solution **118** are sterilized, for example through an autoclave, then combined with the biological components.

(221) Table 6 lists certain biological components that may be separately purified and added to the solutions described herein after sterilization, according to this two-step process. These additional or supplemental components may be added to solutions **118**, **116**, **116/118**, the priming solution or a combination thereof individually, in various combinations, all at once as a composition, or as a combined solution. For example, in certain embodiments, the epinephrine, insulin, and MVI-Adult, listed in Table 6, are added to the maintenance solution **116/118**. In another example, the SoluMedrol and the sodium bicarbonate, listed in Table 6, are added to the priming solution. The additional components may also be combined in one or more combinations or all together and placed in solution before being added to solutions **116**, **118**, **116/118**, and/or the priming solution. In some embodiments, the additional components are added directly to the perfusion fluid **108** through port **762**. The component amounts listed in Table 6 are relative to each other and/or to the amounts of components listed in one or more of Tables 1-5 as well as the amount of aqueous solution used in preparing solutions **116**, **118**, **116/118**, and/or the priming solution and may be scaled as appropriate for the amount of solution required.

(222) TABLE-US-00006 TABLE 6 Exemplary Biological Components Added Prior to Use Component Amount Type Specification Epinephrine About 0.50 mg Catecholamine $\pm$ about 10% Hormone Insulin about 100 Units Hormone $\pm$ about 10% MVI-Adult 1 mL unit vial Vitamin $\pm$ about 10% SoluMedrol About 250 mg Steroid $\pm$ about 10% Sodium About 20 mEq Buffer $\pm$ about 10% Bicarbonate

(223) In one embodiment, a composition for use in a maintenance solution **116/118** is provided comprising one or more carbohydrates, one or more organ stimulants, and a plurality of amino acids that do not include asparagine, glutamine, or cysteine. The composition may also include other substances, such as those used in solutions described herein.

(224) In another embodiment, a system for perfusing an organ, such as a heart, is provided comprising an organ and a substantially cell-free composition, comprising one or more carbohydrates, one or more organ stimulants, and a plurality of amino acids that do not include asparagine, glutamine, or cysteine. Substantially cell-free includes systems that are substantially free from cellular matter; in particular, systems that are not derived from cells. For example, substantially cell-free includes compositions and solutions prepared from non-cellular sources.

(225) In another aspect, the solutions **116** and **118** may be provided in the form of a kit that includes one or more organ maintenance solutions. An exemplary maintenance solution may include components identified above in one or more fluid solutions for use in an organ perfusion fluid **108**. In certain embodiments, the maintenance solution **116/118** may include multiple solutions, such as a preservation solution **118** and a nutritional solution **116** and/or a supplemental composition or solution or may include dry components that may be regenerated in a fluid to form one or more solutions **116/118**. The kit may also comprise components from the solutions **116** and/or **118** in one or more concentrated solutions which, on dilution, provide a preservation, nutritional, and/or supplemental solution as described herein. The kit may also include a priming solution. In an exemplary embodiment, the maintenance solution includes a preservation solution **118** and a nutritional solution **116** such as those described above, and a priming solution such as that described above.

(226) In certain embodiments, the kit is provided in a single package, wherein the kit includes one or more solutions (or components necessary to formulate the one or more solutions by mixing with an appropriate fluid), and instructions for sterilization, flow and temperature control during perfusion and use and other information necessary or appropriate to apply the kit to organ perfusion. In certain embodiments, a kit is provided with only a single solution **116**, **118** and/or **116/118** (or set of dry components for use in a solution upon mixing with an appropriate fluid), and the single solution **116**, **118** and/or **116/118** (or set of dry components) is provided along with a set of instructions and other information or materials necessary or useful to operate the solution **116**, **118** and/or **116/118** in the system **100**.

(227) In another aspect, the systems, solutions and methods may be used to deliver therapeutics to an organ during perfusion. For example, one or more of the solutions and/or systems described above may include one or more drugs, biologics, gene therapy vectors, or other therapeutics which are delivered to the organ during perfusion. Suitable exemplary therapeutics may include drugs, biologics, or both. Suitable drugs may include, for example, antifungals, anti-microbials or anti-biotics, anti-inflammatories, anti-proliferatives, anti-virals, steroids, retinoids, NSAIDs, vitamin D3 and vitamin D3 analogs, calcium channel blockers, complement neutralizers, ACE inhibitors, immunosuppressants, and other drugs. Suitable biologics may include proteins; suitable biologics may also include vectors loaded with one or more genes for gene therapy application.

(228) For example, suitable steroids include but are not limited to androgenic and estrogenic steroid hormones, androgen receptor antagonists and 5- α -reductase inhibitors, and corticosteroids. Specific examples include but are not limited to alclometasone, clobetasol, fluocinolone, fluocortolone, diflucortolone, fluticasone, halcinonide, mometasone, prednisone, prednisolone, methylprednisolone, triamcinolone, betamethasone, and dexamethasone, and various esters and acetones thereof.

(229) Suitable retinoids include but are not limited to retinol, retinal, isotretinoin, acitretin, adapalene, tazarotene, and bexarotene.

(230) Suitable NSAIDs include but are not limited to naproxen, suprofen, ketoprofen, ibuprofen, flurbiprofen, diclofenac, indomethacin, celecoxib, and rofecoxib.

(231) Suitable vitamin D3 analogues include but are not limited to doxercalciferol, seocalcitol, calcipotriene, tacalcitol, calcitriol, ergocalciferol, and calcifediol.

(232) Suitable anti-viral agents include but are not limited to trifluridine, cidofovir, acyclovir, penciclovir, famciclovir, valacyclovir, ganciclovir, and docosanol.

(233) Suitable human carbonic anhydrase inhibitors include but are not limited to methazolamide, acetazolamide, and dorzolamide.

(234) Suitable anti-proliferative agents include but are not limited to 5-FU, taxol, daunorubicin, and mitomycin.

(235) Suitable antibiotic (antimicrobial) agents include but are not limited to bacitracin, chlorhexidine, chlorhexidine digluconate, ciprofloxacin, clindamycin, erythromycin, gentamicin, lomefloxacin, metronidazole, minocycline, moxifloxacin, mupirocin, neomycin, ofloxacin, polymyxin B, rifampicin, rifloxacin, tetracycline, tobramycin, triclosan, and vancomycin. The antiviral and antibacterial prodrugs described herein may be used to treat appropriately responsive systemic infections.

(236) In certain embodiments, a solution system for use in a perfusion fluid **108**, comprising a first chamber containing a first solution, such as a preservation solution **118**, that includes one or more cardio stimulants and a plurality of amino acids that do not include asparagine, glutamine, or cysteine, and a second chamber, containing a second solution, such as a nutritional solution **116**, that includes one or more carbohydrates, such as dextrose. The system may also include a sterilization system for sterilizing the first solution and the second solution prior to using the solutions to perfuse a heart. In some embodiments, one or more of the solutions **118** and **116** includes one or more therapeutics. In some embodiments the solution system includes a third chamber comprising a priming solution, such as is described above, which may have one or more carbohydrates. In certain embodiments, the first solution **118** includes epinephrine, adenosine, insulin, one or more immuno-suppressants, a multi-vitamin, and/or one or more electrolytes.

(237) Certain experimental data are available to describe certain embodiments of the solutions described herein and their use in organ perfusion. Certain data are set for in FIGS. **31-33**. FIG. **31** depicts a chart demonstrating electrolyte stability for an organ undergoing perfusion in forward mode according to an embodiment of the system **100**. In the embodiment associated with FIG. **31**, the organ is a heart **102** wherein perfusion is conducted in forward mode (as described above) by pumping perfusion fluid **108** containing solution **116/118** to the left atria **152** and out of the aorta **158**. The rate of perfusion is approximately 30 mhr. As can be seen from FIG. **31**, the levels of various electrolytes: sodium, potassium, calcium, and chloride ions, as well as dissolved glucose, remain at stable levels throughout the course of perfusion, from before the organ is cannulated to the perfusion system **100** to six hours after cannulation within the system **100**.

(238) FIG. **32** depicts a chart demonstrating electrolyte stability for an organ undergoing retrograde perfusion according to another embodiment of the system **100**. In the embodiment associated with FIG. **32**, the organ is a heart wherein perfusion occurs by pumping the perfusion fluid **108** containing the solution **116/118** into the aorta **158** and through the coronary sinus **155**. The rate of infusion is approximately 30 mL/hr. As can be seen from FIG. **32**, the levels of various electrolytes: sodium, potassium, calcium, and chloride ions, as well as dissolved glucose, remain at stable levels throughout the course of perfusion, from before the organ is cannulated to the perfusion system **100** to six hours after cannulation. FIG. **32** also demonstrates that the levels of the electrolytes and glucose remain at levels similar to those for the base line (BL) normal physiological state for the organ.

(239) FIG. **33** depicts a chart demonstrating the arterial blood gas profile for an organ undergoing perfusion according to another embodiment of the invention. As can be seen from FIG. **33**, the levels of various blood gases: carbon dioxide and oxygen, and pH remain at stable levels throughout the six-hour course of perfusion. FIG. **33** also demonstrates that the levels of carbon dioxide, oxygen, and pH remain at levels similar to those for two base line (BL) measurements for the normal physiological state for the organ. FIGS. **31-33** demonstrate the ability of the present systems and methods to maintain an organ under stable physiological or near physiological conditions.

(240) In another aspect of the invention, lactate is used as an indicator of isolated donor heart perfusion status. In Arterial blood lactate is measured

using a standard blood chemistry analyzer or as built in organ care system **100** arterial on-line Lactate analyzer probe. The venous blood (which has been through the coronary sinus) lactate is measured using a similar technique as above. The V-A lactate differential is calculated using the following formula: Lactate V-A differential=Venous (coronary sinus) blood lactate–Arterial blood lactate.

(241) The V-A differential indicates the perfusion status.

(242) If the V-A Differential has a negative (–) value the venous blood (coronary sinus), has less lactate than the arterial blood. This indicates that the heart is actually metabolizing lactate which is a sign of adequate perfusion and oxygen delivery to the myocardial cells.

(243) If the V-A Differential has a zero (0) value the lactate in the venous side is equal to the arterial blood. This indicates that the myocardial cells are not producing or metabolizing lactate. This state indicates adequate perfusion for the myocardial cell, however, serial measurements are needed to validate that this state of equilibrium is not shifting.

(244) If the V-A Differential has a positive (+) value the myocardial cells are starved of oxygen and are starting to produce lactate as a byproduct of anaerobic metabolism. To address this issue, the operator would increase the coronary flow to ensure adequate perfusion and increase the rate of delivery of oxygen and substrate to the myocardial cells.

(245) Serial (at least hourly) measurements of the lactate V-A differential are indicated for the entire maintenance period of an isolated heart on the organ care system **100** to give the operator a continuous assessment of the perfusion status of that heart. The serial measurements allow the operator to evaluate the trend data for the lactate V-A differential.

(246) FIG. **34** depicts a serial lactate differential that indicates adequate perfusion. The vertical axis indicates the lactate value (mmol/L) and the horizontal axis is time (minutes). The table below provides the values for arterial lactate (Lactate A), venous lactate (Lactate V) and Lactate V-A differential (Lactate VA dif) and the time, in minutes, on the perfusion clock.

(247) TABLE-US-00007 TABLE 7 Serial lactate table of information corresponding to FIG. 34. Perfusion Lactate A Lactate VA Dif Lactate V Time

1.87	0	1.87	0	20	40	1.63	–0.24	1.39	60	80	100	1.01	–0.08	0.93	120	140	0.91	–0.08	0.83	160
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(248) Notable is that the V-A differential is zero or lower throughout the perfusion time. This indicates that there is adequate perfusion and that the myocardial cells are not producing lactate. In one embodiment, serial reading can provide the trend of the V-A differential. Further, the trend of decreasing lactate values indicates that the myocardial cells are metabolizing lactate. These indications are associated with positive post transplant outcomes.

(249) FIG. **35** is an example of serial lactate V-A differential assessment of a human heart on an organ care system **100**. Notable is the increasing lactate values, indicating the myocardial cells are creating lactate and the positive values for the VA differential. This indicates an inadequate perfusion and was associated with ischemic injury to the donor heart resulting in a clinical decision of not being suitable for transplantation. Further, the trend of increasing lactate values indicates the production of lactate and indicates that the myocardial cells lack sufficient oxygen.

(250) TABLE-US-00008 TABLE 8 Serial lactate table of information corresponding to FIG. 35. Perfusion Lactate A Lactate VA Dif Lactate V Time

1.32	–0.06	1.26	10	1.45	0.11	1.56	30	4.54	0.11	4.65	150	4.81	180	8.1	–0.1	8	250	8.7	–0.5	8.2	280
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(251) The serial lactate differential can be used in combination with other physiologic parameters to assess the myocardial tissue suitability for a transplant. For example, Coronary Vascular Patency of an isolated heart on the Organ Care System **100** can be assessed using the combination of high aortic pressure (perfusion pressure) and serial lactate V-A Differential.

(252) Particularly, the presence of elevated aortic pressure observed in a heart on the organ care system **100**, combined with elevated, rising or neutral lactate V-A differential may indicate coronary vascular narrowing of the perfused heart. This can be explained by the elevated pressures as a sign of high resistance to blood flow and in turn low or inadequate oxygen delivery to the myocardial cells resulting in lactate production and the abnormal V-A differential.

(253) It is to be understood that while the invention has been described in conjunction with the various illustrative embodiments, the foregoing description is intended to illustrate and not limit the scope of the invention, which is defined by the scope of the appended claims. For example, a variety of systems and/or methods may be implemented based on the disclosure and still fall within the scope of the invention. Other aspects, advantages, and modifications are within the scope of the following claims. All references cited herein are incorporated by reference in their entirety and made part of this application.

Claims

1. An organ care system for perfusing a heart, the organ care system comprising: a chassis; an organ chamber assembly mounted to the chassis, the organ chamber assembly configured to contain the heart during a perfusion, the organ chamber assembly comprising: a fluid conduit comprising: a first interface configured to connect to an aorta of the heart; and a second interface configured to connect to a pulmonary artery of the heart; a first lactate sensor configured to measure a first lactate value at the first interface, and a second lactate sensor configured to measure a second lactate value at the second interface; an oxygenator; a reservoir mounted to the chassis, wherein the reservoir is in fluid communication with the organ chamber assembly and is configured to contain a perfusion fluid; and a processor configured to: calculate a lactate differential at two different times using the first lactate value and the second lactate value, wherein the organ care system is configured to receive an adjustment of a flow of the perfusion fluid based on a change between the lactate differential at the two different times.
2. The organ care system of claim 1, wherein the organ chamber assembly is disposable.
3. The organ care system of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to calculate the lactate differential at least once per hour.
4. The organ care system of claim 1, comprising a flow mode selector valve configured to select between flowing the perfusion fluid to the first interface and flowing the perfusion fluid to the second interface.
5. The organ care system of claim 1, comprising a pressure sensor configured to measure an aortic pressure.
6. The organ care system of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to correlate a change between the lactate differential at the two different times with a suitability of the heart for transplantation.
7. An apparatus comprising: an organ chamber assembly configured to contain a heart during a perfusion, the organ chamber assembly comprising: a fluid conduit comprising: a first interface configured to connect to an aorta of the heart; and a second interface configured to connect to a pulmonary artery of the heart; a first lactate sensor configured to measure a first lactate value at the first interface; and a second sensor configured to measure a second lactate value at the second interface; an oxygenator; a reservoir, wherein the reservoir is in fluid communication with the organ chamber assembly and is configured to contain a perfusion fluid; a processor coupled to the first lactate sensor and to the second lactate sensor; and a memory coupled to the processor and comprising computer-readable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to: calculate a lactate differential at two different times using the first lactate value and the second lactate value, wherein the apparatus is configured to receive an adjustment of a flow of the perfusion fluid based on the two or more lactate differentials.
8. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the organ chamber assembly is disposable.
9. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the computer-readable instructions, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to: calculate the lactate differential at least once per hour.
10. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the computer-readable instructions, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to: correlate a change between the lactate differential at the two different times with a suitability of the heart for transplantation.
11. The apparatus of claim 7, comprising a flow mode selector valve configured to select between flowing the perfusion fluid to the first interface and flowing the perfusion fluid to the second interface.

12. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the reservoir is mounted to a chassis.
 13. The apparatus of claim 7, comprising a pressure sensor configured to measure an aortic pressure.
 14. An organ care system comprising: a chassis; an organ chamber assembly mounted to the chassis, wherein the organ chamber assembly is configured to contain a heart during a perfusion, the organ chamber assembly comprising: a fluid conduit comprising: a first interface configured to connect to an aorta of the heart; and a second interface configured to connect to a pulmonary artery of the heart; a first lactate sensor configured to measure a first lactate value at the first interface; and a second lactate sensor configured to measure a second lactate value at the second interface; an oxygenator; a reservoir mounted to the chassis, wherein the reservoir is in fluid communication with the organ chamber assembly and is configured to contain a perfusion fluid; a processor coupled to the first lactate sensor and to the second lactate sensor; and a memory coupled to the processor and comprising computer-readable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to: calculate a lactate differential at two different times using the first lactate value and the second lactate value; and correlate a change between the lactate differential at the two different times with a suitability of the heart for transplantation, wherein the organ care system is configured to receive an adjustment of a flow of the perfusion fluid based on a change between the lactate differential at the two different times.
 15. The organ care system of claim 14, wherein the organ chamber assembly is disposable.
 16. The organ care system of claim 14, comprising a flow mode selector valve configured to select between flowing the perfusion fluid to the first interface and flowing the perfusion fluid to the second interface.
 17. The organ care system of claim 14, comprising a pressure sensor configured to measure an aortic pressure.
 18. The organ care system of claim 14, wherein the processor is configured to calculate the change between the lactate differential at least once per hour.
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